

The Member and the Group— Recovery Through Service

The Twenty-Eighth Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous

1978

Final Report

**Roosevelt Hotel
New York City
April 16-22**



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Drawings in this issue
by Al Herr, from the A.A. filmstrip "Circles of Love and Service"
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Confidential — full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses, just as A.A. directories do.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use does not, of course, violate in any way our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications media (press, radio, TV, etc.).

Regional Map Of U.S. and Canada

Regional trustees: See farewell talks, p. 8; Floor Action 4, p. 47; Advisory Action 57, p. 49; brief biographies, pp. 58-59.

A.A. regional forums: See presentations, pp. 17-18; staff and trustees' committee reports, pp. 37-38; Ask-It Basket question, p. 43.

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28th Conference Sees Change—and Stability

Opening day

From orientation sessions for new delegates through the dinner-A.A. meeting Sunday and the trustee committee reports Monday afternoon, the mechanics of starting the 28th General Service Conference of A.A. (U.S. and Canada) meshed smoothly into gear. Therefore, Conference members could move quickly into committee work and workshops the first full day of the annual six-day meeting at New York's Hotel Roosevelt.

Lois Wilson, widow of A.A.'s late co-founder Bill, headed the guest list at the Sunday-evening dinner attended by 320 people. The A.A. meeting afterward was led by Mary Ellen Welsh, who retires from the General Service Office (G.S.O.) staff later this year. Speakers were delegates Garrett Taylor (District of Columbia), Grace Day (West Virginia), and Tom Sinclair (British Columbia/Yukon).

John L. ("Dr. Jack") Norris, M.D., formally opened the Conference by welcoming members to his last session as chairperson of the General Service Board and Conference.



Trustees' chairperson since 1963, Dr. Jack (left) ended this phase of his service to A.A. with the 1978 Conference. At its close, he was replaced by Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D. (right), to whom Dr. Jack paid warm tribute on the always-emotional last day (see pp. 8 and 9).

Bob Pearson, general manager of G.S.O. and vice-chairperson of the Conference, formally called the roll of the 135 voting members, and later introduced most of the nonalcoholic employees of G.S.O. Jack Morley, Grapevine editor, introduced the magazine staff and employees.

Each day's session opened with the Serenity Prayer and a reading of pertinent A.A. literature, led successively by Al Ashman-skas (Eastern Missouri), LeRoy Iszler (Central Michigan), Jack Wilson (Utah), and Jessie Parks (Southeastern Michigan). For the daily closing, the Lord's Prayer was led by Marv Brisson (Northwestern Ontario), Skeeter Hayes (Southeastern Texas), Laurent Biron (Southeastern Quebec), Jim Dickens (Nevada), and Rolly Provost (Eastern Ontario).

Highlights of past Conferences

'An experience in faith'

The first paragraph of the report of our first annual Conference (Hotel Commodore, New York City, April 20-22, 1951) stated: "'Genuine faith,' a thoughtful spiritual leader tells us, 'is more

than insight.' It is always the 'beginning of action.' It is propulsive. It fortifies the will. It begins as an experiment and ends as an experience."

That Conference was an unbounded expression of faith in the future of A.A. It reflected early members' *insight* into the problems of continuing A.A. unity, continuing service to individuals and groups already in A.A., and compelling need to reach "the millions who still don't know."

The Conference was the *beginning of action*, designed to preserve and strengthen A.A. Through the Conference, the founders and their friends delivered to the membership the Legacy of Service begun in Akron, Ohio, 16 years before.

Without question, the Conference was *propulsive* and *fortified the will*. Time and again, the 37 delegates revealed the forward thrust of their thinking, their desire to insure A.A.'s survival. Their will to action was strengthened by their participation. Begun as an experiment, the three-day session ended as an experience in faith.

One problem facing the Conference was how to get "the sense of the meeting" on important matters. A corollary problem was how to determine which items on a crowded agenda should be considered and which deferred.

The need for a minimum number of committees, to review various subjects and to prepare reports for approval (or rejection) by the full Conference, soon became apparent. It was agreed the following committees should be constituted: Budget, Agenda, Conference Report, and Trustees. The committees met at their convenience Saturday evening and, in some cases, Sunday morning. No committee meetings were on the regular agenda; they were called for lunch hours, breakfast times, and any other available time. Committees' suggestions were presented for action at the final session Sunday afternoon. Since then, committee meetings have become far more significant.

At the first Conference, for the first time, delegates met the "unseen friends" of A.A.—the nonalcoholic trustees, without whom, as Bill pointed out, the movement could never have become what it is today. Two were mentioned—Austin MacCormick, one of America's greatest penologists, and Dr. John L. Norris, whose work with A.A. in industry set a pattern.

At the 1952 Conference, one problem discussed was the "Easy Does It" fellow who loaf around a club, stays sober, but makes no effort to support himself. Also, delegates advised one another not to be disheartened by resistance in relaying the Third Legacy message to local areas.

At this Conference, Bernard Smith said, "What we do here and have done here is not nearly as important, in my judgment, as the fact that *we are here*." At the same time, he emphasized that "we seek not compromise but certainty. I cannot reiterate too strongly," he said, "my feeling that unless we are sure, unless we are certain, if there is yet time left to us to make a decision, I regard no decision as important as the willingness in American society to postpone ultimate consideration. I reiterate those words: We seek *not compromise*, but *certainty*. If we can think of that, we will not fail."

In 1953, someone suggested the phrase "no fees or dues" be taken out of the Preamble. In reply, Bill W. referred to basic

meanings of words, “‘fee’ being understood as something paid for something received; ‘dues,’ the requirement for admission to something. In A.A., no one is forced to pay to receive the help we can offer; membership is not contingent upon payment of dues; hence the ‘no fees or dues’ phrase reflects as accurately as possible how we operate. It does not, of course, mean the recovered alcoholic should not be asked to share the cost of essential A.A. activities when he is able to do so.”

In 1955, the Conference had its final session as part of the closing of the 20th Anniversary International Convention in St. Louis. Bill spoke about highly publicized anonymity breaks. One question asked was: “Do interpretations of the Tradition of anonymity (and of other Traditions) lie within the province of the Conference, which might, from year to year, develop different interpretations?” Bill emphasized that both the Steps and the Traditions “obviously mean what each individual construes them to mean.” Up till then, the founders and early members had been so-called guardians of the Traditions, Bill said, but he reminded the Conference that adoption of a permanent Third Legacy Charter could transfer that responsibility to the Conference itself. “The proposed Conference Charter makes it clear that no agency in A.A. should ever have the right to coerce or punish or attempt to exercise authority over any individual, whatever his deviation from the Traditions may be.”

At the 1959 Conference, a study committee on relations with outside agencies was appointed. From it emerged the pamphlet “Cooperation but Not Affiliation” (now revised and titled “How A.A. Members Cooperate”).

In 1963, as the result of a magazine article negative about A.A., Bill wrote for the Grapevine “Our Critics Can Be Our Benefactors,” and the 1963 Conference devoted its time to A.A. taking its own inventory. As a follow-up, the first sharing session was demonstrated at the 1964 Conference.

In 1967, the first Grapevine calendar was introduced.

In 1970, Bill was asked, “If there was any change you would make in the Big Book, would it be to change the word ‘rarely’ to ‘never’ at the start of Chapter 5?” Bill answered no.

The 21st meeting, in 1971, was the first where Bill was not with us.

In 1972, a resolution that G.S.O. should not involve itself in local disputes or misunderstandings was approved.

Groups and members — spring 1978

	Groups	Members
United States	18,382	352,807
Canada	2,950	50,783
Overseas ¹	7,597	134,537
Treatment Facilities	1,400	33,544
Correctional Facilities	1,258	40,205
Lone Members		393
Internationalists		607
Totals	31,587	612,876 ²

1. Figures as of Jan. 1, 1977; reports on later statistics incomplete at present.

2. Including nonreported members, it is estimated that there are now more than 1,000,000 members, in 92 countries.

In 1973, the new booklet “Came to Believe” was available.

The 1974 Conference affirmed that all A.A. groups should be listed in the *World Directory*.

I know we all look forward to this 28th Conference with love and open hearts.

Beth Kuhlmann, G.S.O. staff

Keynote

‘The Member and the Group—Recovery Through Service’

From the very beginning, Alcoholics Anonymous wasted no time nor effort in trying to determine the why or causes of alcoholism. We were simply advised to accept the illness and get on with recovery.

Not too many sober days had gone by when I found myself thinking, “Why me?” It was not the old “Why me?” prompted by self-pity. I could in no way understand why I had been selected to enjoy sober life when people all around were still in the darkness of alcoholism.

I found the answer in the Steps. The prayer in the Third Step in the Big Book held the key: “Take away my difficulties, that victory over them may bear witness to those I would help . . .” Perhaps there *was* a reason. Maybe a purpose could be found right here. Soon, I was engulfed with the problems of defects and inventory. The purpose faded for a while, until I read Step Seven. I was at the time in desperate need to determine what was meant by humility, and to just what degree one could *humbly* measure one’s progress in that area.

There was the prayer mentioned in the Big Book discussion of Step Six: “my usefulness to You and my fellows.” The reason for my existence must be to serve. Later on, that was clearly defined: “Our real purpose is to fit ourselves to be of maximum service to God and the people about us.” Service to God and my fellows is the reason I am given sobriety, and there is no other reason. If I fail to serve, my purpose in life will be unfilled, and no doubt life itself will be taken away.

Long ago, I stopped praying for sobriety, because perhaps my Maker might think, “If he does not know what he has got, why, I might as well take it back.” Sooner or later, all our prayers might change from “What can You give to me?” to “What have You got for me to do?” How best can I serve?

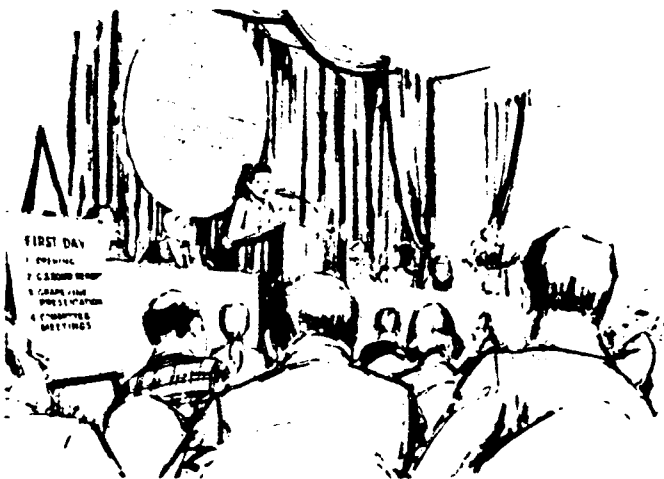
I have always felt that if we concentrated on Recovery, Unity and Service would take care of themselves automatically. However, if Recovery is to be available in the group, Unity and Service must be part of that group. Yet Service is looked upon in many places as something separate, to be endured by only a few. The recovery of millions of alcoholics depends upon us. That is an obligation, a responsibility that is mind-boggling. As each member works through the group—through recovery to service—we cannot number the lives that can be touched.

*Mac Cheater, general service trustee—Canada
[now termed trustee-at-large]*

'Mutual trust should prevail'

Last year, before I came to New York, I reviewed all material sent, and sought the conscience of my area on various issues. But I carried with me a fully developed sense of inadequacy. Now, after attaining the status of veteran, I feel a bit more confident, but still carry with me a fully developed sense of inadequacy!

Perhaps this is as it should be. We feel a sense of awe at being here, to share the heritage of love and service left us by Bill and Dr. Bob. We are aware of our human limitations, but we take comfort in the knowledge that perfection is not expected of us—only progress. The days ahead will be filled with exciting work:



listening, talking, discussing, sharing. Yet even in the midst of the frantic schedule, we can remain quiet within ourselves and, in a spirit of prayer and meditation, reach a loving God expressed through our group conscience.

In this Conference meeting, we will agree often and sometimes disagree. I bring the conscience of my area, but I consider questions before us, not as a representative of a particular area, but in the best interests of A.A. as a whole. There is a time when I must listen, and a time when I must talk. There is a time when I must yield, and a time to hold firm.

Concept XII describes the ideals of Conference participation: "... our Conferences will always try to act in the spirit of mutual respect and love—one member for another. In turn, this signifies that mutual trust should prevail; that no action ought to be taken in anger, haste, or recklessness; that care will be observed to respect and protect all minorities; that no action should ever be personally punitive; that whenever possible, important actions will be taken in substantial unanimity; and that our Conference will ever be prudently on guard against tyrannies, great or small, whether these be found in the majority or in the minority."

Fran Polek (Washington), area delegate chairperson

Presentations spark informal discussion

As usual, area delegates held a meeting just for themselves on Tuesday evening. Items on the agenda for the full Conference are customarily not taken up, since other Conference members are absent, and this is not an "official" Conference session.

Three presentations, open discussion, and an election were on the agenda. Fran Polek (Washington), delegates' chairperson, presided. Rolly Provost (Eastern Ontario) spoke on "The Delegate and A.A. World Service Structure"; Tom Dougherty (Chicago), on "The Delegate and the Responsibility of Communication"; and Jim Dickens (Nevada), on "The Delegate and the Professional Community." Floor discussion centered on regional forums and mail foul-ups.

Ed Edwards (Maryland) was elected delegates' chairperson, taking office immediately upon the close of the 1978 Conference sessions, and Bill Killebrew (Tennessee) was elected alternate chairperson.

Sharing session

Wide range of topics aired

Although not conducted by the rules for a sharing session published by G.S.O. some years ago, the sharing session Friday afternoon at the 28th Conference unearthed some good ideas on a wide spectrum of topics. No subject was barred.

The filmstrip "Circles of Love and Service" was reported to be of great value in getting people interested in service. (A blowup of a new pamphlet based on the filmstrip was shown at the Conference.) Some delegates, however, reported difficulty in getting projectors.

The suggestion was made that name tags with a sketch of Victor E., from the popular Grapevine cartoon strip, be furnished for A.A. functions. [These are now ready and may be ordered from the Grapevine for A.A. functions.]

The reason 75% of Georgia groups contribute to G.S.O. (although the overall U.S. and Canadian figure is 56%) is that "we talk about it all the time in Georgia," the delegate from that state said.

Most members favor the use of full names at A.A. meetings, and some choose to use full names when they are speaking at non-A.A. meetings.

Listing of district committee members in the A.A. directories was proposed, and there was general agreement that the importance of D.C.M.'s should be more widely recognized. However, the value of a directory listing was questioned, since the directories are primarily for the use of travelers. Everyone, however, liked the idea of listing group service numbers in directories.

One trustee asked that all areas with G.S.R. "schools" send information about them to G.S.O., so other areas can share such experience.

Farewells—chairman, GV editor, trustees

Almost a half hour early, Conference members began to seat themselves at round tables Saturday morning for the customary farewell brunch beneath the crystal chandeliers in the Hotel Roosevelt's Terrace Room. At each plate was a copy of the Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9*, the Conference issue mailed to all groups as a summary of significant decisions and reports.



For the first time in years, nonalcoholic John L. ("Dr. Jack") Norris, M.D., retiring chairman of the General Service Board, did not preside but introduced for that task his nonalcoholic successor, Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D., Olympia, Wash., first chairperson of the board. Milton revealed he had twice declined to become the board head but decided this year he could not do so. "A.A. has been my love since the 1940's," he said, "and I am deeply moved by your trust."

Fran J. Polek (Washington), delegates' outgoing chairperson, briefly expressed thanks to all who had helped make the Conference a success, and Ed Edwards (Maryland), delegates' incoming chairperson, read "How It Works."

Roberto Minero, Mexico City, D.F., his nation's representative at the World Service Meeting and a former member of Mexico's General Service Board, was also introduced. With Conference permission, he had been a nonvoting observer all week.

Then came the farewell remarks by four Conference members.

'A moment of humility—rare for me!'

Peter A. G. Watters, Oakville, Ont., retiring Eastern Canada regional trustee, began talking in French, then said, "You have heard 60 seconds in French; but French-speaking Canadian delegates have had to listen to English for six days!"

Pete dedicated his talk to his Al-Anon mother, who asked him to leave his home community in 1958 but stood by him faithfully when he joined A.A. in 1960. His first A.A. service job, as intergroup representative, he took because he thought it paid, Pete said. But he went on to become G.S.R., and "I wanted to

resign after every G.S.R. session," he admitted. "I had yet to learn patience."

When Pete was a Panel 17 delegate, he was touring G.S.O. (then on East 45th Street in Manhattan) when a lone, tall, gray-haired man ambled up and wanted to know whether he could help the visitors. Almost in shock, Pete realized it was Bill. Beside the meeting-room windows, then overlooking the East River and the United Nations complex, Pete said, he heard another delegate say in awe, "It sure is a long way from the back alleys to this 18th floor!"

His election as a trustee was "a moment of humility—rare for me!" Pete declared. "Now, in retrospect, you wonder if you've made any contribution," he continued. "But certainly I have gained; I'll miss the people, if not the work. And to my surprise, I've come to know the love of God through A.A. service."

He forgot to take notes

In 1955, Stan Wilsey, Fairfax, Calif., was elected (on the 18th ballot, he recalled) delegate to the Conference that met in St. Louis, Mo., and accepted from A.A.'s founders the Legacy of Service. At the first "delegates only" meeting, Stan was chosen to take notes but got so excited, he forgot. One motion, he remembered, was to throw out all the nonalcoholic trustees. But the last motion on the floor was to destroy all minutes of the meeting, and it passed, to Stan's relief.

He said he hopes to see the Traditions appreciated and used more, especially now that their long form is in the book "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" (an addition that Stan suggested). The long form answers many questions about the Traditions, he said.

Stan also spoke fervently in favor of rotation, and put in a plug for "Live and Let Live." He referred to the custom at some meetings of holding hands during the closing prayer, and suggested a section be set aside for non-hand-holders, as there often is one for nonsmokers. "I don't object to anyone's holding hands who wants to," Stan explained. "I object to your thinking there's anything wrong with me because I *don't* want to!"

Grapevine almost required 'vow of poverty'

Jack Morley, retiring Grapevine editor, reminisced about starting to work for the Grapevine in 1961, when the General Service Board was continually having to bail out the magazine financially. "We practically worked under a vow of poverty," he said. But in the mid-1960's, the Grapevine went into the black and also paid back to the board all the money given to the magazine. Since then, the GV has made a large yearly contribution to the General Fund.

But the habits of poverty are hard to break, Jack noted, and told of the Grapevine's move from East 45th Street to its present offices. That day, a drunk who was a regular visitor at G.S.O. turned up. He placed himself in the hallway while Paula and Jack were frugally packing the GV's files for moving. "Mostly he leaned against the wall," Jack recalled, "but occasionally his feet would begin to slide from under him, and down he'd go. At first, we picked him up each time and propped him against

the wall, but finally we gave up, let him lie there, and just stepped over him as we worked."

The outgoing editor said the magazine was filled with drunkalogues at first, but has come to be about living sober. Jack thanked A.A. for its gifts to him, the greatest of which he said, is faith.

'With gratitude for his tireless devotion'

When Dr. Jack rose to speak, he was presented with a specially commissioned head of himself done in bronze. The engraved plaque on the base read: "John L. Norris, M.D., General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, 1951-1978. Presented by members of the 28th General Service Conference of A.A. with gratitude for his tireless devotion and service to our Fellowship."

"I'm the one who should be thanking you," Dr. Jack began. He then told of his "A.A. sponsor." When he first tried to treat an alcoholic, "I failed spectacularly as a physician," he said. "And then the fellow got well in spite of me, in A.A., and he insisted I go to meetings with him." He remembered the man's saying, "Doctor, I am free!"

"What little I've been able to do as board chairman, I didn't do," Dr. Jack emphasized. "As Dr. Bob said, I was just a channel."

Dr. Jack also reported on his Latin American trip, March 17 - April 3. He visited São Paulo, Rio de Janeiro, and Belo Horizonte in Brazil, and attended the annual A.A. conclave in Buenos Aires, Argentina. He met with counterpart board members in each nation, and addressed both professionals and a large public meeting in Bogotá, Colombia, to help them get a rehabilitation center started.

Dr. Jack pointed out that the group *conscience* may be quite different from a group *opinion*. "We find the conscience by listening quietly," he said. "We have problems, and we'll have more," according to Dr. Jack, but delegates, he said, have a rare opportunity to convey to their areas a sense of the stability of A.A. and quiet confidence in the Fellowship.

About the new board chairperson, he said, "I believe Milton Maxwell is too little appreciated in A.A., because he is so quiet. But because of his understanding heart, I think Milton may be A.A.'s greatest nonalcoholic friend in the field of alcoholism."

Dr. Jack recalled the first A.A. banquet he attended, in Rochester, N.Y., sometime in the 1940's. He recollected hearing a fruit farmer, sober six months, say, "This is the first spring I remember seeing apple blossoms and hearing birds sing." Chief speaker on that program was Bill D., A.A. No. 3, often described as "the man on the bed." And this reminded Dr. Jack that "not until Bill W. knew he needed someone else for his *own* sobriety could he carry the message."

Dr. Jack closed his talk with the prayer of St. Francis of Assisi. "For those of us in A.A. who have tried to carry the message, that prayer has been answered!" he concluded.

Delegates to the 28th Conference ranged in age from 34 to 78; the average was 53. The average sobriety term was 12 years, with the range extending from four and three-quarters to 28.

Spouses entertained

Twenty-five New York area A.A. members formed the Hospitality Committee, to entertain Conference members' spouses while delegates and other Conference members worked (often starting with 7:30 breakfast sessions and continuing uninterrupted until past midnight).

In addition to shopping on New York's fabled Fifth Avenue and orchestra, opera, ballet, and theater performances, nine activities were especially arranged for the visitors. They included a tour of Lincoln Center with lunch at the Ginger Man; a visit to the Metropolitan Museum of Art with lunch at its Fountain restaurant; a visit to an art studio at the National Arts Club, with a tour of the club and lunch; a visit to Al-Anon's World Service Office; tea at Windows on the World on the 107th floor of the World Trade Center; and a boat trip around the island of Manhattan, with lunch aboard.

Coffee breaks

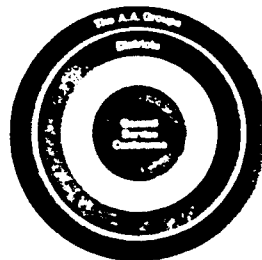
Eighteen attractive special display boards (volunteer service by Mary Nichols of the New York Intergroup office) surrounded the area where Conference members coffeed-up in the Terrace Room of the hotel.

Also shown was one of the professionally designed A.A. exhibits shipped to meetings of national professional societies, the one-way table-top version of this exhibit, and the Preamble and "I Am Responsible" plaques.

On nearby tables were stacks of all Guidelines, the A.A.W.S. Literature Order Form, the Grapevine order form, and two new one-page pieces, "Carrying the Message Inside the Walls" and "Where Do I Go from Here?" (the latter for alcoholics leaving treatment facilities).

Among the bulletin boards were two on non-English literature, four on the Grapevine, the Flow Chart of a Conference committee action (see p. 57), and the "Who Makes Up the Conference?" sketch, plus displays on G.S.O. bulletins, P.I.-C.P.C. material, books, directories, pamphlets, institutions and archival material, a chart of yearly A.A. growth, and a blowup of the inside spread of a new leaflet, "Circles of Love and Service," based on the G.S.O. filmstrip of the same title.

Lois Wilson, widow of A.A. co-founder Bill, entertained delegates and their wives at a reception at Stepping Stones, Bedford Hills, N.Y., Saturday afternoon. Chartered buses took the guests from the Hotel Roosevelt directly to the Wilson home and back.



Vital Subjects Opened Up for Discussion

Ranging from A (Anonymity) almost to Z ("Who Establishes Policy in A.A.?"), sixteen topics were subjects of Conference consideration in presentation/discussion sessions, workshops, and special reports. Summaries follow.

Let's carry the A.A. message

Four panelists opened the first presentation/discussion, moderated by Jerry Danzig, general service trustee and chairperson of the trustees' Public Information Committee.

... Through public information

Creation and distribution of TV public service spot announcements highlighted our area's 1976-77 program. An experimental program of concentrated P.I. effort directed at the medical profession is also under way. Here is a brief summary of these projects.

First, we learned from a district P.I. chairperson and from TV station managers that 60-second public service spots were too long and plentiful. They compete with all other service organizations for limited spot availabilities. Spots running ten, 20, and 30 seconds would have much greater opportunity to be used and would be welcomed by stations. With the help of a friendly advertising agency, we worked up visual ideas and polished voice copy for three, one of each length. The costs of live models were avoided by using wash drawings in color, depicting the alcoholic executive, housewife, teenager, factory worker, etc. This also enabled us to conform to our anonymity Tradition. Costs for the spots came to approximately \$600.

Distribution to TV stations in the area was accomplished in 90 days by rotating two copies of the master tape to local P.I. committees in major cities. Major stations would, without charge, make a duplicate 2" tape of the three spots and return the master to us. For smaller stations, we arranged for the large network station to make duplicates on 3/4" cassettes used by smaller outlets. The only cost to us was purchasing the cassettes, approximately \$15 each. Every major network station in the area has used our spots, some in prime-time slots. A few stations are still showing them.

Last fall, our area was asked by the trustees' P.I. Committee to undertake a pilot project with the medical profession, an effort to reach out to the medical community and to "sponsor" doctors—to achieve better understanding of Alcoholics Anonymous as a referral resource. The first thing we learned was that doctors did not want to be "sponsored." But they felt they were poorly informed, and would welcome brief information on what A.A. can and cannot do to assist the doctor.

Our initial effort in this project is a mailing to some 4,000 M.D.'s, osteopaths, psychiatrists, and psychologists. The covering letter stresses the unique position of the doctor in confronting the alcoholic at the time of crisis, and motivating the alcoholic to seek help. The letter is accompanied by a specially developed "Fact Sheet for Doctors," "Is A.A. for You?," "A.A.—a Community Resource," and a stamped return envelope for the physician to request contact from an A.A. member and/or ask for additional literature.

Subsequent efforts will include appearances by A.A. members

at local medical society meetings and informational contacts with hospital administrators, their staffs, and nursing groups. Our ultimate goal is to have all A.A. members approach their family doctors, acknowledge their membership, and offer their personal services for referrals.

Barbara Scharla-Nielsen (Northern Florida)

Advisory Actions on public information: p. 48-49

... Through cooperation with the professional community

One of our D.C.M.'s managed to get together people from the treatment facilities in our area. The first meeting was at one of the facilities. He also set up our committee, composed of our regional trustee, our D.C.M., our central office secretary, and me. We felt that by keeping the committee small, more rapport could be established.

We met once a month, at a different treatment center each time. Conversation was lively, with many questions about application of our Traditions. We tried to give the facility people all the help we could, as well as literature from G.S.O. aimed at professionals—to let them know how we can and cannot help.

There was the question of dual addicts. Some facilities automatically sent addicts to A.A., even though their problem wasn't alcohol. This created difficulties in some groups, but when they were referred to Bill's pamphlet on the subject ("Problems Other Than Alcohol"), things calmed down. Finally, Narcotics Anonymous offered its help, and there are now several groups active, with plans for more. Many dually addicted people feel more at home in these groups; others, in our Fellowship.

Our C.P.C. meetings are now quarterly, as there is less need. We still try to keep professionals up-to-date on A.A.

Another idea is more sponsors for people leaving treatment. Having someone take over when a person leaves treatment helps to insure recovery.

At the 107th Congress of Corrections in Milwaukee last year, I was asked to put together a committee to man our A.A. display booth. The chance to talk with people who came to our booth had to be the greatest. I was really impressed by the knowledge they had of A.A., and the respect they showed for our program. Meeting someone from each institution in our state gave me a chance to clear up misunderstanding about literature distribution; we have a fund for this purpose.

Offering our services to the professional can be really rewarding. Informing your doctor and lawyer of your recovery can lead to many new members for our Fellowship.

John Gans (Southern Wisconsin)

... In treatment facilities

Many treatment facilities in Connecticut have A.A. groups, self-supporting and aware of help available from our Institu-

tions Committee. But what of the facility that has no meeting? Or has a meeting that is not able to support itself? How do these people find A.A.? This is where our Treatment Facilities Committee steps in.

The committee, which has a representative from each district, starts and supports meetings when requested. Distribution of meeting schedules is handled by the state committee. Distribution of Conference-approved literature this year was budgeted at \$2,200. The committee has a list of A.A.'s willing to go into facilities and talk to people one-to-one, to introduce them to outside A.A.'s when released, and to sponsor them. We try to get the cooperation of the facility staff by getting P.I. and C.P.C. people involved.

At each month's district meeting, a vital part of the agenda is getting groups to cover speaker commitments for all facility meetings wanting this service. Any problem or need for additional support can be readily handled, because all interested groups in the area share in solving the problem.

Robert Gilman (Connecticut)

Advisory Actions related to two foregoing topics: 11 (p. 47), 54 (p. 49)

... Into the jails and prisons

For over 25 years now, I have watched A.A. members carrying the message to prisoners in jails and prisons, and also twelfth-stepping ex-offenders as they return to your communities. Increasing numbers of ex-offenders participate in this effort, but the greatest number continues to be non-ex-offenders, or "Square Johns." Two questions asked are: "How can I relate to these people? What can I offer them?"

First, you have suffered their experience of alcoholism—a common bond and basis of communication for which there is no substitute, even with the most professionally trained counselors or doctors. And when you go to an institution group, you are a living, walking, talking example of the hope vital to their survival in the institutional setting. You bring prisoners what no other person can—your individual and unique message of your sobriety.

For too many prisoners, you are the only real contact with the free world, and your acceptance of them as persons is the only expression of love they have ever experienced. You are testimony that support can come from others, and that true help is constantly available from a Power greater than ourselves. Your willingness to share the tragedy and the human comedy that mark the road to sobriety provides, many times, the only way prisoners ever have to look at themselves honestly. One of the most sorely missed necessities of life in jail and prison is healthy humor and its resulting laughter, especially the ability to laugh at oneself.

Don't ever worry about the so-called differences between you and the men and women in jail or prison. Many times, the only real difference between you and me and our prisoners is the fact that they got caught. If you are a good listener, you will learn there are some drunks in jails and prisons who have much to offer you and me in their efforts to become sober.

The greatest test both for the prisoner and for you is the day of

release. Too many prisoners leave us without the love and support of a family; too many, without even a responsible friend to greet them. For every prisoner willing to accept A.A., this should be changed. Rewarding Twelfth Step work awaits you every day a prisoner is released. While in jail or prison, people can accept intellectually your loving invitation to stay with the program after release, but they still harbor within themselves great apprehension about acceptance in your free-world group.

Your willingness to meet that ex-offender the day of release and take him to the first meeting is essential. It goes without saying, if they don't make the first meeting, they'll never make the second or any others.

For those of you who have not experienced this challenging and sometimes frustrating Twelfth Step work: You are cheating yourselves of one of the most rewarding parts of sobriety. Those with the greatest fears about this kind of work are probably the very ones who have the most to offer. I know of no other group than prisoners in greater need of what you have to give—love, sobriety, life itself in many cases. Think about it.

*W. J. Estelle Jr., chairperson,
trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee*

Advisory Actions related to foregoing topic: 12, 13 (p. 47)

The Twelve Traditions—'Why it works'

Mike Rainbolt, Southwest U.S. regional trustee, moderated the panel on the Traditions.

Traditions One, Two, Three, Four

On April 2, 1840, a man said to five men with whom he was drinking, "Let's form our own temperance society." That was the birth of the Washingtonians. By the late 1840's, it had over 400,000 members. By 1850, the movement was dead.

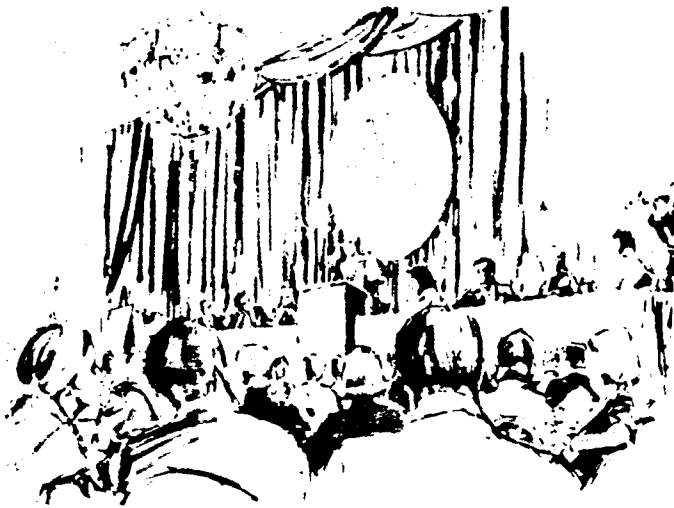
What blew this group apart? (1) Its members were flamboyantly public; (2) they collected money from all sources and had much internal friction over financial problems; (3) they split into fragments by getting involved in political, social, and religious issues.

Tradition One: "Our common welfare should come first; personal recovery depends upon A.A. unity."

We become whole as individuals through group unity. A power greater than myself, given to me by the group, enabled me to do what I could not do by myself. The love and concern for my welfare, the personal attention I receive and try to give to others—all these safeguard individuality. I know "our common welfare should come first" if I am to maintain any personal recovery.

Tradition Two: "For our group purpose there is but one ultimate authority — a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience. Our leaders are but trusted servants; they do not govern."

Our trusted servants are, for the most part, excellent leaders. Their aim is the same as yours, mine, and the group's—to carry



the message. Ideally, leaders become "elder statesmen." But I am amazed at the short length of time it takes for "bleeding deacons" to surface.

Tradition Three: "The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking."

We cannot refuse any who desire to get sober. Membership does not depend on conformity.

Another fellow and I twelfth-stepped a sick alcoholic over three years. There were trying and tolerance-stretching times. We didn't see him for about seven months; then he started coming back. He had been sober six months. Under our watchful eyes, he'd never had more than three weeks. That was about seven years ago. He is still sober. The program comes to us in different ways. Our friend had that one requirement for membership deep within him during those years we squired him around. But he became a member when *he* said so.

Tradition Four: "Each group should be autonomous except in matters affecting other groups or A.A. as a whole."

How can any society with such freedom and lack of rules continue to function? We adhere to principles that guarantee our survival. Ego-driven individuals we may be, but we have irrevocable bonds through a Power greater than ourselves and a desire to stay sober.

Bob Hawkes (Louisiana)

Traditions Five, Six, Seven, Eight

Tradition Five: "Each group has but one primary purpose—to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers."

In service and in meetings, do we sometimes lose sight of our primary purpose, our common responsibility?

Tradition Six: "An A.A. group ought never endorse, finance, or lend the A.A. name to any related facility or outside enterprise, lest problems of money, property, and prestige divert us from our primary purpose."

Affiliation or activities that would harm A.A. as a whole are the major danger areas. But our course has been charted and the hazards clearly marked. If we steer clear of them, we should have smooth sailing.

Tradition Seven: "Every A.A. group ought to be fully self-supporting, declining outside contributions."

In every case, the responsibility comes back to us, the individual members, for we *are* Alcoholics Anonymous.

Tradition Eight: "Alcoholics Anonymous should remain forever nonprofessional, but our service centers may employ special workers."

It became clear to our early members that no A.A. should ever ask or accept payment for carrying the message. They also perceived the work necessary to make carrying the message possible. We all should know the difference.

Bill W. wrote in "A.A. Comes of Age": "Like other societies, we soon found that there were forces among us that could threaten in ways that alcohol and sex could not. These were the desires for power, for domination, for glory, and for money. . . . True brotherhood, harmony, and love, fortified by clear insights and right practices, are the only answers. And the purpose of A.A.'s traditional principles is to bring these forces to the top and keep them there."

Tom Dougherty (Chicago)

Traditions Nine, Ten, Eleven, Twelve

Tradition Nine: "A.A., as such, ought never be organized; but we may create service boards or committees directly responsible to those they serve."

How can we have an unorganized movement and at the same time create a service organization? As the "Twelve and Twelve" points out, neither the Conference, the board, nor the simplest group committee can issue a single directive to an A.A. member and make it stick.

Such lack of direction could lead to anarchy. But there is an unusual condition in A.A.: Unless each member follows the Steps, he fails; unless there is conformity to the Traditions, the group deteriorates. So we of A.A. do obey spiritual principles. In the spirit of service, we elect boards and committees that embody a deep spirituality in their operation.

Tradition Ten: "Alcoholics Anonymous has no opinion on outside issues; hence the A.A. name ought never be drawn into public controversy."

Members who have become responsible citizens are not going to back away from the responsibility to act as they see right. But we do not enter into public controversy *as A.A.'s*, because our Fellowship will perish if we do.

Tradition Eleven: "Our public relations policy is based on attraction rather than promotion; we need always maintain personal anonymity at the level of press, radio, and films."

As the folder "Understanding Anonymity" explains, many of

us confuse the meaning of the word "anonymity" with the anonymity *Tradition*. They are quite different. There has never been a single word in the Traditions against the use of one's own full name within the Fellowship, or on a one-to-one basis outside.

But at the level of press, radio, films, and TV, anonymity is the greatest protection our Society can ever have. We have learned to publicize our principles, not individual members. This is the dividing line between "attraction" and "promotion."

Tradition Twelve: "Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions, ever reminding us to place principles before personalities."

Placing "principles before personalities" is not difficult when dealing with another member. However, the spiritual significance of this Tradition, to me, means placing principles before *my own* personality. That way, no individual member is stronger or weaker than the group or the Fellowship as a whole; and no A.A. group, nor A.A. as a whole, need feel dependent upon any one person.

So the Twelfth Tradition is *why* it works. May God grant that it always shall be so.

Dean Kirkham (Northern Coastal California)

Relocation of the General Service Office

Some noneconomic considerations

The report of the Office Relocation Study Committee shows the substantial savings that would result from placing G.S.O. in a more central location. But A.A. has never been guided solely by financial considerations, nor should we be. Let's look at the noneconomic arguments against relocation.

The committee reports that A.A. visitors tour G.S.O. when visiting New York. Are we operating G.S.O. for the benefit of A.A.—or A.A. tourists?

I take more seriously the objection that relocation would result in the resignation of capable and experienced staff members. That is probably a fact, and would be a real loss. But we are losing them anyway. From 1960 through this year, there have been 21 staff members. The average length of service was seven years. Of the present members, only two have served more than ten years. The others have been here from one to six. We have lost seven staff members in the past five years. [Editors' note: Four reached retirement age, or their husbands did. The other three work elsewhere in New York City.]

There exists in A.A. a psychological gulf between the rank and file of A.A. members in the U.S. and Canada on the one hand, and our "New York Establishment" on the other. Relocation would go a long way toward overcoming resistance to general service based on the built-in bias against New York and the "Wall Street - Madison Avenue - Eastern Establishment" image where it exists, as the study committee said.

New York is equally mistrustful. The report exhibits grave doubt that the "character and composition of the G.S.O. staff,

service boards, and committees" could continue to be of the same high quality if they were recruited anywhere but New York. No hicks from the sticks need apply. There are millions of people who do not want to live in New York. It is conceivable that a dozen or so of them might fulfill every requirement for long-term G.S.O. employment except one—that they must live in New York.

The last noneconomic argument expresses anxiety that A.A. members elsewhere would create disunity, introduce politics, and interfere with the office, as the Southeastern New York Area and the Northeast Region do not. The compiler of the report cannot prove that these convictions are well founded. No one can prove they are not, until the experiment is tried.

Most major developments in the service structure of A.A. have been efforts to bridge this gulf. Isn't that why we delegates are here, representing the thousands of groups in the U.S. and Canada? Bill and Dr. Bob saw the importance of keeping A.A. authority at the group level, rather than in a board of directors and a service office.

The addition of regional trustees to our A.A.W.S. Board of Directors was to insure that all sections of the U.S. and Canada would have a voice in the decisions, and prevent domination by one geographical sector.

The purposes of regional forums are: to provide better communications between the board and grass-roots A.A.; to provide the board with an opportunity of "taking the pulse of A.A." personally; and to demonstrate to A.A.'s everywhere that the only purpose or interest of the board is to carry the message of recovery to alcoholics everywhere.

Each of these developments has been a powerful strengthening force for A.A. I suggest that the logical next step is removal of G.S.O. from the East Coast, into the grass roots our office and board try so hard to keep in touch with. I believe the gulf will not be closed until we do.

Elizabeth H. Erhard (Oklahoma)

Floor Action related to foregoing topic: 2 (pp. 46-47)

How and why A.A. grows

'The continuing miracle'

The group is where it happens. "I got drunk, but we stay sober." That's why it's tremendously exciting to see that in 1977, 2,595 new groups in the U.S. and Canada asked to be listed at G.S.O. During the same period, 1,337 groups became inactive. For comparison, in 1976, 2,175 new groups formed; 1,020 fell by the wayside.

A.A. is growing. Not only did it increase by 1,258 groups (net) in 1977, but many existing groups are bursting at the seams with new members. One group has four members with flashlight batons directing the parking of cars in a huge parking lot, and inside the meeting place coffee is served at six stations dotted around the big hall.

A.A. is also evolving. Our program of recovery remains un-

changed, and the language of the heart is the same in any meeting, anywhere in the world. But the number and variety of groups and meetings are astonishing.

All that is needed for a new A.A. group is a resentment and a coffeepot. A healthy group often grows until it becomes unwieldy, participation of members becomes difficult, or it outgrows its quarters. Then, by agreement, it may divide into two groups. A new group may also be started to meet a need for a new *time* for a meeting: Saturday night, lunchtime, or after work. A new group may start to meet the need for a new *place*: Grand Central Station, Kennedy Airport, or the South Pole. Groups formed in the suburbs reflect shifts in the general population.

A new group may start because a new *kind* of meeting is wanted: Step, beginners, Big Book, workshop, Eleventh Step. Finally, alcoholics may band together because of some additional commonality: in men's groups, women's, young people's, gays', "slippers", doctors', lawyers', priests', sailors'. Commercial airline pilots and other flight personnel meet at airports and call themselves "Birds of a Feather."

Some dedicated and sincere A.A. members deplore these so-called special-interest groups as being divisive, a threat to A.A. unity. Yet some kinds of special-interest groups have been with us almost as long as A.A. has existed. In Tradition Four in the "Twelve and Twelve," Bill W. says, "very simply . . . every A.A. group can manage its affairs exactly as it pleases, except when A.A. as a whole is threatened." What incredible freedom we enjoy in A.A.! No wonder groups are proliferating!

Where A.A. is strongest and most populous, it tends to grow stronger, faster; conversely, where there are fewer groups and A.A.'s are not as numerous, growth is much slower and harder. For example, in 1976, Minnesota reported 556 groups. In 1977, it added 81 new groups. California, with 2,454 groups in 1976, added 366 new groups last year. The province of Quebec, with 834, added 142. But a state that had only 72 groups in 1976 added eight in 1977. Two other states, with 73 and 60 respectively, were able to add only 14 groups between them.

This pattern is probably inherent in an organization that grows only on a one-to-one basis. Where members are few, there are just not that many people to make Twelfth Step calls. A.A. is not visible and available enough to attract prospects. In other localities, exploding with new A.A. meetings, teeming with members, enthusiasm and spirit run high; twelfth-steppers are running around like ants on a hot hill; and the poor drunk can't turn around without running into a friend who has found this new way of life.

Other factors have worked to encourage A.A. growth in the past five to seven years. Perhaps the most significant has been the proliferation of rehabilitation programs and treatment centers. Adding to the momentum have been court programs for drunk-driving offenders, industrial programs for employees, and armed services alcoholism programs. With growth have come growing pains. Groups in the vicinity of treatment centers have been inundated with busloads of patients. Young people bring with them other addictions, explicit language, and free discussion of sex. Court-referred drunk-driving offenders want attendance slips signed. These and a thousand other problems have strained A.A. unity and rocked the serenity of many an oldtimer.

The continuing miracle is that A.A. weathers every storm and flourishes. One reason is that it is girded about by the Traditions. Another is that our service structure—loose, anarchistic, based on responsibility rather than authority—seems to resist change at the core but to be amazingly resilient to temporary tempests that might tear apart other organizations.

But the main reason A.A. flourishes, I believe, is simply that it works. Sick people get well here. "Don't drink, and go to meetings, and you'll get better," my sponsor told me. Today, there are more meetings to go to, and a wider variety to choose from, but when the newcomer gets there, he finds exactly the same recovery program, the same Twelve Steps, the same understanding and love and caring that I found and that every drunk has found in A.A. for 43 years.

Bob Pearson, general manager, G.S.O.

Who establishes policy in A.A.? You, that's who

Bob Britt, Panel 27 delegate (Virginia), presided for the discussion of this topic. Summaries of the panelists' talks follow.

Self-support: dollars and sense

Webster defines policy as prudence or wisdom in the management of affairs. Prudence is defined as the ability to discipline oneself by use of reason. We use the Steps to discipline ourselves individually; collectively, we use the Traditions to discipline the group. Wisdom, on the other hand, means sense. I should like to link that word with "dollars." Dollars and sense—a good pair to use when talking about self-support.

Self-support implies more than just financial self-sufficiency. We have often heard from the podium: "But most devastating of all was my loss of self-respect." Would it not be devastating to A.A. if it were to lose self-respect and self-determination because it was not self-supporting?

Years ago, I was treasurer of our intergroup. My problem was that there was no treasury—about \$40, as I recall. The pressing problem was our need for meeting lists. We had just a few, out-of-date, with half the groups not listed. Now, one group in the area had all the money. At our next meeting, their representative came forth with a solution: Three or four of their members would foot the bill. You could hear sighs of relief.

However, some of us remembered our Traditions and had the gall to say this wasn't wise. Our rescuers had suggestions as to how the job should be done, and if they paid for it, they could call the shots. Well, when the smoke cleared, our policy of self-support prevailed. The meeting-list booklet got published—economically, you might say (not in the style wanted)—but it served us well.

Last year, a member called me to say intergroup was accepting outside contributions. Would I please speak to the people at that office, since they had turned a deaf ear to his protests? So, just "happening by" one night when their executive committee was in session, I asked them about it. "Oh yes," said one member, "but it was only \$50."

"Only \$50," said I. "What if it had been 500 or 5,000?"

"Oh, that would be different."

"How would it be different?" I asked. Silence. Looks were exchanged. Someone commented it was too late to do anything about it, since the money had been deposited. That was followed by a comment that the money could be returned with a letter explaining our Tradition of self-support. Later, the situation was explained to intergroup representatives, and the money was returned.

What is disturbing is that so many of our members are unfamiliar with our policies. This policy, like every other in our Traditions, was established by us, the members. Have you ever received a letter from G.S.O. telling you what your policy should be in a certain situation? No. What you did receive was the shared experience of other areas whose group conscience had solved similar problems. G.S.O. does not establish policy. You do. That's who.

John Waterfield, Northeast U.S. regional trustee

Advisory Actions on finance: p. 47

Some of us enjoy arguing obscure points

"Cooperation but not affiliation" is often misinterpreted. In the dictionary, I found the following definitions:

Cooperation: working together; uniting in producing a result; common effort. Affiliation: close association with another, typically in a dependent or subordinate position.

This clarifies the difference and reveals the reason A.A. took the option of cooperation. To be placed in a dependent and/or subordinate position would be disastrous and untenable for A.A. as a whole, for the A.A. group, and for the A.A. member; problems of money, prestige, "boss-ism," power plays, among many others leading to controversy both public and private, would result from affiliation.

But cooperation? In "Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends," Bill W. states: "We can accomplish together what we could never accomplish separately or in rivalry." In this spirit, always within the framework of our Traditions, A.A. cooperates with outside agencies and facilities. In the early days of our Fellowship, members of the medical profession, the clergy, the news media, the legal and banking communities, and many others cooperated with the founders by sharing their expertise in the formulation of A.A. itself. So this principle is a two-way street. Where would A.A. have been without the efforts and wisdom of involved nonalcoholics?

The old pamphlet "Cooperation but Not Affiliation" answered, "Without their help, many of us would not be alive today." My own story supports this declaration. I was totally unaware that I had become an alcoholic. It did not occur to me that I needed help, nor was I about to ask for any, certainly not from that bunch of drunks who called themselves A.A. Had it not been for my doctor, who knew of an alcoholism recovery unit in the state hospital, I would have continued to commit polite suicide. As it was, however, I was fortunate enough to find myself in a program whose basis was the Twelve Steps, interpreted by A.A. members who had become professional counselors. The staff also numbered nonalcoholics—a psychiatrist

well-versed in the A.A. program, a clergyman familiar with things spiritual, a social worker, and nurses selected for their training and empathy. Our local intergroup provided speakers for a weekly A.A. meeting. In this manner, A.A. came to me.

This experience has been shared by hundreds, perhaps thousands, of alcoholics. The hospital did its thing, A.A. did its thing, and I needed both things in order to recover.

Available A.A. literature on this subject includes the Traditions, "A.A. Comes of Age," several of our Guidelines from G.S.O., and pamphlets. With so much material at hand, it seems ludicrous that more advantage is not taken of the information provided. But perhaps some of us enjoy arguing points that remain obscure to us—an elected, not a necessary, obscurity, I might add. Meanwhile, let us bear in mind the definition of "cooperation." Our "common effort" is help for the alcoholic, and who should know better than we how vital that is?

Lenore V. Jefferson (Eastern Pennsylvania)

Advisory Actions related to foregoing topic: 11 (p. 47), 54 (p. 49)

Third Tradition: Who can be a member?

Alcoholism is an equal-opportunity disease, and A.A. is an equal-opportunity fellowship, our Third Tradition says. A person becomes a member of A.A. upon deciding that he or she is a member, and remains a member as long as he or she wants to. Neither race, color, sex, age, religion, nor any other identifying characteristic has an effect. The foreword to the first edition of the Big Book states that "the only requirement for membership is an honest desire to stop drinking." The foreword to the second edition states "that no alcoholic man or woman could be excluded from our Society." Our Twelfth Concept and particularly our Fifth and Sixth Warranties point out that no person can be expelled from A.A.

A.A. was founded and is designed to help the alcoholic deal with the disease of alcoholism. In this narrow area of living, our Fellowship has expertise that is unequaled by any other source. We do not, however, have expertise with other problem areas that affect people. Nor are we, as a fellowship, expert in helping alcoholics with problems other than alcoholism. When we try, we will most probably fail. Our success with alcoholism does not give us authority to practice medicine or law without a license.

When people decide they are A.A. members, they also assume the responsibility of membership. This includes adherence to, protection of, and perpetuation of the Traditions and Concepts.

My number one problem is alcoholism. It will continue to be. I have many other problems, and these rotate in and out of my number two problem slot. I do not view with alarm persons who come to A.A. with dual problems. In fact, if they are as I am, they have not only dual problems, but also triple, quadruple, and so on. What I do view with alarm is the occasion when we forget, when we replace alcoholism with some other problem in the number one spot. We are then in peril, both as individuals and as a fellowship.

So what do we do? In my judgment, we accept our responsibility

ity as members, concentrate on alcoholism, and expect other members to do the same. We adhere to the Traditions and Concepts, and we expect other members to do the same.

We view with alarm those instances when problems other than alcohol are discussed at A.A. meetings. We express our concern to those involved, and we share with them our reasons. When necessary, we go to the group conscience with our concern, and express our beliefs.

What we must do, in addition, is to advise all that we are involved with alcoholism and cannot become involved with other problems. When someone persists in this area, we must, as our conscience dictates, resist to the maximum extent. To best express my feeling: It's as if we in A.A. made an agreement with the banks and bankers. If they won't make Twelfth Step calls, we won't cash checks.

Vic Blair (Hawaii)

The role of the general service trustee—U.S./Canada

Two panelists sparked this discussion with thought-provoking remarks, summarized below.

'This is not a congress nor a parliament'

This could be opening up an old problem that many of us would prefer to see stay settled. I don't think it is up to any of us to second-guess those who, while settling the ratio problem, fixed the total number of trustees at 21.

I see nothing wrong with the makeup of the board. Surely, when a person is elected to it, he or she can be looked upon in a mature way, and no one is considered a "super-anything." If I am disturbed by another human being's "importance," the problem lies within me. The "Twelve and Twelve" says, "It is a spiritual axiom that every time we are disturbed, . . . there is something wrong *with us*."

Once elected, every trustee is to serve as the board decides, with no contest or competition. Therefore, the only difference is the method of election. The election process enables us to elect new trustees with whatever qualifications may be needed. I believe that a problem is created when we interpret a "business or professional" qualification to include "sex and age." Time will take care of the balance needed. In any event, we must remember that in all of our Conference structure, we are never *representative*. This is not a congress nor a parliament. Once elected, we all serve the Fellowship *as a whole*, not just one area or region.

Just as a group contributes money for general service, it contributes people to serve. We are all part of that "people contribution." That is *all* we are.

Perhaps a committee erred. Perhaps there was a misinterpretation. Does that mean we have to rewrite "The A.A. Service Manual" or revamp our board structure? I think not. The future may require change, and we should be alert to changing needs. But in my opinion, for now, we are where we should be. The A.A. program is spiritual. To recover, we must experience a spiritual change. Those on the outside cannot really under-

stand unless it happens to them. In the same sense, it is impossible to describe the spirit that exists within the board. It is a very special thing, an awareness of something different from any other life experience. The board today is good, serving this Fellowship as it should.

The greatest blessing I will ever receive, the highest honor ever bestowed, is the right to walk through the doorway of my own group, take a chair in the back of the room, and share with my fellow A.A.'s to solve our common problem.

*Mac Cheater, general service trustee—Canada
(now termed trustee-at-large)*

'Leadership qualities . . . grasp of A.A. service'

When there is a need for a particular professional or business background, the General Service Board should make such a request. If the board listed a specific background for a vacancy, then the general service trustee should match as closely as possible. He or she should also have leadership qualities and a grasp of A.A. service.

When the last two vacancies occurred, the board apparently felt no need for any particular background, but it said there would no longer be a woman serving on the board. This caused some heated remarks. I would hardly want the board to go without a specialized skill just because a woman might not be available. If a skill is not required, then many men and women in the Fellowship could fill that role.

Let us assume for a minute there never will be a need for a specific background when selecting general service trustees. Then what we have are "at large" trustees, whose desired qualifications are not unlike those of a regional trustee. If that were the case, would one region in the U.S. and one in Canada have two trustees bringing regional points of view to the board? Would other regions feel slighted? (I know that all trustees represent the Fellowship as a whole.)

As long as no "specifications" are made for a vacancy, then I feel the Fellowship would be better served with two additional regional trustees. There is nothing that says we cannot change the number of regions, while the Fellowship is continually growing. We are continually redistricting within our areas so we may serve groups better. Perhaps if regions were a little smaller, a regional trustee would have a better opportunity to familiarize himself or herself with the areas. Also, the membership would have a better opportunity to know its General Service Board.

In summation, I feel the general service trustee—United States/Canada should be a conduit for expertise the board requires. It may be someone with background in public relations, law, medicine, teaching, business, etc. But if the board fills these needs with Class A and "in town" trustees, then I feel the roles of "at large" trustees would be better served by additional regional trustees. I would like to see the Conference consider restructuring the regions to accommodate additional ones.

Dick Sutherland (Southern California)

Floor Action related to foregoing topic: 1 (p. 46)
Advisory Action: 56 (p. 49)

International Convention

More daytime sessions planned for 1980

The 45th Anniversary International Convention of Alcoholics Anonymous will be held in New Orleans on the July 4th weekend, 1980.

All major meetings will be held in the Superdome, which seats a maximum of 70,000 people (in the configuration we plan to use, 35,000). Closed-circuit TV hung from the ceiling will give a close-up view of speakers and performers on the stage. Four quadrants in the Superdome, holding a total of 7,500 to 8,000, can be broken into rooms of various sizes, where we plan to hold workshops and panels. Hotel ballroom space will be used during the day and at midnight.

Our goal is to provide many more daytime meetings than in Denver. This will, of course, necessitate more speakers. Our service structure will be responsible for the alkathon speaker selection. The G.S.O. staff will select speakers for workshops, panels, and special-event meetings. No A.A. member who is not registered may be selected.

We have 10,000 committed hotel rooms, and dormitory space at Tulane University to house 1,200. Additional space will be picked up in outlying districts. Registration forms will be available in the fall of 1979, and we advise early registration. Headquarters hotel will be the Hyatt Regency, connected by a walking bridge to the Superdome.

Dede Hoffmann has been appointed Host Committee chairperson. Some members of the G.S.O. Planning Committee visited New Orleans in December, for a dinner to raise funds for the Host Committee. Over 200 Louisiana A.A. members attended. We were all impressed with the enthusiasm demonstrated for the enormous task ahead, and we returned to New York with renewed confidence that the 1980 International will be the biggest and best A.A. Convention ever held.

Betty Liddle, G.S.O. staff

Enthusiasm grows for New Orleans event

At every meeting I attend throughout Louisiana, excitement about the 1980 International Convention is growing. Every district will select a 1980 Convention coordinator. So far as possible, all requests for information or suggestions offered in each district will be given to the coordinator and handled through the Host Committee in New Orleans. This committee is already working hard. With the cooperation of the experienced G.S.O. staff, everything will be as conveniently organized as possible.

Mardi Gras town is the best-equipped Fun City of them all. There is the one and only French Quarter, and there is the Superdome, which will be fully utilized. The choice of world-famous places to eat is fantastic. New Orleans is the home of Dixieland jazz, still being played as it has been for many years on old Bourbon Street. Surely, any alcoholic can identify with that street and admit it has character!

But this Convention belongs to A.A.'s of the world. We are looking forward to it as the greatest learning experience of our

lives. We hope everyone will find a renewed desire to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. We know that all of us will grow as we experience this added unity of purpose, and we feel the impetus will influence our A.A. activities long after 1980.

Bob Hawkes (Louisiana)



A.A. regional forums

Informal service gatherings held in various parts of the U.S. and Canada were the subject of widespread, approving discussion after three participants shared their experience with regional forums, summarized below.

From skeptic to booster

My attitude was dubious when the idea of regional forums first arose:

"What will the area think of the staff, the delegates, the trustees?"

"Will a forum really improve communication at all levels of service?"

"Won't it be costly?"

"Shouldn't the money be used to send free literature to prisons and hospitals instead?"

"Will it bring us closer together?"

"Will a forum interest more A.A. members in service work?"

After the first forum, the staff listened to all the tapes, and my attitude became more positive. Then I attended my first forum as an observer and aide. My conversion took place. I was enthusiastic — just like everyone else!

In Chicago, Ottawa, and Amarillo, I discovered that a regional forum is tremendously beautiful sharing. It is an open and honest and up-front service session. It works — as A.A. works! At these service weekends, feelings are expressed, questions are answered, and sharing and communication take place. If each participant could bring a new person interested in service to a regional forum, more A.A.'s would know about G.S.R. work, trustee work, D.C.M. work, and staff work, and P.I., C.P.C., and institutions work. Financial trouble spots could be

aired; complaints about G.S.O. could be aired; and area problems could be shared.

For example, let me quote from some forum reports:

- One member, 20 years in the program, said to his group chairperson following the forum, "I never have been a G.S.R. How do you get to be one?"
- "It doesn't matter how we serve. What matters is that we do serve."
- "I have been recharged. I was dragged to the forum and didn't expect to get anything out of it. Now I'm going home with a precious gift — understanding more about myself and more about A.A. and how it works. I've changed."
- Dr. Jack said, "There's no question that can't be answered if we trust each other and will be trustworthy."

Perhaps these quotes catch the spirit of forum activity, but the best way is to attend one. We hope the regional forums will continue, to provide more service to all who are powerless over alcohol and seek help.

Susan Daly, G.S.O. staff

Our office, not that office

The East Central Region held its first regional forum Memorial Day weekend 1977. We had approximately 225 people—exceptional for our region. Those from out-of-state remained the entire weekend, while those from surrounding areas commuted. On Sunday morning, about 25 people arrived who had not registered. They had learned by word of mouth how exciting it was to share this experience and the opportunity to meet Dr. Norris and our G.S.O. staff.

The meeting room was set up just as it is here now, with microphones in the middle and on each side. If you stretched your imagination, you could have been sitting at the Conference.

Of course, the real reason behind the forums is to improve communication between local members and G.S.O., to dispel the feeling that it is *that* office, instead of *our* office. The forum did just that.

In the last two years, we in Wisconsin have adopted procedures in "The A.A. Service Manual." Quarterly D.C.M. meetings and G.S.R. workshops are popping up in areas that never showed interest before. However, many areas had these right along.

The idea that we are the only region with this or that problem is slowly disappearing, because of the forum. Members are not hesitant about writing our General Service Office any more. We know G.S.O. people understand that our concerns are theirs.

Some of us remember when merely the mention of service drew no interest. Now, members volunteer—asking how they can serve. Our first suggestion is "Read 'The A.A. Service Manual' and 'A.A. Comes of Age.'" Unless you are ready to give the necessary time, you should not take a service job. If you don't have time to fulfill your commitment, you can seek out other ways to serve.

Sobriety is our most treasured possession, and without quality, quantity means nothing. Time instills in us a realization of what

we need to attain a more gratifying life, and of what we must do, how far we must reach, to accomplish this. Our P.I., C.P.C., literature, correctional facilities, and Grapevine committees all need service workers. There is a place for all of us, and if you don't try, you'll never know the joy of sharing.

Regional forums are a source of sharing and in no way take the place of this Conference. There may be suggestions from a forum to pass on to a delegate or trustee. Sharing is caring, and loving is service. Service is gratitude in action.

Often, when I have my quiet time, I marvel at the great gift God has bestowed on me—a spiritual life through our Fellowship, in contact with a loving God who allows me to do His work through people.

Virginia Hallman, East Central U.S. regional trustee

'See the effects in happy faces'

Reports on regional forums do not constitute actions or recommendations to the board or Conference. Such actions and recommendations, of course, are made through the Conference, A.A.'s policy- and decision-making body.

It was my pleasure to attend the Eastern Canada Regional Forum in Ottawa, Ont., last October, a very successful one for the nearly 500 members who attended.

This was the first to be held in two languages. General sessions were simultaneously translated from English into French, and workshops were held in each language. The language barrier was, in fact, no barrier, because understanding and love—the language of the heart that is used in A.A.—overcome all barriers. In my own area (mainly French-speaking), the 60-odd who attended came back full of enthusiasm at the understanding and love they were able to share with members of other areas with another language. They, in turn, have been actively sharing their experiences with other members. We have also received a written report in French, to enable G.S.R.'s to transmit the feelings of the forum to members in the area.

I suggest to delegates that they make an effort to attend these forums, and they will see, as I have, the effects in happy faces of many sober A.A. members.

Gerry LaPointe (Northeastern Quebec)

World Service Meeting

Anywhere, in any language

The Fifth World Service Meeting will be held in Helsinki, Finland, October 5-7, 1978. The theme is "Recovery, Unity, and Service Worldwide." To carry the message to suffering alcoholics in their native language wherever in the world they may be, delegates from all over the world come together every two years and share experience, strength, and hope.

We expect 32 delegates from 19 countries and zones: Argentina, Australia, Belgium, Brazil, Central America (Northern and Southern Zones), Colombia, Finland, France, West Germany,

Ireland, Mexico, New Zealand, Norway, South Africa, Sweden, United Kingdom, United States, and Canada. Delegates from U.S./Canada are Virginia Hallman and (for a second term) Mac Cheater.

W.S.M. committees are: Agenda, Literature/Publishing, Policy/Admissions/Finance, and Working With Others.

There will be two workshops, on sponsorship and the Traditions. There will be a presentation and floor discussion on "Money in A.A. (the spiritual value of giving)." Public information work, within the framework of our Traditions, will also be discussed.

A W.S.M. Planning Committee (the general manager and five G.S.O. staff members) has been responsible for coordinating the agenda in cooperation with and subject to the approval of the General Service Office in Helsinki.

Three G.S.O. staff members will attend the meeting in Helsinki, along with our general manager, who will serve as co-chairperson. We look forward to this time of round-the-world sharing.

June Russell, G.S.O. staff

How our General Service Office serves us

General service trustee Ed Small moderated this presentation. Here are digests of the panelists' talks.

"Those characters from New York"

G.S.O. permeates nearly every segment of our life in the Fellowship. Counsel, guidance, and suggestions to individuals, to groups, districts, areas, and regions are always available to help resolve a question of any kind. G.S.O. lends a hand in planning a small district meeting involving only a few groups and stages an International Convention drawing nearly 20,000.

G.S.O. is geared to meet the needs of a membership of more than 1,000,000. Yet, moving through this huge volume of daily action, it maintains lifelines of letters to scattered Loners throughout the world. The flow of mail into G.S.O. is huge, with requests for guidance and answers to questions. G.S.O. is willing and able to counsel, but comes to a screeching halt when asked to give a definite answer—not because it cannot, but because doing so would violate long-established policy. Actions and opinions of individuals and groups through the years are preserved at G.S.O. to help us solve problems that face us today.

Planning, organizing, and staging the annual Conference is a major G.S.O. activity. Months before each annual Conference meeting, the staff member assigned to the Conference begins sending information and questionnaires to the delegates, who send back answers, new queries, and agenda suggestions. G.S.O. arranges the meeting site, delegates' housing, record-keeping, and other details, sums up proceedings in *Box 4-5-9*, covers them fully in the *Conference Report*.

Particularly valuable is G.S.O. activity in public information. The P.I. Kit, mailings to newspapers stressing anonymity, and recommendations to local P.I. groups are extremely helpful.

Already demonstrating their value are A.A. regional forums. Not the least of many benefits is the delightful widening of personal acquaintance among other A.A. members and G.S.O. personnel. Among many favorable comments was one made to me by a newcomer to service work: "It's nice to know those characters from New York are just plain nice people."

New pieces of A.A. literature may be designed to reach the public with the A.A. message or may be directed to segments of the A.A. family. Suggestions for new ones and remakes of older ones reach the Literature Committee regularly. Scrupulous care is taken in developing and designing their appearance and the validity of their editorial content. Each is reviewed and reviewed again. A year or more is likely to pass before the finished piece appears. But when it does, it forms another part of the total image of A.A. The care that has been given it is well worth the effort. Prior to release for production, of course, each must be given Conference approval.

In the ways touched on here and in countless others, G.S.O., its people, its skills, its know-how, its archives, its publishing company, its everything combine their efforts to maintain my sobriety and that of hundreds of thousands of others.

Reed Edgar (Colorado)

Critics are needed to strengthen us

When I first walked into G.S.O. as a new delegate 20 years ago, what impressed me most was all the letters our staff members have to write every day—some of them to alcoholics still suffering, in my own area.

I have written many letters and made phone calls to our G.S.O. to get films, tapes, opinions, and especially help with problems at institutions. Every time, I received answers—sometimes not answers I wanted, but those best for our Fellowship.

I had to come up with information to satisfy the A.A. member who was anti-general-service. I was able, through G.S.O. help, to accept the fact that these critics are needed and add a lot to strengthen the Fellowship. I have discovered on the Literature Committee that all such information can be found in our own books and pamphlets, if we have them on hand to give people. G.S.O. has taught me how to say, "I don't know—but here is a piece of literature that will help you."

In describing G.S.O., the word "communication" keeps coming back to me. Through communication from G.S.O. to groups throughout the world, they are kept operating. And can you imagine arriving in New York for this Conference if G.S.O. had not arranged it?

At G.S.O., we have so many willing people dealing with people like you and me. Sometimes, I think we may expect just a little too much of our G.S.O. staff. I have many opportunities to visit G.S.O. and, on occasion, need some information. This is provided obligingly and always with a smile. I wish all members of A.A. could visit our G.S.O. to see for themselves the amount of work that goes on to carry the message, to keep us all informed, and with the help of a loving God, to keep A.A. alive through service to the still-suffering alcoholic.

Cec Corrigan, regional trustee (Western Canada)

'G.S.O. is a clearinghouse'

As I see it, G.S.O. is a word-processing center. And while it is much more than the sum of its parts, it *has* decidedly physical parts, substance, and structure. It provides a surface to which the vitality and experiences of the Fellowship can adhere. It gives cohesiveness, continuity, and visibility to our co-founders' dreams and our own. G.S.O. is a clearinghouse that gathers, sorts and stores, disseminates our hopes, actions, triumphs, and disappointments.

What began on Vesey Street in 1939 with Bill W. and Ruth Hock is now an organized office of 75 employees, which last year received 113,459 pieces of mail, 500 per working day. Each item is responded to. Much correspondence involves routine matters: literature orders, public information questions, new group and G.S.R.-changes data, contributions. Other letter writers address themselves to special-interest groups, government involvement in the field, and cooperation versus affiliation in treatment facilities. The role of delegates in the gathering process is vital. The annual updating of group records provides the biggest single source of information on who we are and who is in the service structure.

After we gather this wealth of material, it has to be filed for retrieval. An individual file is kept on each of 20,000 groups in the U.S. and Canada. There are files for all foreign general service offices, central offices, and literature distribution centers, and for groups in treatment centers and correctional facilities. Some 1,200 subject files are maintained on topics ranging from "Administration" to "Venezuela." These are just the central files. Additionally, individual files are kept by most staff members and department heads. A lot of living experience is on hand.

All the information is of little importance if no one knows about it. Consequently, a lot of G.S.O. energy goes into getting information into the right hands. This is the aim of all our publishing activities, from the Big Book through the "Too Young?" pamphlet. The staff travels to nearly 200 conferences, conventions, and roundups per year. Also, regional forums provide a local focus for general service activities. Much of our stored information is regularly supplied to delegates—for example, the annual printout on each group.

The sole purpose of the office is the Fifth Tradition—to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. The more single-mindedly we stay to that goal, the more we succeed in carrying out the will of all Conferences.

Frank Mauser, administrative assistant, G.S.O.

Finance

The ever-popular subject of money aroused sharp interest Thursday afternoon. The session began with the report of board treasurer Arthur Miles, who also moderated.

'The groups will respond'

The 1976 Conference, recognizing that G.S.O. was becoming increasingly dependent on literature income, asked the board to try to broaden the base of group support. Anticipating in-

crease in group support, the Conference asked that the price of the Big Book be reduced, bulk discounts be liberalized, and a greater quantity of literature be distributed free. This was done. Last July, at the request of the 1977 Conference, the board again lowered the price of the Big Book to groups, along with prices of all other books.

To make this policy work and further reduce literature prices, groups had to make that extra effort. After what seemed to be a good start in this direction, a distressing trend has me greatly concerned. Over a five months' period, October 1977 through February 1978, contributions were not only below budget but were actually below the same five months of a year ago! Our Reserve Fund, within bounds established by last year's Conference, is strong, and sales are running ahead of last year. But groups are not participating in building a broader base of support.

Contributions for 1977 [see pp. 54-55] finished up \$58,000 over the previous year, about a 6% increase. If we emphasize participation more than ever and strengthen communications, I feel the groups *will* respond and contribute, not only enough to pay for service operations in full, but also a sufficient amount to take care of growth and inflation.

Literature sales continue to reflect A.A. growth. However, as a result of reductions in prices of books and the liberalization of bulk discounts, net increase in sales income over 1976 was held to 6.4%. Sales for the year totaled \$2,383,334, a surplus of \$139,100 over 1976 sales. Total G.S.O. income—representing publishing gross profit, contributions, and interest generated by cash flow—was over the previous year by \$76,300 and just about on budget. Excluding the electronic data processing equipment, site preparation, and system development costs, normal expenses were \$136,700 over 1976. Total G.S.O. expenses increased by \$290,000 over last year and were within budget by less than 1%.

To sum up: The operating deficit of the General Fund, caused by the contribution shortfall plus other expenses of the board, was met by net income of the publishing operation, \$546,600. This resulted in a net G.S.O. income of \$308,800, compared to \$526,900 for 1976. After satisfying operating requirements, the balance of the net income was transferred to the General Service Board Reserve Fund per prior Conference action. [See p. 50 for full financial statement.]

The 1978 G.S.O. budget [see p. 53] has been reviewed and approved by the trustees' Finance Committee. It is a prudent one and allows for increases in both income and expense. Sales income, considering a continuing trend established in the latter part of 1977 and taking Fellowship growth into consideration, is projected to be 12% higher than 1977. Because of the disappointing results of last year's figures, the contribution increase for 1978 has been conservatively estimated at 8% over 1977. Expenses for G.S.O. operation have been set 12% higher than the previous year. However, if we eliminated *special* expenses, such as cost of the proposed A.A. film, employees' retirement expense, and cost of the World Service Meeting, total G.S.O. budgeted expenses would actually be below those of 1977. Net income for G.S.O. operations has been budgeted at \$289,300. Of course, excess income will be transferred to the Reserve Fund.

So the one negative aspect of my report is diminishing support

from the groups. Let us all see what we can do to reinforce our Tradition of self-support.

Arthur Miles, chairperson, trustees' Finance Committee

Reserve Fund equals \$1.70 per member

It has been said the groups may feel we have too much money. Part of the problem regarding A.A. finances is lack of awareness of how big the Fellowship has become. For instance, how many groups know that we now estimate our membership to be more than a million? And that if we took our Reserve Fund and distributed it equally among the membership, each member would receive only a little more than \$1.70? Or if it was distributed among the more than 30,000 groups, each share would amount to no more than \$56? In reality, the board reserve is equal to less than eight months' operating expenses.

In its early beginnings, A.A. had a difficult time financially. The fledgling service structure (the General Service Board and Office) was able to get by primarily on group contributions, plus some surplus from the sale of the Big Book. For years, Bill had to send out personally an appeal for money to all groups just before Christmas. This always resulted in a big jump in contributions. More money came in during November and December than in the rest of the months combined. How was that for deficit financing? Without an adequate reserve, slowly and painfully built up out of book discounts donated by the groups, I don't think the office could have managed.

Later, A.A. moved into a better position—but not because groups or members contributed more money. The total was greater, of course, since the Fellowship was growing, but the total percent increase and the per capita contribution still failed to “pay the freight,” as Bill used to say. Only because of the success of the publishing company, and later of the Grapevine, was it possible to maintain proper services to the groups—services that the groups, through the Conference, had themselves requested.

Today, only a little more than half the groups in the U.S. and Canada contribute anything at all to the maintenance of these services. At the request of the 1976 Conference, the board has taken measures to reduce the gross income of the A.A.W.S. publishing operation. Recently, the board agreed to give back to the groups the book discounts donated, in effect reducing prices further. All this was done because the Conference felt the board should reduce its income other than that received from contributions.

What *really* concerned the Conference was the gap between cost of services to the groups and contributions from groups to provide these services, which was becoming even larger. The Conference felt that this was unhealthy, that greater pressure should be placed on the Fellowship to increase contributions, allowing the board to decrease its dependence on surplus monies accumulated by the two subsidiary corporations.

This problem has been with us many years. However, the Conference has taken positive steps to turn this situation around, and I am sure will continue to work with the board to get the message across to the groups.

Dennis Manders, controller

Better tools for delegates

One main reason for our move to electronic data processing is to provide you delegates with better tools—such as more up-to-date group information data, correct mailing labels for meetings, and better directories with as much current information as possible.

Not only will we be able to report to groups quarterly, and to delegates semiquarterly, but we will also be able to acknowledge contributions individually. The publishing operation will be affected, too—in order processing, inventory control, and accounts receivable. What does this do for A.A.? Better service for a smaller share of the service dollar.

Our investment will pay for itself in about five to six years, in such forms as:

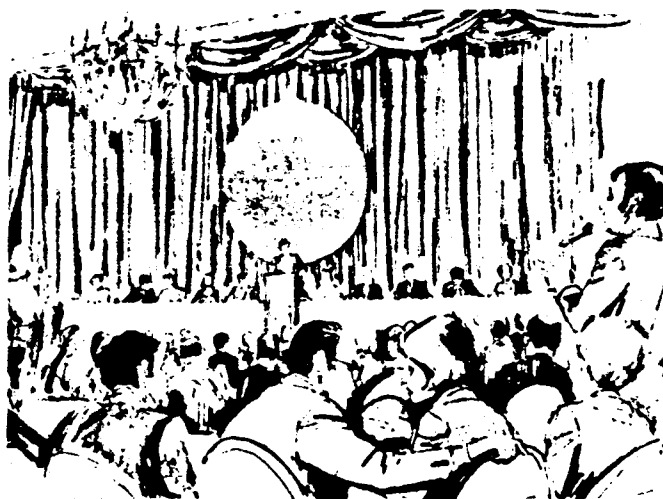
Mailing costs—the ability to produce ZIP-code-sorted labels so we can take advantage of bulk mailing rates. We will also have less returned mail, because mailings will go to the most recent G.S.R. address we have on file.

Directory costs—the savings of the cost of storing, updating, and preparing data for printing of directories.

Cost of services—this will be one of the larger cost-saving benefits. We can handle the growth of the Fellowship without increasing the payroll proportionately.

Employees at G.S.O. participated in a contest to name the new machine. They came up with the name Enterprise.

Edward Gordon, assistant controller



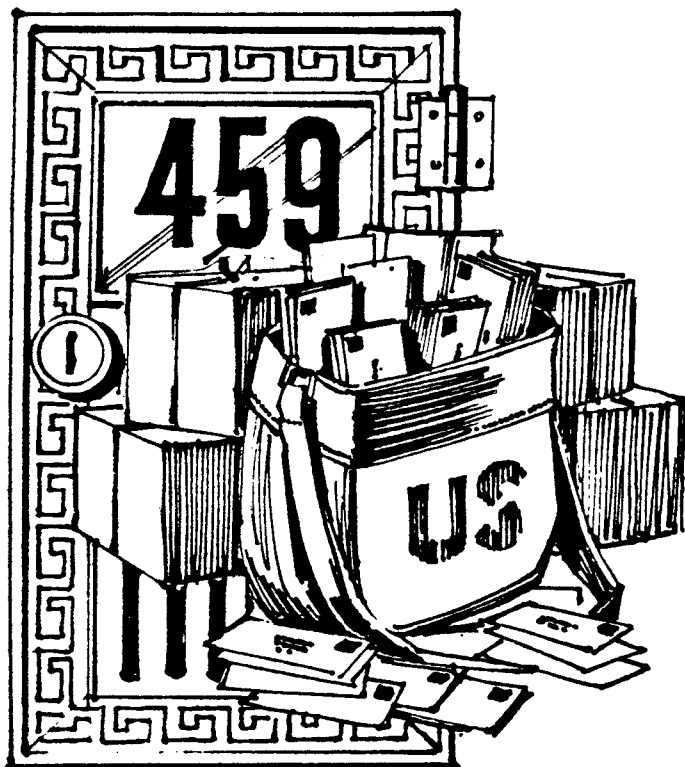
We ought to be, but aren't, self-supporting

The *General Service Board*, chief service arm of the Conference, is primarily responsible for the financial integrity of A.A. World Services, Inc., and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

The board's *Finance Committee* makes recommendations to the board on all matters concerning G.S.O. and Grapevine finances. It keeps a watchful eye on costs, closely scrutinizes the yearly budgets of estimated income and expenses, and recommends changes when necessary. At midyear, it asks for budget revisions if earlier estimates have gone too far wrong. It

looks at every new and considerable expenditure and decides whether it is necessary or desirable and affordable. This committee is responsible for our Reserve Fund.

The *Employee Retirement Committee* reviews the employees' retirement trust fund. Cost of the plan was previously funded from book discounts waived by the groups and from Grapevine contributions; but, per Conference action of 1977, these costs are now borne entirely by A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine.



A.A. World Services, Inc., as lessee, provides facilities for G.S.O. and the Grapevine, both of which pay for the space they occupy. As employer, A.A.W.S. pays G.S.O. employees' salaries. And as publisher, A.A.W.S. owns the copyrights on all Conference-approved books and literature. It pays Lois a royalty on the books Bill wrote. (This royalty was Bill's only source of income from A.A. He never received a salary.)

All persons who handle money are bonded. Two signatures are required on all checks, and an outside accounting firm makes regular audits of the books.

General Fund – group services: Moneys for this fund are contributions from individual A.A. members and groups. The costs of group services are charged against this fund, including that of the Conference. Sad but true: Contributions have met our needs only once between 1954 and this moment. This deficit is funded out of net income from publishing.

General Fund – other expenses: Since the board is not a financial operating entity, its expenses (the cost of quarterly meetings, travel, housing, and meal expense) and the cost of P.I. and

C.P.C. activity, regional forums, and legal and auditing services, plus special board projects such as filmstrips, are funded out of net income from publishing.

If it were not for publishing, G.S.O. and the board would have no net income, but a deficit instead. Now, let's ask ourselves: Are we truly self-supporting through our own contributions?

The income of *The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.*, is received from subscriptions and other sales. Its expenses are fully met from moneys received. The Grapevine is operating at a fine net income, allowing it to produce first-class products. G.S.O. and the Grapevine should be commended for keeping expenses at a minimum and services at a maximum, with amazing efficiency.

The *Conference Finance Committee* reviews A.A.W.S. and Grapevine budgets and financial reports and any recommendations directed to the committee, initiating new recommendations if need arises.

Our moneys will serve A.A. prudently and wisely if we place our moneys in God's hands. Only then will we *become* truly self-supporting—not just *ought to be*.

*David Aronofsky (Northeast Texas),
chairperson, Conference Finance Committee*

Advisory Actions on finance: p. 47

Are we letting others do our work?

Lively floor discussion from many differing viewpoints followed the presentations on this subject, moderated by Don Nicolson, regional trustee (West Central U.S.).

'Our sponsorship responsibility'

Those "others" are here to stay. Let's cooperate with treatment facilities, detox centers, and all the others. We need them. But there is no way "others" can do for the alcoholic what we can do. Our threefold malady must be treated in all three areas to effect full recovery. We can assist "others" to do *their* work by placing the sick alcoholic in a treatment facility; then we do *our* work by trying to carry the message.

Bill's being led to a medical doctor was part of the great miracle of our Fellowship. As an M.D., Dr. Bob treated many early A.A.'s, without charge, for the physical part of our malady—but he always remembered that he must return again and again to help the newcomer with the other two areas. These are the emotions that another alcoholic can identify with, and the spiritual disintegration that another alcoholic can comprehend. Let's not shirk our sponsorship responsibility in these areas. Let "others" dry out, clean, and feed our prospect. But let us be there to talk with him, and walk with him from his recovery room to an A.A. contact, to an A.A. meeting, and to a new way of life.

After many years of complaining that we have no place to take the drunk, we now have a place, and we take him there. Then, often, we feel we have done our job. Let "them" handle it. But we know that when he is released from any institution, he needs a guiding hand and heart, or he will head for the bottle.

Some of us oldtimers don't stress to the younger member that his sobriety depends largely upon his carrying the message—not the body. The newer member is detox-oriented and is ready, at the ring of the phone, to taxi the new guy to the nearest facility. We oldtimers have "baby-sat" for hours on end; now, we feel it's time for newer members to have their turn. But let's urge them to use this from the Big Book: "You can help when no one else can. You can secure their confidence when others fail. . . . Never avoid these responsibilities. . . . Helping others is the foundation stone of your recovery."

We older members should remind the newer member of his responsibility as a sponsor, that as such, he is a leader. On this topic, Bill wrote, "The stakes are about as big as they could be. A human life and usually the happiness of a whole family hang in the balance. What the sponsor does and says, . . . how well he handles criticisms, and how well he leads his prospects on by personal spiritual example—these qualities of leadership can make all the difference, often the difference between life and death."

Many alcoholism counselors are good at their profession and try to help the alcoholic. They seem to do it best when they convince the prospect that the spiritual principles of A.A. offer the total sobriety enabling him to become happily and usefully whole.

Harriet Rawls (Southern Florida)

Where our work begins

For a long time, I thought everybody should come to A.A. and accept this program exactly as I did. But not everyone had come here the same way I had. Today, we have more treatment facilities than we had 15 years ago. We should be getting a lot more alcoholics from them. Whether alcoholics come to us from hospitals, from jails, or just off the street, we should always be willing to help them and meet them where they are at.

We should let doctors know we are members of A.A. and how our program works. We should give them literature and ask them to come to an open A.A. meeting. Sharing our experience with them will help them in treating other alcoholics.

Our work begins when the alcoholic comes to us. When new members are referred to A.A. from hospitals or treatment centers, please treat them with the same understanding we give to any newcomer. They probably have heard about our program in the facility. So advise them to get sponsors. We should cooperate with the staff and counselors in treatment centers. We should share our *experience* with them, not our opinions.

A lot of groups hold beginners meetings, a good way of getting the newcomer involved. I suggest that a sponsor tell the newcomer about Unity and Service as well as Recovery. All three make up our A.A. program. We ought to get newcomers to take part in setting up the meeting place, making coffee, and cleaning up after the meeting. This is a wonderful way of starting in service. A hospitality committee is one of the best means of welcoming the newcomer to the group. We should treat court referrals just like any other newcomers, and promise them that we will respect their anonymity.

Jim Shannon (Southeastern New York)

'Many things outsiders cannot do'

Let me say, in the beginning, I don't think we are letting others do our work. We are glad to have others help us, but we realize that there are many things outsiders cannot do for alcoholics.

My area takes in Nova Scotia, Newfoundland, and Labrador, a length of about 1,300 miles from east to west. In the Nova Scotia metropolitan area of Halifax and Dartmouth, groups have access to more modern facilities than in smaller places. Membership is growing; talks are given in schools; public meetings are held. In a detoxification unit in a hospital, members put on meetings for patients.

Districts 3 and 4 are trying to get a detox unit. They also hold public meetings and workshops, and give talks in schools. In Districts 6 and 6A, membership is growing. Public information is being attended to with enthusiasm. Local A.A.'s cooperate very well with a recovery house and a detox unit. District 7 is 100 miles long, 90 wide. Some groups are in remote places. There is a detox unit—the first in Canada—where meetings are held every week, different groups volunteering in turn. Pamphlets are distributed to clergymen, doctors, hospitals, and medical clinics. In lieu of an answering service, members give their phone numbers to police stations and hospitals. Public meetings are held monthly, and talks are given in schools.

In Newfoundland, there is an alcoholic ward in one hospital, where members go and help patients. Public information is well looked after, and cooperation with the media is excellent. In the capital city of Saint John's, an energetic intergroup exists. The number of groups has increased.

Labrador is difficult and expensive to visit, the only means being by air or water. However, it has two groups, which are doing well.

Without any doubt, there are many things that we could do better—but we are trying.

Michael Flemming (Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador)

Advisory Actions related to three foregoing topics: 11 (p. 47), 54 (p. 49)

Participation of the G.S.R. — the vital link between the A.A. group and the General Service Conference

Three panelists led off this discussion, moderated by Ken Dolliver, Panel 27 delegate (Northeast Ontario).

Spiritual growth inherent in service

Only through close contact with G.S.R.'s in my area can I bring to the Conference my share of the informed group conscience. The informed group conscience, as exercised by this Conference, is carried back to the individual groups through the same representative. If this chain of communication is used, the unity of A.A. is assured.

Not until I was a delegate did I fully realize the need for the G.S.R. To the group-level A.A., necessity for the Conference, and even for area assemblies and other service units, often seems obscure. How often have I heard, "I'm not drinking, and

that's what I'm here for." Many feel their purpose in coming to A.A. ends with their concept of sobriety.

The G.S.R. is the one to whom other group members can turn when a question concerning the Fellowship arises. It is very important that the group representative have something to offer then. This might be only the reply that the G.S.R. doesn't know, but will discuss it in the assembly, get the experience of other groups, and bring that experience back.

In some groups, the G.S.R. changes every few months. One reason must be that the importance of the position to A.A. as a whole is not realized. I have often felt frustration that I could not personally express to every G.S.R. the spirituality in service and what it has meant to me. The G.S.R. is a direct link in the chain of unity binding the Fellowship and transmitting from group to group the experience, strength, and hope that offer a solution to the still-suffering alcoholic and unlimited spiritual growth to the recovering member.

I was accompanied to a regional forum by a friend in the program for several years, who was very active in his group and sponsored many newcomers. He had avoided service on the area level. On the way home, he said he had felt like rising in the final meeting and announcing that there was a spiritual side to service. He is now a G.S.R.

Bob Wall (Central New York)

A.A. needs the voice of all groups

Being a G.S.R. started a great many of us in this room on the service road that has brought us together this week. For me, it has been a process of learning about A.A. and about myself. Without G.S.R.'s we would have no communication from group to group through our nerve center at G.S.O. Unfortunately, some groups view the G.S.R. as low man on the totem pole of group jobs. Anything that can change this viewpoint seems very important.

The first qualification for any A.A. service is a good understanding of the program. Two years' sobriety gives G.S.R.'s a chance to learn something of A.A.'s Three Legacies, as well as the feeling of the group. The "G.S.R." pamphlet lists the responsibilities of a G.S.R., as does "The A.A. Service Manual." Too often, however, the new G.S.R. may read these only once—quickly. Those of us in contact with G.S.R.'s might take the time to:

- Be sure they have the manual and "G.S.R."
- Discuss service with them. One assembly has new G.S.R.'s come early for "orientation." In one area, a past delegate runs a "G.S.R. school." Another area committee sponsored a "day of service" patterned after the regional forum.
- Remind G.S.R.'s and groups that it's a two-year commitment, not six-month.
- Show service films, particularly the filmstrip "Circles of Love and Service," whenever possible, so other A.A.'s, as well as the G.S.R.'s, know what the job is about.

Having at one time served as committee secretary for my area, I know the problems involved in keeping records for our Fellowship are monumental. There is no magic device at G.S.O. to pick new G.S.R. names and addresses out of the ether. The

group secretary or the new G.S.R. must list this information with G.S.O. and with the area committee—and ask that the name of the retiring G.S.R. be removed. If not, nobody knows where to send all the great things the Conference asks G.S.O. to provide. If the group does not have a Grapevine representative, it is important to remind the G.S.R. of Grapevine materials. It is important, too, that G.S.O.'s thank-you to the groups—the quarterly statements—be read by G.S.R.'s at group business meetings, so all members know where their money goes.

Before each Conference, we owe it to G.S.R.'s to let them know in advance the topics to be discussed, so they may talk them over with fellow members and report the group conscience to D.C.M.'s and delegates.

One great way of keeping G.S.R.'s interested in service is a positive, happy feeling at assemblies. If time is not used on routine matters, G.S.R.'s can bring up group problems and begin to feel this thing called "service." If formal reports monopolize the meeting, G.S.R.'s don't experience this give-and-take and are not likely to last long.

If groups do not elect G.S.R.'s, they have no say in overall policy, literature, and public information, no guidelines, no news of the Fellowship as a whole. So let's tell all groups how much A.A. needs their voice. It comes through their G.S.R.'s.

*Ruth Hartshorn, general service trustee—U.S.
[now termed trustee-at-large]*

'Arguments' become healthy discussions

Like many A.A. members, I was concerned solely with my own recovery the first two or three years. I was active at the group level, did Twelfth Step work, made coffee for a meeting in the detox ward of our county hospital, and worked at staying sober—a day at a time. I heard about G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, and G.S.O., but it sounded like alphabet soup to me. Occasionally, someone enthusiastic about general service work would try to explain to me what it was all about, but I simply wasn't interested. I was told that G.S.R.'s were helping to carry the message worldwide. I didn't understand that. I had no comprehension of where the literature came from, nor did I care. I may have wondered where decisions affecting A.A. as a whole were made, but it didn't concern me.

Then I became secretary of a large, long-established group. My tendency to want perfection came into play. Our G.S.R. was conscientious, but for health reasons, she could not attend group meetings in our smoke-filled room. Therefore, the picture was less than perfect.

With motives less than admirable, when my term as secretary ended, I let it be known I would be available to serve as G.S.R. (Of course, I would do the job right!) There were no other contenders, so I was elected. I began attending monthly district meetings, arriving in a calm state, only to leave upset, tense, angry, and wondering what in the world service work was about. It seemed to me that people argued simply for the sake of argument. I recall one meeting when most of the time was spent discussing who would bring what for the potluck dinner at the fall assembly. I was disappointed, because I held lofty ideas about what we should be doing. But people told me to keep coming back.

The murky water began to clear for me when our area delegate came to our district meeting and presented a concise and enthusiastic explanation of the Conference structure. He shared his positive feelings about being involved. Then he distributed agenda topics and workshop subjects. He said these would be discussed at the Conference, and it was important for each G.S.R. to take this list to the group to get the group conscience. He stressed how important it was for him to know the collective group conscience of our area to truly represent it. I began to comprehend why it was important for a group to have a G.S.R.

For the first time, I felt it was vital to give a *brief* report to my group. A special meeting was scheduled to discuss the agenda topics. At the pre-Conference assembly, our delegate heard the collective group conscience. My group was having input into the Conference! I attended our area's post-Conference assembly, and made a brief report to my group of actions taken at the Conference.

The following summer, our delegate told us to start thinking about agenda topics for the next meeting of the Conference. I asked members of the group to share with me their concerns about A.A.—and they did. I realized that the Conference is an ongoing activity, that all A.A.'s are part of it. In my service growth, those "arguments" at district and area meetings became healthy discussions.

From my perspective as a G.S.O. staff member, I often feel a sense of awe as I read letters from G.S.R.'s. Their concern is so genuine and their service so dedicated. But I must also share some concerns—the greatest being what seems to be the desire for rigid regulations. G.S.R.'s are not elected to police groups. I believe nothing will turn an A.A. away from service work faster than a heavy-handed G.S.R. The G.S.R. is elected to serve the group, not to govern it. We can attract interest in service work by sharing the rewards of service in a loving and joyful way.

Lois Fisher, G.S.O. staff

Anonymity

This was the last presentation/discussion, Friday afternoon, led off by Milton Maxwell, Ph.D. (who, immediately after the Conference, succeeded John L. Norris, M.D., as chairperson of the General Service Board). Summaries of the participants' statements follow. (A workshop session on anonymity was held Friday evening. See p. 28.)

The hankering for prestige

A careful reading of A.A. history, particularly in "Twelve and Twelve" and "Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age," shows how awareness of anonymity's multiple values grew out of experience, often painful.

Originally, being anonymous was a simple response to the prevailing stigma. It was aimed at protecting individuals already in the groups and promised the same protection to anyone thinking about coming in. Then, from experience, emerged the understanding of anonymity's *spiritual* values—for members personally, each group, and the Fellowship as a whole.

To touch on anonymity's value in the spiritual growth of individual members, particularly those with a yen for praise and acclaim, I can't do better than quote from the May 1955 Grapevine:

"If one's main ego-food has consisted of recognition and applause, then 'the old ego' will not easily be denied more of this nourishment. And . . . his cleverest gimmick [will be] the old 'good of the group' stuff. [The old ego] kids the member into believing that there is nothing wrong with the limelight if it's for the good of the group. In fact, headlines are just what the group needs. Think of all the new prospects who will come flooding in! Before we know it, personal publicity and Twelfth Step work are practically synonymous. But no matter how attractively disguised, it's still the old ego. It's still the old hankering for reassurance through recognition and prestige. And it ought to be plain that any soft policy toward that old hankering can easily revive the old pattern to its former strength—with disastrous results."

Milton Maxwell, Ph.D., nonalcoholic trustee

Attraction vs. promotion—the difference?

The two parts of the Eleventh Tradition — on public relations policy and on anonymity — are closely connected.

The public *should* know about A.A. In particular, the millions of alcoholics who will get sober in the Fellowship in the next 20 years are almost all alive now, and still part of the public. To come to us, they will need to know about us, and it is our Twelfth Step obligation to see that they do. In fact, the better their understanding of their disease and of A.A., the sooner they may come.

The public relations side of our Twelfth Step is underscored by our 1974 and 1977 surveys. We learned that more than half our present membership heard about A.A. from public sources—institutions, the press, doctors, ministers, etc.—and less than half directly from an A.A. source. We learned this *again*, for Bill had pointed it out long ago.

Certainly, one reason A.A. is so respected today is the regard third parties express for the effectiveness of our program, rather than what we say about ourselves. In the long form of the Eleventh Tradition, our founders said, "There is never need to praise ourselves. We feel it better to let our friends recommend us." As far back as the Jack Alexander article in a 1941 *Saturday Evening Post*, this idea has contributed to our growth.

Our latest survey of public information committees indicates that almost 90% have found the media cooperative in carrying our message. But for the success of this activity, it is essential that our non-A.A. friends relay our message truly, without distortion. That knowledge can come only from us, through (1) public information work and (2) the example of our personal sobriety.

In "A.A. Comes of Age," the connection between our public relations policy and our anonymity principle is very clear. Bill gives many examples of individuals whose egos got tangled up with their Twelfth Step work. The danger to the Fellowship was that society, seeing our program personified by individuals driven by a desire for public recognition, would come to attrib-

ute those characteristics to all of us and would lose belief in our message. So much for *promotion*.

The *attractive* thing about our Fellowship, as far as society is concerned, is the hope it offers for the alleviation of the disruption caused by alcoholics. How universal this hope can be has just been underscored by our new 1977 survey. The increase in youthful alcoholism is being followed by an increase in young people joining our Fellowship. This message must be fully presented through our public relations efforts.

A sober alcoholic is our most potent message to the still-suffering one, while persistent evangelism would drive him away. Just so, the record of our Fellowship, honestly and thoroughly presented, can enlist all segments of society in the alcoholic's behalf, while a promoter's zeal could alienate them.

The difference between promotion and attraction is the difference between trying to push a product at the public and truly letting the product sell itself. It's the difference between the outside world's way and the A.A. way.

*John Bragg, member of trustees'
Public Information Committee*

Advisory Actions on public information: pp. 48-49

What would friends say?

In my years of drinking, I did little to hide my alcoholic ways. Yet when I came to our Fellowship, I was apprehensive about what my friends (those I had left), my employer, and my family would think. By becoming a member of A.A., I was admitting that I was an alcoholic. I felt the whole world would now be aware of it.

My sponsor gave me the pamphlet "A.A. Tradition—How It Developed." In this, Bill said: "Since we advertise anonymity to every newcomer, we ought, of course, to preserve a new member's anonymity so long as he wishes it preserved." This immediately put me at ease. Shortly thereafter, I lost my fear regarding my membership's being known. In fact, I had to be careful not to shout it from the rooftop.

As we become sober and comfortable in our Fellowship and begin to make talks to other A.A. groups, sometimes to outside groups, we should be most careful of anonymity. Although many of us have no qualms at full names' being used at our meetings, we should never use full names in outside public gatherings. Of course, no A.A. need be anonymous to family, friends, or neighbors. Disclosure there can be right and good. Nor is there any danger when we speak at group or semipublic meetings, provided only first names are revealed.

In the early days, there were many anonymity breaks, and this disturbed Bill. In 1945, with A.A. growing by leaps and bounds, he realized something must be done. He tells in "A.A.'s Legacy of Service" how a good A.A. friend suggested that all the experience gained up to then be codified into general principles that could offer tested solutions to A.A.'s problems of living and working together, and of relating A.A. to the outside world. The Traditions (the long form) were first published in the Grapevine, April 1946.

Our Twelfth Tradition was conceived to protect us from ourselves. But may we never become so anonymous that when the hand of the suffering alcoholic reaches out to us, we cannot be found.

Harry Dorsett (North Carolina)



Obligation to let it be known

When the Traditions were adopted, not much consideration was given to the possibility that their wording might prohibit breaking personal anonymity privately. The main consideration was the need for anonymity at the public level.

In many areas, members are identified in meetings, open and closed, by first name only—a matter of personal choice. Nothing in any Conference-approved literature indicates this is desirable, nor is there any prohibition against using full names within A.A.

It is important to keep in mind the distinction between breaking anonymity and breaking the anonymity *Tradition*, and the difference between saying, "I am a recovered alcoholic" and saying, "I am a member of Alcoholics Anonymous."

The Traditions require that I do not allow my full name to be used together with my membership in A.A. at the media level. Allowing that to happen breaks the anonymity Tradition.

The Traditions allow me to break my anonymity at any other level if I desire. The only restraint is the necessity to stay within the spirit of the Traditions. Is my motive in line with our policy of attraction and the purpose of carrying the message, or is it tainted with personal gain or designed to bolster an already monumental ego? It is also necessary to examine our motive for maintaining personal anonymity at the private level. Is it avoidance of the stigma of alcoholism, or maybe a slight reservation as to whether we will, in fact, maintain sobriety?

Can we carry the A.A. message when we maintain strict *personal* anonymity? Where personal harm is unlikely to result, I feel A.A. members who have maintained sobriety for substantial lengths of time have an obligation to let the fact be known on a one-to-one basis, to show that it is possible for an alcoholic to maintain sobriety and fill a responsible position in society. I believe this is a necessary part of carrying our message. This is

particularly true in individual relationships with the medical and legal professions, the court systems, social agencies, and others who come in contact with still-suffering alcoholics and may refer such individuals to A.A. All too often, these people have knowledge only of the "slippers" and sliders who are never quite able to make the program. Their enthusiasm for A.A. can be enhanced if they have personal knowledge of recovered alcoholics.

Ray Anderson (Western Missouri)

Floor Action related to anonymity: 3 (p. 47)

Workshops take searching, fearless inventory of Fellowship performance

"Anonymity," "Working With Others—Inside and Outside A.A.," and "What We Can Do for the Alcoholic" were subjects of three evening workshops attended by Conference members. In effect, the Fellowship was taking its own inventory in regard to certain responsibilities.

In ten small groups (at least one trustee and one G.S.O. or GV staff member in each), which met concurrently, delegates discussed a series of topics and questions previously agreed upon. Reporters from each section pooled the responses, so an overall summary of workshop opinions and findings could be reported back to the entire Conference. Digests of the reports follow.

What we can do for the alcoholic

1 Sponsorship—are we really working at it?

It was the consensus that we really are in most places, but more can be done. Some groups report problems on sponsorship for patients coming out of treatment centers. Suggestions for groups included forming a host committee, assignment by the group of temporary sponsors, discussion meetings on sponsorship, and giving jobs to new people (such as helping with coffee).

2 Does sponsorship include sharing the fact that service work is part of the program?

Inevitably, people involved in service introduce into it those they sponsor, all agreed. But sponsorship is still mostly about recovery in most places.

3 What can A.A. do to change its image that we are for weak-willed derelicts or religious fanatics?

Telling others—such as friends, business associates, clergymen—about our membership was recommended, as well as use of the new flyer "A.A. at a Glance."

4 How can we tell the public what A.A. can and cannot do?

One workshop suggested making appointments with professional people during their working hours to talk about A.A. Also urged were cooperation with media, use of health fairs and other community events, and offering cooperation to professional groups. Public information meetings and such publica-

tions as the P.I. Fact Sheet, "A.A. in Your Community," and "Too Young?" were also suggested.

5 How are people from court programs and treatment and correctional facilities sponsored?

All workshops recommended new people be met where they are and sponsored like any other alcoholics, regardless of the referral source.

Institutions committees, lists of A.A. contacts for institutions to use, and meetings inside facilities can answer this need.

6 Do groups encourage members to visit detox centers and help patients into A.A.?

Many groups do this. It was agreed that A.A. visitors should be carefully trained on what to do and what not to do.

7 Is it true that "only alcoholics may participate in A.A. meetings"?

The terms "participate, open meeting, open discussion, public meeting, closed meeting" have many interpretations. It was agreed that this is ultimately a matter for group autonomy.

A group inventory and the pamphlet "Problems Other Than Alcohol" were suggested as helpful.

Advisory Actions related to foregoing and following workshops: 11 (p. 47), 33 to 42 (pp. 48-49), 54 (p. 49)

Working with others—inside and outside A.A.

1 How can A.A.'s be encouraged to be friendlier to unfamiliar faces?

Greeters, hospitality committees, and older members' examples were suggested. "Desire chips" were also recommended.

2 Do groups in most areas have hospitality committees?

The majority said groups do, or use greeters. Some groups use beginners meetings or special tables for beginners. Where central offices do not exist, police, clergymen, etc. are given lists of A.A. members willing to be contacted in behalf of newcomers.

3 How are newcomers encouraged to participate?

Suggestions included giving them jobs (one group started using china cups so members could wash dishes!), taking them on Twelfth Step calls and speaking dates, inviting them to service functions and "eating" meetings, having them read "How It Works" at meetings, and flooding them with telephone numbers.

4 Are new members encouraged to find sponsors?

Most are. Some groups explain the original Twelfth Step contact is not necessarily a permanent sponsor.

5 What special treatment, if any, should be given to members with handicaps?

In one group, a blind member reads "How It Works" from Braille at each meeting. Some A.A.'s try to learn sign language to help deaf members. One group has a committee for the handicapped. Most groups provide literature in languages other than English when such need exists.

6 How can we improve cooperation between general service committees and central offices?

Use of liaison officers and mutual visits were suggested, as were encouraging C.O. people to attend regional forums and use of the 60-30-10 plan. It was pointed out that "The A.A. Service Manual" has material on this subject (pp. 83-84 in 1977 edition).

7 How can we encourage members working with professionals to share our *experience*, not our opinions and advice?

Members of institutions, P.I., and C.P.C. committees should be carefully selected and educated in workshops, with appropriate Guidelines and other A.A. literature. Familiarity with our Traditions and Chapter 7 in the Big Book was recommended.

8 Have we informed our clergyman, doctor, employer, etc. of our A.A. membership and willingness to help other drunks?

In most workshop sections, it was felt employers are least likely to be informed. It was suggested we take doctors and clergymen to open A.A. meetings.

9 Does your area have a C.P.C. committee?

More than half do.

10 Do groups cooperate with court programs?

Almost all do.

11 How can groups in treatment facilities maintain autonomy?

Since the Conference C.P.C. Committee covered this question,* most workshop sections did not discuss it.

*See Advisory Action 11, p. 47.

Anonymity

1 What is the difference between (a) maintaining personal anonymity at the media level and (b) disclosing our A.A. membership at the private level—i.e., group, friends, neighbors, fellow workers?

All agreed the Eleventh Tradition requires anonymity in the former case, not the latter. Revealing membership on the personal level is a matter of individual choice. Use of full names at meetings violates no Tradition, but helps us carry the message and demonstrate love and trust.

2 Why are anonymity breaks in the media detrimental?

They are a threat to newcomers, a failure of responsibility to the new member. They encourage personality cults and self-appointed representatives and spokesmen. They destroy trust,

degrade our image, and create controversy.

3 Are anonymity breaks in the media our responsibility or that of the media?

Ours. We have not done a good enough job of explaining our anonymity Tradition.

4 Do service-meeting reports use full names of participants?

Full names are used in about two-thirds of the areas, for use inside A.A.

5 How can we explain that using full names within A.A. violates no Tradition?

Suggestions included Traditions meetings, anonymity workshops, use of appropriate A.A. literature, examples and explanations by sponsors, and announcements made at meetings.

6 Do speakers at public information meetings use full names?

In about two-thirds of the areas, only first names and last initials. In other areas, it is the choice of the speaker.

7 How does the anonymity Tradition protect the newcomer? The regular A.A. member? The Fellowship?

It promises the newcomer absolute confidentiality, to relieve fear and build trust and security. For other A.A.'s, it places principles before personalities and helps maintain equality within the Fellowship. For the entire Fellowship, each member is a guardian of this Tradition, which has served us so well for 43 years. It has helped us maintain unity, and avoid public controversy and divisiveness among ourselves. It helps perpetuate our principles and integrity.

8 How can we explain it better to the newcomer?

This is rarely the newcomer's major interest, as long as she or he is assured of confidentiality. Sponsors can explain this to newcomers, using all available A.A. literature and the Grapevine.

9 Are we vigilant about the anonymity of other members?

Not enough. We should stress this more, and also confidentiality.

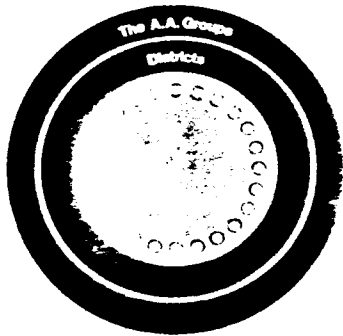
10 What about the spiritual significance of anonymity?

It encourages members to sacrifice personal ambition, to cultivate humility by self-discipline, and to learn to give with no recognition or reward. "Anonymity amounts to the renunciation of personal prestige as an instrument of general policy," says the pamphlet "A.A. Tradition—How It Developed."

11 Does "star" treatment violate the spirit of Tradition Twelve?

Yes, but we are guilty of creating A.A. "stars" and even of glorifying some public figures.

Floor Action related to anonymity: 3 (p. 47)



Alaska: We continue to learn how advisable it is to follow "The A.A. Service Manual." At our fall elections, a departure from Third Legacy procedure was used, "to reduce cost and increase efficiency." Dissatisfaction resulted in the resignation of our area chairperson/alternate delegate. Then personal circumstances forced our delegate to resign. So yours truly had to assume all three duties — not a good situation. One plus for all of us is the election as vice-chairperson of a member from the Panhandle portion of Alaska, long isolated from the northern part. — *Dick Juelson*

Alberta/Northwest Territories: Our area takes in one portion of the Peace River area. Alberta was joined by the Northwest Territories in our September 1977 assembly. We have public information on the move. We believe that not overworking our D.C.M.'s (no more than about six groups each to take care of) and sharing sessions on service account for large participation in our twice-yearly assemblies. With about 250 groups, 180 G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s attended in September. — *Ivan Strome*

Arizona: Our last sharing session was held in Yuma, where A.A. membership totals 60. All 60 participated both in putting it on and in sharing. We have monthly G.S.R. and D.C.M. meetings, where most group problems are solved. By having an agenda, we keep these meetings short, informative, and interesting. Service forums, open to all A.A.'s, are held with service events, like delegate reports or introduction of new state officers to a local gathering. This year, we had our first area sharing session in Spanish, with participation from Mexico. — *Bob Morris*

California (Mid-Southern): Of our 16 districts, 15 hold monthly meetings. We have started G.S.R. schools. We have good cooperation with three intergroups; in their monthly bulletins, we have a delegate's message and listing of service meetings. We are creating an area C.P.C. Committee to work with intergroup P.I. committees. Many districts have become involved in carrying our message to doctors and hospitals. In one, groups furnish Big Books for bedside stands in an alcoholism ward. Others furnish racks of A.A. literature to doctors' offices and hospitals. — *Goldene Lahann*

California (Northern Interior): We have about 425 groups, of which 201 have G.S.R.'s, and 21 districts, most of which have monthly meetings. Workshops are becoming more numerous. The area Grapevine chairperson is producing results, as more groups elect Grapevine representatives. Our three central offices responded to 280 requests for public information in 1977. A.A. service is provided to 28 correctional institutions and nine hospitals. In 1978, we plan to

set up workshops in the mountain regions, where general service is weakest. — *Annette Fiel*

California (San Diego): In our area, new groups spring up faster than our central office can keep track of them. We formed a new district of Spanish-speaking groups with their own D.C.M. Our worst problem is the busloads of alcoholics directed to small meetings. Our area Hospital and Institutions Committee has one director in charge of all meetings in hospitals, psychiatric wards, and detox centers, and another director for meetings in correctional facilities. People released have follow-up sponsorship whenever possible. — *Cliff Locke*

Delaware: If you are willing to help, A.A.'s will find something for you to do. Our contributions to G.S.O. have made the largest percentage increase of any area in North America, by adoption of a "Penny a Day for Sobriety" program. Our assembly has budgeted funds to cover the delegate's expenses, to enable any member to be a delegate, regardless of ability to pay. (It took two years for one past delegate to repay the loans he took out to cover his expenses.) In February, our assembly held its first workshop, open to all members; 7% attended; and it was well received. — *Bill Goughan*

Georgia: Ten years ago, we had 137 groups, 75 G.S.R.'s, and 18 D.C.M.'s. We now have 308 groups, and at our last assembly, we had 153 G.S.R.'s and 19 D.C.M.'s. Total attendance was approximately 400. Most districts have a G.S.R. meeting each month. Last April, a permanent state A.A. service office was opened. We keep up-to-date records of all state groups. We asked groups to up their contributions to the assembly to take care of the office expense. This has been done. — *Keith Strickland*

Idaho: We have had 123 new Grapevine subscriptions, a 47% sales increase. Responsibility for sponsorship is our top challenge. Until new members can select their own, many groups designate sponsors on a trial deal. Institutional involvement is a statewide responsibility, not the obligation of a single group. A revolving visitation program is maturing and is being geared for the state hospital. Our goal is to blanket Idaho with a radio spot campaign that tells the time and place for every meeting in the state. — *Joe Clements*

Illinois (Northern): After my first two years in A.A., my sponsor decided I had had enough of the carefree life and asked me to fill out the remaining six months of her G.S.R. term. (She was not well.) Our area involves some 350 groups, with ten D.C.M.'s plus officers and alternates. I have come to believe that service in A.A., whether making coffee for the group, acting as program chairperson, or being secretary to the area, offers tremendous opportunities for developing spiritual muscles — becoming an athlete for God. — *Ruth Peterson*

Indiana (Southern): Our area and Indianapolis Intergroup furnish speakers for local correctional facilities, the Salvation Army detox center, and Volunteers of America. At Central State Hospital, we have two regular groups, and two at the Veterans Hospital. We also work with the Federal prison at Terre Haute, the Evansville detox center, and the Madison and Richmond state hospitals. All our districts use the radio spot announcements from G.S.O., and Indianapolis

and Terre Haute use the TV spot announcements. — *Buck Bruner*

Kansas: We now have two assemblies and two committee meetings yearly. This year, we are establishing Grapevine and C.P.C. Committees. We are also restructuring our Institutions Committee, to let people near the institution be active in what they consider "their" institution. With growth, we are experiencing some growing pains. Who should vote at committee meetings? Should we revamp our newsletter or eliminate it? — *Bill Hopkins*

Kentucky: We have held quarterly state committee and G.S.R. meetings for a long time. Recently, we have been rotating these throughout the state. This has made it possible for more people to attend and more groups to participate. We plan our second regional forum in May 1978. This has proved to be a very successful sharing experience for all. Many groups hold meetings once a month with a potluck dinner at 7:00 p.m. and a guest speaker at 8:00. These rotate from group to group, with each serving as host for the evening. — *Leon Richards*

Maine: Our area is divided into large districts, as groups are widely scattered. We have started redistricting because of an increase in number of groups, and to cut down travel. The state committee conducts one meeting a year in each district. Radio stations are very cooperative in announcing meetings. Where I live, we have members unable to read. We try to help by use of tapes. We have a mental health center with a successful alcoholism program, which advises clients to become involved in A.A. after leaving; so we get many new members. — *Mark Peterson Sr.*

Manitoba: General service finally came of age last fall in Manitoba when, for the first time, our assembly was held separate and apart from our annual provincial conference, and was a success on its own without the pressure of other influences. Our January assembly (we hold four yearly) was a workshop, so that newcomers to general service could get better knowledge of their duties and responsibilities. The assembly was split into five groups, each with a leader and "The A.A. Service Manual" to guide us. Everyone seemed to benefit. — *Helen Harmon*

Maryland: I was one of 15 attending the Maryland General Service Conference 12 years ago. The meeting ended in a shouting match. I was introduced to the "next Maryland delegate," although no election had been held. When directions are followed in A.A., everything works for the good. Our four assemblies each year are well attended, averaging about 100 people. There is no friction or bickering, and we are growing every year. Service work, for me, has been just as rewarding as Twelfth Step work. — *Ed Edwards*

Massachusetts (Western): Our area is in its first year of using the district structure. Stronger groups in a district have a feeling of concern for smaller or newer groups — one of the main reasons for districting. Our Institutions Committee has outside sponsors taking the message to all correctional institutions in our area. We have weekly meetings at three detox units, a V.A. hospital, a state hospital, the Salvation Army Home for Men, one mission, and a nursing home — 15 meetings a week. The P.I. Committee covers about six commitments per month. We are now try-

ing to create interest in the C.P.C. Committee. — *John Maloney*

Michigan (Western): Active committee persons meet monthly in different locations, some with their G.S.R.'s. Two mini-conferences are held annually. New groups are forming at universities, correctional facilities, and halfway houses. Young people's groups form and grow. Our P.I. Committee is carrying the message to social service counselors, news media, labor and management, law and courts, schools, and the medical field. We have an area Grapevine chairperson, and many groups and districts have their own GV representatives. Last year, our first G.S.R. workshop was held prior to the assembly. — *Al Siska*

Minnesota (Northern): The Legacy of Service has opened the door to new dimensions I never knew existed. We continue to create more interest in service by holding more district meetings. We have two assembly meetings a year. We also have a yearly workshop, which lasts for three days. Our districts are dividing for better communication and service. We recently elected GvRs, and our Grapevine circulation has increased sharply. Our P.I. Committee has brought better understanding between our Fellowship and our friends outside A.A. — *Duffy Salvog*

Mississippi: Third Legacy progress is sporadic for us, often frustrating, then heartening, then static. But progress is being made. Groups are starting in treatment centers such as three state hospitals and one V.A., and in the state penitentiary. Many groups visit jails to conduct meetings. Recently, a new state tax on liquor created another source of funds for alcoholism treatment, bringing about the opening of halfway houses. They use A.A. literature, and A.A. members to conduct meetings. — *J. D. Higginbotham*

Montana: My A.A. service started in California as a G.S.R. only six months after my sobriety began. In Nevada, I became interested in the benefits of an intergroup. In Montana, we established the Helena Intergroup in 1972, and another has now been established in Missoula. Within our 147,000 square miles, we have 128 groups and nine districts. We recently appointed a Grapevine chairperson. The vastness of our state makes it very difficult to communicate personally with the various trusted servants in our area service structure. — *Marvin Wilson*

Nebraska: Our total group registration in '77 was five less than in '76, but our Omaha metropolitan area has increased 200% in the past two years. The problem is getting new groups to ask for listing at G.S.O. So we have district mini-conferences for G.S.R.'s. At our last state meeting, attendance was 40% instead of the usual 20%-25%. We request D.C.M.'s to cooperate with local health fairs and medical and hospital seminars by setting up information booths with a member to hand out literature and answer questions. — *Roger Gleason*

New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island: As I searched for highlights, the lowlights came into view; there is much work to be done. Our highlight is the starting of 23 new groups in the area. Most districts have a monthly G.S.R. meeting. A campaign to have a GvR elected in each group is progressing. One lowlight is some apathy about the Legacies of Unity and Service. However, some districts have already started

workshops to correct this. We also experience some problems with communication, since one of our provinces is a beautiful island. — *Lloyd King*

New Hampshire: About seven years ago, when I had 11 months of sobriety, I was elected G.S.R. Encouragement from my group and past delegates kept me involved and interested in general service. We have 14 districts. The delegate, area chairperson, and secretary receive minutes of district meetings to keep us informed. The area committee meets each month except the four when we have assembly meetings. D.C.M.'s are responsible for the county institution commitments in their districts, and our P.I. Committee also coordinates commitments through them. — *Woody Wooldridge*

New Jersey (Southern): Our answer to A.A. growth (from 14 to 118 groups in 20 years) was redistricting. We hold four committee and four assembly meetings a year. We've asked each G.S.R. to take at least three minutes at the next group meeting to report on general service activities. Our alternate delegate heads a liaison committee that meets regularly with our three intergroups, to improve communications *inside* A.A. We compiled a list of hospitals, rehabs, and detox stations in each district and asked D.C.M.'s to make sure the hand of A.A. is always there. — *Jane Story*

New Mexico: Redistricting has proved beneficial to communication, cooperation, activity, and involvement by groups and members. At every public meeting (unheard of a few years ago), we get new people in the Fellowship. We have four assemblies a year, with a workshop or sharing session at each. Our assembly this year set up a working fund for P.I. and our area newspaper. We now have an area Grapevine chairperson. We are putting together the A.A. history of New Mexico. If we don't get that history written down today, we will never have it. — *Thurman Dunn*

New York (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire): This past year, we elected a new area Institutions Committee, and meetings have increased in 12 different institutions throughout our area. In January, we held our first service conference, known as "Day of Sharing." With many new members attending, topics were kept basic, such as group structure and rotation. Of 100 in attendance, 75 were in service. All expressed a desire to continue this yearly. The more people involved in service, the better the line of communications will be for all groups and members. — *Ed Flanagan*

New York (Western): Our highlights for this year include at least four days of sharing, one day of learning, and three conventions. Many A.A. members of our area are beginning to get involved in all activities pertaining to Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole. There is great cooperation with the professional community, such as churches, Rotary groups, industry, hospitals, schools, and other institutions. — *Al Woodson*

North Dakota: There has been slow but steady growth. The assembly will consider the feasibility of an area P.I. committee. Some of our eight districts need better group contact. The area has three assemblies, one held at the same time as the yearly state roundup. The other two are now two-day affairs: discussion of A.A. literature, study of "The A.A. Service Manual," D.C.M. meetings, an open call-up meeting, sharing, and if need be, business to shorten the regular assembly meeting. Groups

are encouraged to hold Tradition meetings, and the Traditions are in constant use at assembly meetings. — *Nada Butz*

Ohio (Northwestern)/Michigan (Southeastern): The thrust of our service activity is directed toward four goals: (1) Geographic areas have been established, D.C.M.'s elected, and a reporting plan put into effect; (2) we are merging the interests of the area with the intergroup association; officers from each attend the other's meetings; (3) we have voted to distribute only Conference-approved literature through our central office and at the state conference; (4) the visitation squad will carry the message to shut-in members. — *Bob Tapola*

Ohio (Southwestern)/Kentucky (Northern): A total of 95 groups are registered with the area, but group registration is low compared to maximum potential. For example, the Cincinnati area alone now has 118 groups. But we are encouraged by a yearly increase the past nine years. Eight meetings a year are conducted for officers and committee members; four others, with total membership participation. Minutes are mailed to all members. We have purchased two filmstrip projectors and plan to build a film library for our groups. — *Mike Thies*

Ontario (Western): One highlight was our fall assembly, which ran two days for the first time. Our turnout of G.S.R.'s was 157. It was very rewarding. The G.S.R.'s liked it so well that our spring assembly also will be two days. Our trustee spoke on the Traditions and did a wonderful job. I am concerned about our G.S.R.'s. How can we get through to them that they should be prepared to take the job for two years, not three months? One more highlight was our regional forum in Ottawa, a real experience for me. — *Orville Young*

Oregon: In my travels, I have observed a marked increase both in the number of new groups and in attendance at established ones, due in part to P.I. Work within correctional institutions has gone well. Our chairperson has developed rapport with officials and residents, and A.A. is well received in five complexes. Quarterly mini-assemblies have stimulated interest in service. In March, an alkathon in Portland ran for 29 continuous one-hour meetings in a prominent downtown location. — *Ken Savaloja*

Puerto Rico: In setting up service in our area, we try to live by "The A.A. Service Manual." We work with G.S.R.'s at assemblies. If assemblies are set up according to the manual, there is no dispute. They work out beautifully. We have to educate the G.S.R.'s to understand that service is something you grow into. We have set up different days of the month and different places for G.S.R. schools. New G.S.R.'s attend the school and then have some idea of what their duties are. — *Ramon Acevedo*

Quebec (Northwestern): When I sat in the back row of the hall at my first A.A. meeting, ten years ago, far from me was the thought that I would go to New York to discuss the future of A.A. worldwide. It took us three years of hard work to organize districts, then an area committee. We have 200 groups and seven districts in an area 200 miles across, 1,000 long. Our main problem is language. We have to serve all but six of our groups in French. We still lack translations of most service material, such as Guidelines and bulletins. — *Angelo Carpentier*

Quebec (Southwestern): When groups read "The A.A. Service Manual," they all become better informed. Five hundred G.S.R.'s attended the Eastern Canada Regional Forum, and that was a learning experience for them. We have an active P.I. Committee, which handled 176 requests for literature in 1977 from hospitals, schools, TV, radio, etc. We also have a weekly one-hour radio program, for which we supply information and speakers. We have monthly area meetings for 453 groups and 21 districts. Through service, we enjoy our sobriety.

— *Pierre Prenoveau*

Rhode Island: We believe our assembly growth is due directly to our school of information and structure, started as a result of misinformation and problems. We first had to recognize we had the problems in order to correct them and to change the misinformation. We have P.I.C., C.P.C., Grapevine, and institution committees set up by districts. The assembly meets quarterly, and attendance represents about two-thirds of the groups, plus some interested observers. We have panels and workshops in the morning, then our business meeting.

— *Bob Gadoury*

Saskatchewan: Attendance at workshops and area committee meetings has been excellent. In the fall, we had 175 out of approximately 200 G.S.R.'s present, and all D.C.M.'s. We are actively involved in public information and institutions, with committees set up. Only about 60% of our groups contribute on a regular basis. We have been unable to get the C.P.C. Committee functioning properly, but progress is being made. Active sponsorship is declining, maybe due to rapid growth and a lack of people with the experience to sponsor new members.

— *Al Hergott*

South Carolina: We have five districts organized according to "The A.A. Service Manual." We rotate officers from three regions in the state. The alternate delegate will try to get each G.S.R. to encourage the group to make contributions to G.S.O. At our state convention in 1977, total registration was 673, and coffee cost \$1,700. At Thanksgiving, we had a Coffee Cup Campers weekend at Greenwood State Park, with 32 present. Our chapter was organized in 1976, and we meet approximately four times a year at some convenient campground.

— *Frank Stewart*

South Dakota: I began service by opening the meeting room and putting on the coffee, then moved to G.S.R., to district committee member, to delegate. I never felt I was qualified for the job, but I tried to do the best I knew. Our area highlights would be the tremendous growth in new groups and the younger people coming into A.A. A lot of our groups take part in an open meeting at the alcohol treatment center on weekends. There will be more need for sponsors for patients coming out of treatment.

— *Nick Krebs*

Tennessee: We have developed a well-coordinated state P.I. Committee. One member has been able to secure many public service spots for radio tapes she produced, and as a result, many calls to the groups have been made. She is now working on video tapes. Increased Grapevine sales can be credited to our GV Committee chairperson, who has gotten GvRs in about 50% of the groups. He has held workshops in various places and plans more.

— *Bill Killebrew*

Texas (Northwestern): My introduction to A.A. service was being sent to an intergroup committee meeting "to find out

what *they* were planning and come back and tell us." I was amazed to find out that *they* and *us* were one. The South-west Regional Forum created enthusiasm about the Third Legacy. The El Paso Central Office is thriving. After problems with answering services, we went to a "call-forward" system. A.A.'s around El Paso are less club-oriented than service-conscious. We have an active P.I. Committee and get along with our professional friends.

— *Jan Williamson*

Texas (Southwestern): Our area is 500 miles wide and about 460 deep, with 20 districts and 205 groups. Recently, we established Committees for Public Information, Institutions, (divided into Hospitals, Penal Women, Penal Men), Editorial, Grapevine, Spanish/Bilingual, and C.P.C. We have a D.C.M. workshop or sharing session in February and a larger one in March. We have G.S.R. meetings in most districts. This creates more interest than anything else.

— *Skeeter Shillings*

Vermont: We alternate assembly sites, because Vermont is long and mountainous. "The A.A. Service Manual" is distributed to each G.S.R. In our most highly populated district, a newspaper ad is used in conjunction with a full-time answering service to attract the alcoholic who still suffers. We distributed several hundred meeting lists to doctors and pharmacies through the state Alcohol and Drug Abuse Division.

— *Barbara Marsh*

Wisconsin (Northern)/Michigan (Upper Peninsula): We are having our spring conference in a new place, where many did not know what a conference was — or even G.S.O. In another section, P.I. is moving well, working with a drug and alcohol council, running articles in the newspaper and on radio, and stressing anonymity. In still another place, intergroup meetings attract 180 to 300 people, in a different city each month. (Some travel 300 miles or more.) We elected a GV chairperson, a past delegate. We should use past delegates when their terms expire.

— *Gene Loomis*

Wyoming: We have 50 or fewer groups, scattered over many square miles of mountains and prairies. So our biggest problem is communications. Most of our population lies on the outer perimeter of the state, so larger groups are attracted to A.A. outside the state. For ten years, we have tried to encourage district committees. Our hope is to expand intergroup and inter-district functions, and get more G.S.R.'s interested in the district.

— *Lew Lee*



Reports From G.S.O., the General Service Board, and Trustees' Committees

G.S.O. and
G.S.B. reports

General Service Board

In final report, Dr. Jack tells of progress

Trustees' report: If I had to put my finger on the single concern most talked about—at forums, the Conference, and other service meetings—I suspect it would be the broad subject of problems other than alcohol. What do we do about the other kinds of addicts that come in numbers to closed A.A. meetings? How do we handle the dually addicted member who talks mainly about his pill problem? Who is eligible to participate in A.A. meetings? These are legitimate concerns. Bill wrote a good deal on this subject. (A folder of excerpts from the pamphlet "Problems Other Than Alcohol" is available free from G.S.O. in quantities, and Bill's wisdom is still sound.) And of course, group autonomy and group conscience are the final arbiters in this as in all other matters in A.A.

I see a trend in the last year or two toward increased interest in general service. We hear it in the reports of the regional trustees. We see it at forums and assemblies. And we sense it in letters coming into the General Service Office. Repeatedly, we hear comments like "A few years ago, we were lucky to get 12 or 15 G.S.R.'s at our assembly, and this year we had 78." This is most gratifying.

This is my last report to you as chairman. With regret, but with great gratitude, I turn this privilege over to Milton Maxwell, for many years one of your trusted servants.

Your trustees are great people. They have given of themselves without thought of reward other than the preservation and strengthening of A.A. I do not remember any problem not worked through as we tried to live the Second Tradition. Regional trustees have brought to the board the needs and thinking of their special abilities. G.S.O. staff members have been the mortar that holds us together, filling in the cracks in our knowledge and understanding of what is happening "out there," each one adding her own special spirit of love and devotion. Nonalcoholic G.S.O. people have caught the spirit of love and service. From my perspective, G.S.O. and the board are as nearly perfect as any human society can be.

Regional forums have helped a great deal in keeping G.S.O. in touch with the between-the-lines thinking and living of A.A. May we keep our one purpose—to stay sober and help the still-suffering alcoholic (the two are inseparable)—always clearly in view. If we all do that, everything else will fall into place.

A.A. continues to grow at a vigorous rate. Sales of literature to the Fellowship reached an all-time high. We distributed over 200,000 copies of the Big Book alone! Contributions in 1977 topped 1976 by 6% (but were under the amount budgeted). We had a net gain of about 2,000 new groups in the U.S. and Canada last year—that's ten every working day! And existing groups report more people attending.

Among other important developments of the past 12 months, let me highlight these:

- The exploration by a trustees' subcommittee of the possible use of audiovisual media for carrying the A.A. message—including a film "to convey to the public the inspiration, the excitement, the magic, and the spirit of our Fellowship, and to share

our joy in being sober."

- The completion of the study on the feasibility of moving G.S.O. and the recommendation that it would not be in the best interests of the Fellowship to relocate at this time.
- The flyer "A.A. at a Glance" (offered without charge, in quantities, to carry the message to gatherings outside the Fellowship) and the filmstrip "Circles of Love and Service."
- Following the recommendation of the 27th Conference, the board took landmark action in A.A. finances. All moneys in the accounts of the two operating entities (A.A.W.S. and The A.A. Grapevine) above the amount necessary for working capital were transferred to the Reserve Fund under the direct administration of the board (the Conference having determined that a prudent balance in the reserve is one year's operating expenses). The policy was also affirmed that as group contributions increase to the point that they pay for group services, then, proportionately, the price of A.A. literature can be further decreased.
- A new survey of A.A. membership (the fourth since 1968) was made in 1977 with the cooperation of delegates in every area of the U.S. and Canada. Data on the characteristics of A.A. membership have also been obtained in Great Britain, New Zealand, Finland, West Germany, Brazil, and Mexico, and we shall release the comparative results later this year. The first study of worldwide A.A. membership ever made, this is exciting.

John L. Norris, M.D., chairperson

A.A. World Services, Inc.

Over 5,000,000 messages sent out by G.S.O.

Directors' report: In 1977, distribution of all books, pamphlets, and miscellaneous items reached 5,429,200 units. Free literature sent to groups, and to inform the general public about A.A., amounted to 501,000 individual pieces (inventory value, \$29,800). Literature sales for 1977 totaled \$2,389,400, an increase of \$145,200 over 1976. To help defray costs of other services contributions could not meet, A.A.W.S. transferred \$231,500 to the General Fund.

- We authorized Bob Pearson to meet with G.S.O. Australia and the New South Wales Central Service Office to assess their publishing problems, in the hope of bringing about a solution.
- The first draft of Dr. Bob's biography—more than 300 pages, containing history of A.A. in the Akron-Cleveland area—is ready.
- We drew up a position paper re requests to reprint A.A. literature in study guides, or interpretive or explanatory texts. This is available on request.
- We agreed that the price of the Group Handbook be equalized at \$4, and that A.A.W.S. absorb the estimated \$2,000 loss as part of the free literature we give away (per directive of 1976 Conference).
- We agreed that an equitable handling fee be added to charge

orders from all large non-A.A. purchasers, as well as from A.A. groups, central offices, etc.

- A.A.W.S. transferred to the Reserve Fund \$777,800. This represented the amount in excess of \$150,000, plus major commitments and accounts payable, in the operating fund as of June 30, 1977.

In addition to the A.A. staff, A.A.W.S. employees include those in the following departments: Accounting (13 employees); Archives (two); File (three); Mail (five); Records (seven)—first user of our new electronic data processing system; Shipping and Receiving (11); and Stenographic and Clerical (16).

John Bealer, M.D., chairperson

Literature distributed in 1977: See list on inside back cover.

Archives

Memories of early A.A. shared

Trustees' committee: Emphasis continues on collecting oral histories of early members and others instrumental in the growth of the Fellowship. We now have 140.

A cassette tape has been prepared for archives visitors. It features Bill W. reading the fifth chapter of the Big Book and a portion of Dr. Bob's farewell talk.

Since much archives material is one-of-a-kind, steps are being taken to repair and protect all clippings and correspondence—quite an extensive undertaking.

Milton Maxwell, chairperson

Staff report: Visitors enjoy browsing among the books and historical artifacts, looking at pictures, and reading correspondence pertaining to their own groups.

Here are some of our major activities in the past year:

- We completed three microfilming projects—records and correspondence of Bill and Dr. Bob, the earliest groups, and the Alcoholic Foundation/G.S.O.
- We processed group and area history records from many states and two provinces.
- We interviewed or received tapes of interviews from over 30 individuals directly concerned with A.A. growth at group, area, or state level.
- We retaped 88 cassettes onto our standard format of 7" one-to-one reel, resulting in about 165 7" tapes.
- We received inquiries from areas starting to build local archival units and made historical photos available for them.
- We acquired two copies of the first printing of the Big Book—one, the first ever sold.
- We answered many requests for information on A.A. and

assisted in a biography of the co-founders and in an analysis of A.A. by a Harvard researcher.

Nell Wing, archivist

Conference

All suggested agenda items reviewed

Trustees' committee: We became a full standing committee in 1974, to review ways of improving the General Service Conference, and to consider suggested Conference themes and agenda topics. Here are some of our activities in the past year.

We recommended that the West Virginia request for reviewing the third edition of the Big Book be referred to the Conference Literature Committee, and that the listing of gay groups in A.A. directories be referred to the Agenda Committee.

As a result of the 1977 Conference Evaluation Questionnaire and the G.S.O. post-Conference sharing session, we recommended the following for the 1978 Conference:

- 1 Earlier opening, on Sunday, for all Conference members
- 2 Sharing session as part of the main agenda
- 3 Sending background material on discussion topics to delegates as early as possible
- 4 Keeping the archives open Saturday prior to the Conference

In addition to topics recommended by the Conference Agenda Committee, we recommended the following for the 1978 agenda:

- 1 Presentations/discussions on: finance; A.A. regional forums; "The Twelve Traditions – 'Why It Works' "; "The Role of the General Service Trustee – U.S./Canada"
- 2 Workshop on anonymity
- 3 Report on "How and Why A.A. Grows"
- 4 Highlights of past Conferences, by a staff member

Questions for workshops were also reviewed.

John Waterfield, chairperson

Staff report: The purpose of the Conference is to assume the responsibility of leadership once held by the founders of A.A. and to carry the message. It is also a policy-making body that expresses the group conscience of the Fellowship.

The Conference secretary corresponds with all Conference members, past delegates, and committees. We now have on our mailing list: 681 past delegates; 1,859 district committee members; 75 area committee chairpersons; 69 area committee secretaries; and 71 area committee treasurers—a total of 2,755. Others in service are also on the list.

We receive minutes of most area assemblies and committee meetings, which are circulated among the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs. This helps us keep up with A.A. around the country. Any member may send in suggestions for the Conference agenda. Suggestions are presented to the trustees' Conference Committee and the Conference Agenda Committee, then shared with everyone in the *Quarterly Report*, Box 4-5-9, and the preliminary agenda mailed in January.

The Conference secretary assumes responsibility for:

- 1 Collection of items for Conference theme and agenda
- 2 Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Conference Committee
- 3 Correspondence with delegates in preparation for the Conference
- 4 Working with the general manager, the office manager, and the staff in planning the Conference
- 5 Scheduling all reports and other material for Conference Manuals, Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9*, and the *Final Conference Report*
- 6 Preparation of Conference Advisory Actions and summaries of Ask-It Basket questions
- 7 Reviewing minutes, reports, and all communications received from area committees and D.C.M.'s

Phyllis Masback



Cooperation with the Professional Community

Joint committee sessions held inadvisable

Trustees' committee: The 1977 Conference C.P.C. Committee recommended that the board consider holding a joint meeting of the trustees' Committees on P.I., C.P.C., and institutions, to discuss overlapping responsibilities and eliminate competition. The committee chairpersons studied the need for such a meeting, and felt it would not be feasible. They reviewed the Guidelines and "The A.A. Service Manual," and felt the material was clear; it would only confuse local committees if anything more specific was written. The chairpersons call attention to the section in the C.P.C. Guidelines entitled "Relationship of A.A. Committees: P.I., C.P.C., Institutions," particularly the fifth paragraph: "In keeping with our Tradition of placing principles before personalities, *who* or *what* committee carries the message is not important so long as our message is carried to the still-suffering alcoholic."

For the past two years, A.A.'s participation at the Annual Forum of the National Council on Alcoholism has been integrated into specific programs. In San Diego in 1977, Dr. John L. Norris, our nonalcoholic board chairperson, was presented with N.C.A.'s Gold Key Award.

We participated in the following programs at the forum:

- 1 "How A.A. and Other Community Efforts Cooperate to Help the Alcoholic," planned jointly by the San Diego N.C.A. affiliate and our delegate, and moderated by an A.A. member on the N.C.A. San Diego staff
- 2 "A.A.'s Interaction With Private Physicians Prescribing Medication," moderated by Dr. Norris
- 3 "A.A. as an Occupational Program Resource," with a past delegate from Los Angeles
- 4 A public information program, with a paper ("The Impact of Public Information on Self-Care Programs") by a past C.P.C. chairperson
- 5 A sharing session for A.A. members, with a doctor, a lawyer, and a clergyman in A.A. sharing their experience

Our Professional Exhibit was well attended.

At the annual meeting of the Association of Drug and Alcohol Problems of North America (A.D.P.A.) in Detroit in September, Dr. Norris and the current C.P.C. staff member participated on a panel: "Bridging the Gap Between Active Professional Treatment and A.A." Your C.P.C. chairperson participated in the occupational program section.

The committee suggested that a third additional Professional Exhibit and a professional table-top display be purchased, to serve until the new A.A. membership survey information is available for exhibit use.

Gordon Patrick, chairperson

Staff report: To carry A.A.'s message to professional groups and individuals who have contact with alcoholics, staff or members of the trustees' C.P.C. Committee have participated in (1) meetings of the National Advisory Council on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism in Rockville, Md., (2) Annual Forum of N.C.A., in San Diego, Calif., (3) a conference sponsored by the Rockland County Community Health Center, in New York City, (4) the annual meeting of A.D.P.A., in Detroit, Mich., (5) the Summer School of Alcohol Studies at Rutgers University, (6) the fall Conference of the Alcoholism Professionals of North Carolina, (7) a seminar sponsored by the Connecticut Area C.P.C. Committee, Greenwich, Conn., (8) a seminar at Hazelden Treatment Facility, Center City, Minn.

In cooperation with the U.S. Department of State, ten professionals from Europe, Latin America, and Africa visited G.S.O. in February. In fields ranging from psychiatry to criminology, they were in the United States for a multiregional project on drug abuse, alcoholism, and mental health. We discussed the history of A.A., described how A.A. cooperates with the professional community, and told a little of our own stories, followed by questions and answers.

During the past year, our Professional Exhibit was shown at 18 national meetings. As a result of the first 13 of these showings, we received 1,248 requests for literature.

About A.A., our newsletter to 3,600 professionals, is now sent out twice a year instead of annually.

Today, 77 local C.P.C. committees are listed at G.S.O.

Sarah Pierce

Correctional Facilities

New pamphlet in the works for those 'inside'

Trustees' committee: In July, we held our first meeting as a full committee. Recently, we received the manuscript of the new illustrated pamphlet aimed at the alcoholic inmate. We believe the question whether to title the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Hell Out of Sitting in a Cell" or "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" should go to the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities.

"Carrying the Message Inside the Walls" (suggestions for speaking at correctional facilities) has been prepared, in question-and-answer form, to encourage A.A.'s toward such activity. This flyer contains practical tips for speakers and suggestions on cooperation with the facility. We recommend it be made available in quantity to institutions committees and "outside" sponsors.

In meetings with prison administrators, the chairperson has been updating information on where A.A. works best.

W. J. Estelle Jr., chairperson

Staff report: As of January 1, 1978, there were 1,210 A.A. groups in correctional facilities and 151 institutions committees serving them.

To carry our message to the confined alcoholic, G.S.O. offers correspondence with the correctional facilities staff member and with other A.A.'s through our Institutions Correspondence Service.

We list correctional facilities groups in G.S.O. records, and send each a Group Handbook, the Big Book, and other complimentary literature. They also get our directory of *A.A. Groups in Correctional Facilities, Box 4-5-9* bimonthly, and the *Institutions Bulletin* three times yearly.

Discount packages of A.A. literature (English and Spanish) are available to "inside" groups and institutions committees. The Grapevine gives us back issues, which we pass along to groups that require additional complimentary literature. Guidelines available for A.A. members interested in institutions work are those for Institutions Committees and for Cooperating with Court, A.S.A.P. and Similar Programs.

The films "Bill's Own Story" and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions" and the filmstrips "Box 459" and "Circles of Love and Service" are all available on loan without charge to groups in correctional facilities.

Our mail from local institutions committees and inside groups indicates a need for more literature, more A.A. sponsors, more outside speakers, and more outside A.A.'s to participate in the Institutions Correspondence Service.

There is still much to be done for the alcoholic inmate. For the inmate's recovery to become a reality, we need the continuing and loving activity of local institutions committees and A.A. sponsors.

Vincina McCarthy

Finance

This year, the report of the trustees' Finance Committee was given in the form of a presentation. See p. 20.

General Service Sharing Session

Former Policy Committee hears guest speakers

Trustees' report: The Policy Committee of the board came into being in 1955, to deal with problems of external policy of the board and matters affecting A.A. as a whole. In recent years, that committee had fewer items of general policy to deal with, as the board now has more standing committees that make recommendations, and these, when accepted, constitute policies.

In October, the name of the committee was changed to the General Service Sharing Session. The meetings are attended by all trustees, directors of A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and all nontrustee members of trustees' standing committees — usually 50-60 people.

At the July session, presentations on clubs were given, but no action was taken. Guest speakers heard this last year were: Dr. Gregory B. Collins, medical director of the Alcohol Rehabilitation Center of Cleveland Metropolitan Hospital; Capt. Stuart Brownell, U.S.N., director of the Navy Alcoholism Prevention Program; and Robert K. Greenleaf, businessman and author.

We discussed A.A.'s present policy of granting permission to others to publish the Twelve Steps. As the Steps are themselves a distillation of ideas borrowed from other sources, it was felt we should continue to make them available to outsiders after careful consideration.

We discussed a topic suggested for the Conference, "Only alcoholics may participate in A.A. meetings." It was the sense of the meeting that the question should clearly express whether it refers to participation of spouses and visitors at open discussion meetings, or to those with problems other than alcohol, or both.

Stan Wilsey, chairperson

Group services coordinator

Handbooks, Guidelines, film material to groups

Staff report: Primary responsibility of the group services coordinator is to provide communicative services to the Fellowship. The coordinator supervises production of all service materials, update of Guidelines and listings, and distribution of films, literature displays, Group Handbooks, and other unique A.A. material. She works in a team with the staff coordinator and other staff members on the Literature and Conference assignments.

We have three handbooks, for (1) new groups, (2) new prison groups, and (3) new hospital groups. New U.S. and Canadian groups receive a Group Handbook, a complimentary supply of literature, then *Box 4-5-9*, and the appropriate A.A. directory.

We now have 13 Guidelines.

Two 16 mm. color films are available: "Bill's Own Story" and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions." These are distributed on a rental basis at \$35 per week, and are free for A.A. groups in institutions.

Two filmstrips available are "P.O. Box 459," about G.S.O., and "Circles of Love and Service." These may be purchased at \$6.50 each.

Material on various services provided by G.S.O. is available on request. For example, we have lists of: deaf groups; tapes for sale, exchange, and correspondence; sources of A.A. books in Braille for blind members; fellowships similar to A.A.; suppliers of A.A. emblems, medallions, etc. [this listing now discontinued]; armed forces groups; books and pamphlets in other languages (Translations Order Form); Loners; Internationalists; overseas offices; central offices in U.S. and Canada.

As editor of *Box 4-5-9*, the coordinator gathers material for each issue and is responsible for sending it out in English, French, and Spanish to almost 50,000 A.A.'s worldwide.

Susan Daly

Assistant group services coordinator

Bulletins and pamphlets carry the message

Staff report: We sent out approximately 350,700 bulletins and reports in 1977. Mailing lists for bulletins are now computerized for better service.

	Mailing list	Issues per year
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (English)	42,000	6
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (French)	1,200	6
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (Spanish)	6,400	6
<i>Loners-Internationalists Meeting</i>	2,600	6
<i>P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i>	2,000	3
<i>Institutions Bulletin</i>	4,500	3
<i>Quarterly Report</i>	3,600	3*
<i>About A.A.</i>	3,600	2

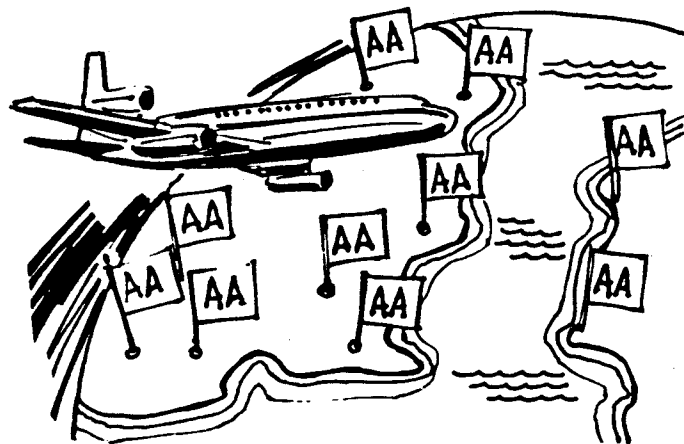
*The *Final Conference Report* takes the place of the fourth issue.

Pamphlets now in progress, with completion anticipated in 1978, are "The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous (biographical sketches and their last major talks)," "Circles of Love and Service" (to accompany the filmstrip), and "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" (tentative title).

We have also worked with a production company on a possible 16 mm. film about A.A., done an audiovisual-materials survey among delegates, alternates, and trustees, and worked with artists and photographers on pictures for bulletins, meetings, and Conferences.

We send a letter semiannually to all central offices, intergroup committees, and literature distribution centers to keep them informed of new A.A. literature, periodical publications, and audiovisual materials.

Lois Fisher



International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums

1980 plans under way: forums in all regions

Trustees' committee:

International Convention—we recommended that the board appoint Dede Hoffmann as Host Committee chairperson for the 45th Anniversary International Convention, in New Orleans in July 1980, and adopted a policy for dealing with travel agents:

- All rooms must be booked through A.A. World Services, Inc., on a first-come-first-served basis.
- A.A.W.S., Inc., will accept block reservations from travel agents provided they have sent filled-out registration forms and checks to cover registration fees from individual registrants to the General Service Office of A.A. in New York City. G.S.O. will forward the housing portion of the forms to the Housing Bureau in New Orleans with the request that the group be housed in one hotel or in hotels close to each other whenever possible.
- Confirmation of reservation and registration receipts will be sent to the individual with copies to the travel agent involved. No commission will be paid to travel agents on hotel rooms booked for the Convention.

We also recommended that each state and province select speakers for one alkathon in New Orleans.

In *Box 4-5-9*, we asked for suggestions for a Convention theme.

A.A. Regional Forums—It was suggested at one forum that activities be planned for non-A.A. spouses; but the forums are working sessions for service-minded A.A.'s, so no change will be made at this time. Spouses of A.A.'s are welcome to attend the sessions without participating.

We agreed to consider having more than one forum in a region if the regional trustee, after prior consultation with delegates, submits such a request.

A request was made for simultaneous translation (English-French, French-English) at the Eastern Canada Regional Forum.

The committee accepted this proposal and recommended financial assistance from the board.

Evaluating previous forums, we decided the size of each forum has been just about right. Over 500 participants would present problems, but this has not happened. We feel the format is fine as is, and recommended we keep the arrangement of workshops the same (no rotation) at this time. We feel the free material we have at present is suitable, but might add at each forum the latest *Conference Report* and "A.A. at a Glance." We suggested adding the table-top display and the "Inside A.A." display to our exhibits at each forum.

The following forums are scheduled: Southeast Region, May 1978; Pacific Region, September 1978.

Peter Watters, chairperson

Staff report:

A.A. Regional Forums—Seven regions have held forums; an eighth is planning one for May; a ninth, for September. The board has approved their continuation, and we are now ready to schedule regions for a second time.

Forums are held on invitation of the regions, and plans are made with the regional trustee, delegates in the region, and G.S.O. staff.

Responsibilities of the coordinator are: (1) plans, working with all involved; (2) arrangements with host-city contact; (3) hotel arrangements; (4) travel arrangements for trustee and G.S.O. staff; and (5) mailings to region's G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, area committee officers, past/present delegates, past/present trustees, and central offices; (6) conference boards and sample literature; (7) mailing reports to all participants, past/present trustees, and current delegates; and (8) other correspondence concerning the forums.

Dr. John L. Norris, chairperson of our board, has attended all the forums and has said he found them thrilling experiences. He emphasized the importance of good communication among all service bodies. If we can communicate with one another, he said, we can solve our problems.

We owe a lot to our Dr. Jack, since regional forums were his idea from the start. They are working, and they are improving communication within our Fellowship.

Susan Daly

The staff report on the International Convention was given in the form of a presentation. See p. 17.

Internationalists, Loners, LIMs

607 seagoing, 393 Lone Members do stay sober

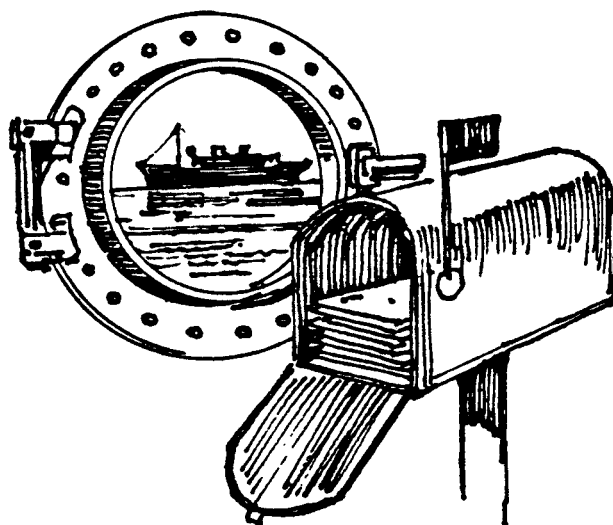
Staff report: We have 607 Internationalists on the G.S.O. mailing list. These have started A.A. groups all over the world, even 13 groups aboard ships. Seagoing A.A.'s keep in touch with the A.A. program through correspondence with one another and with the staff member.

Each new Internationalist receives a package of literature, lists of Internationalists and Loners, copies of the newsletter *Loners-Internationalists Meeting (L.I.M.)*, directories, and a Grapevine order form.

When Internationalists no longer go to sea, they may be listed by G.S.O. as Port Contacts if they wish, scattered throughout the world, ready to offer the hand of friendship to Internationalists on visiting ships.

Every other month, *L.I.M.* is sent. On alternate months, *Box 4-5-9* is sent.

How one Internationalist uses the program to stay sober is expressed in the following letter: "As a seaman, I can attend A.A. meetings only when in port. At sea, I have my own meetings in the confines of my bedroom. With A.A. posters and slogans hung up, it resembles an A.A. meeting room, and I have my cassette player and numerous cassettes with talks by recovered



alcoholics — my people. My meetings are held in the usual way. They open with the Steps, Traditions, and Preamble, and for talks, I play one recording at a time. I wind up writing letters after the meeting, usually at least four a day."

Efforts by one Internationalist to start a group in Pago Pago, American Samoa, are under way, and we hope this seed bears fruit soon.

We have 393 Loners on our list, including some who speak Spanish, French, or German. These are members unable to attend meetings. It isn't always easy to start a group, but Loners are encouraged to do so. Until a group is started, they stay sober through A.A. literature and correspondence. Each new one receives a complimentary literature package, *Box 4-5-9* every other month, lists of Loners and Internationalists, *L.I.M.*, a directory, and a Grapevine subscription order form.

Loner Sponsors now number 849. They also receive *L.I.M.* They do attend A.A. meetings but like to sponsor Loners through correspondence.

Nineteen members who are housebound or disabled and cannot attend meetings are called LIMs. They also receive *L.I.M.*

and the list of Loners, so they may share their experience, strength, and hope.

We now have Loners in the U.S.S.R., Egypt, Israel, and remote parts of the U.S. and Canada.

Beth Kuhlmann

Literature

"Too Young?" pamphlet issued

Trustees' committee: This committee, with the cooperation of the Conference Committee, has worked on the following projects:

- The teenage cartoon pamphlet "Too Young?" was completed in July, and 110,000 copies have been sold.
- The long form of the Traditions has been added to "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions."
- For the combined biography of Bill and Dr. Bob, a rough manuscript of most of the portion relating to Dr. Bob has been submitted. A finished draft of both biographies will be circulated for approval by the end of 1978.
- Our literature survey indicated there is no need to develop anything new except the biography.
- The Audiovisual Subcommittee, after evaluating many films and meeting with producers, selected Crommie and Crommie, Inc., to produce test footage to explore techniques of filming members without violating the Tradition of anonymity. The committee was given authorization to prepare a preview film for the 1978 Conference.
- An audiovisual-materials questionnaire was sent to all delegates, alternate delegates, and trustees, with 24.5% responding. Of those, 72% indicated a need for materials for public information, and 68% indicated a need for filmstrip kits.
- We recommended that the Conference Literature Committee review, in the third edition of the Big Book, changes in the foreword to the *second* edition.
- We continue rewording in nonsexist language as pamphlets are reprinted.
- We considered adding paragraphs to "Do You Think You're Different?" in different languages, stressing that language problems are not a barrier in A.A. We have asked the Conference Literature Committee for clarification on the type of material desired.
- We accepted the Conference suggestion to include the 60-30-10 plan in "The A.A. Group" in the next printing.
- A subcommittee has been formed to work on a pamphlet for elderly alcoholics. A manuscript is being edited for consideration.

Don Nicolson, chairperson

Nominating

New board head nominated

Trustees' committee: We reviewed the duties and qualifications of the chairperson of the General Service Board, and unanimously recommended that Dr. Milton Maxwell become chairperson of the board immediately upon the close of the 1978 Conference.

We recommended that Dr. Jack be elected chairperson emeritus upon his resignation as chairperson.

Résumés of Class A trustee candidates to fill the vacancy created by Dr. Jack's resignation were reviewed. A selection will be made at a later date.

As the 1977 Conference recommended, we studied the role, purpose, and responsibility of the general service trustee — U.S./Canada, to determine such qualifications as the board may require.

After reviewing correspondence from past and present general service trustees, the subcommittee suggested the presentation/discussion on "Role of the General Service Trustee — U.S./Canada" at this Conference.

We reviewed the résumé forms for Class B trustees, with special consideration given to employment in the alcoholism field.

We recommended the following slate of trustees for the board, following presentation to the 1978 Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

Michael Alexander	Arthur J. Miles
John D. Bealer, M.D.	Gordon M. Patrick
W. J. Estelle Jr.	(one vacancy)
Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.	

Class B

N. M. Cheater	Martin Le Boutillier
Cecil E. Corrigan	Don Nicolson
Jerry A. Danzig	Mike Rainbolt
Virginia C. Hallman	Edward J. Small
Charles H. Hanson	Samuel E. Smith
Ruth K. Hartshorn	John E. Waterfield
One regional trustee—Pacific U.S.	
One regional trustee—Eastern Canada	

We approved the following slate of officers for the board:

<i>Chairperson</i>	Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.
<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	John D. Bealer, M.D.
<i>Second vice-chairperson</i>	Mike Rainbolt
<i>Secretary</i>	Cecil E. Corrigan
<i>Treasurer</i>	Arthur J. Miles
<i>Assistant secretary</i>	Cora Louise Belford
<i>Assistant treasurer</i>	Dennis Manders
<i>Chairperson emeritus</i>	John L. Norris, M.D.

We recommended as directors of A.A. World Services, Inc.:

John D. Bealer, M.D.	Don Nicolson
Cora Louise Belford	Robert G. Pearson
John Bragg	Jacquelyn Solomon
Jerry Danzig	John E. Waterfield
Martin Le Boutillier	

We recommended as directors of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.:

Cecil E. Corrigan
Donald F. Daly
Retha Gresham
Virginia C. Hallman
Charles H. Hanson
Austin MacCormick

Polly Marsh
John Ryall
Fred J. Sengstacke
Edward J. Small
Ann Warner

Charles Hanson, chairperson

Overseas

More literature in German and Finnish available

Staff report: The staff member on this assignment corresponds with all groups, individuals, and general service offices in foreign countries (except Spanish-speaking—a separate assignment). A.A.'s from overseas visit to discuss A.A. concerns in their countries with the staff person. During the past year, we had visitors from Israel, Norway, West Germany, France, Belgium, United Kingdom, New Zealand, Denmark, Singapore, East Africa, and India.

For English-speaking groups in countries where there are no literature distribution centers, we provide complimentary literature. We also work closely with newly emerging and established centers, and with members in countries where there are no service boards or literature centers.

To protect our copyright, we are careful in granting reprint permission inside and outside A.A. Translations are checked by bilingual A.A. members in the U.S. and Canada.

The General Service Board in West Germany has recently published a German edition of "As Bill Sees It." It also plans to translate and publish "Living Sober," "A Brief Guide to A.A.," and "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship."

The Finnish board has translated and published "A.A. Comes of Age" and "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship." They will host the Fifth World Service Meeting this year.

We are checking a recent translation of the Big Book into Japanese.

June Russell

Public Information

New materials ready for schools and media

Trustees' committee: "A.A. at a Glance," a one-sheet flyer for distribution by local P.I. committees at school, civic, and community groups is sent in quantity, on request, to local P.I. committees. "A.A. Information Sheet for Media" is also available free.

Our fourth membership survey was undertaken by delegates in June 1977. (Others were in 1968, 1971, and 1974.)

A news release on W. J. Estelle Jr., new Class A trustee, was mailed out.



A human-interest story on A.A.'s self-support, written by a committee member, was released by United Press and picked up by many newspapers.

A news release was sent to *Scholastic* Magazine and major dailies and wire services about our new pamphlet "Too Young?"

The Northern Florida P.I. Committee has made some effective TV spots. They are now available to other P.I. committees on videotape, all three for \$35. [See p. 10.]

Four radio spots, 30 seconds each, are now available on cassette tape for \$5.

At our request, the Northern Florida P.I. Committee has been working on a pilot project to bring information about A.A. to doctors. If it proves successful, it will be recommended for other areas. [See p. 10.]

As a result of a survey, we have begun work on a piece to stimulate interest in P.I. work among members.

Jerry Danzig, chairperson

Staff report: During 1977, we provided information to various parts of the public sector by responding to 8,605 inquiries; processed 4,836 press clippings; distributed 137 TV spots and 93 radio announcement tapes; and noted 157 anonymity breaks. Sixty-five "A.A.—a Community Resource" displays were sent with P.I. labels and pamphlets for use at health fairs and local and state meetings.

Since "A.A. at a Glance" was produced in October, we have shipped more than 75,000 copies to local P.I. committees for use when giving talks at schools and community groups.

There are 261 P.I. committees and 369 contacts listed at G.S.O. New P.I. chairpersons receive P.I. material free of charge. The *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*, sent to them three times yearly, shares P.I. activities reported by local committees. Other materials are sent free to P.I. chairpersons and contacts on request.

The pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" and "Alcoholics Anonymous Information Sheet for Media" were enclosed in

the annual anonymity letter to the media; and "Understanding Anonymity" and "Information About A.A." went to treatment facilities.

Betty Liddle

Spanish correspondence

Bilingual committees started

Staff report: There are 262 Spanish-speaking groups in Canada and the United States (including Puerto Rico). G.S.O. services them with new group literature and *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish.

As more bilingual people come into A.A., communication between the Spanish- and English-speaking groups is improving, and the former are beginning to be represented by G.S.R.'s at area assemblies. In Southwestern Texas, there is a bilingual committee, and in several other areas, there are bilingual D.C.M.'s. San Francisco, Los Angeles, Chicago, Washington, D.C., and San Juan have Spanish intergroup offices, and there is a Spanish Service Committee in New York City.

This September, the Spanish National Congress will be held in California. The theme will be better communication and cooperation between Spanish- and English-speaking A.A.'s in this country.

In most Hispanic countries overseas, A.A. has come of age. There are nine general service offices, including one in Spain. (Brazil, Portuguese-speaking, also has a G.S.O.) Those G.S.O.'s service their groups and answer all correspondence. Many print and distribute literature, and most countries have service structures similar to ours. "The A.A. Service Manual" has been translated and adapted to geographical needs in each. In the Spanish-speaking world, Bill's dream of each country's having its own service structure is coming true.

Mary Ellen Welsh

Staff coordinator

Groups and committees served

Staff report: Ten A.A.'s are employed as G.S.O. staff members. Each has a specific service assignment, and some involve responsibility for the preparation of special service bulletins. Staff members also serve as secretaries of board and Conference committees. Work is apportioned as follows:

Staff coordinator

Quarterly Report; assistant secretary, General Service Board; secretary, trustees' General Service Sharing Session and Committee on Conference Policy/Admissions *Box 4-5-9* (English and French); co-secretary, trustees' International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee; secretary, Conference Report and Charter Committee
Secretary, trustees' and Conference Literature Committees

Group services coordinator, A.A. regional forums

Assistant group services coordinator

Conference

Cooperation with the professional community

Correctional facilities

Loners, Internationalists, treatment facilities

Overseas, World Service Meeting

Public information

Spanish correspondence

Box 4-5-9 (Conference issue); *Conference Report*; secretary, trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and Conference Agenda Committee
About A.A.; *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*; secretary, trustees' and Conference C.P.C. Committees
Institutions Bulletin; secretary, trustees' and Conference Correctional Facilities Committees
Loners-Internationalists Meeting; secretary, trustees' and Conference Treatment Facilities Committees
World Service Meeting Report; secretary, World Service Meeting; secretary, trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees
P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin; secretary, trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees; co-secretary, trustees' International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee
Box 4-5-9 (Spanish)

Basic responsibility of the staff is to answer correspondence. During 1977, over 22,868 letters were received, and each was answered individually by a staff member. The staff coordinator makes sure the mail is answered promptly without interruption during vacation time, times of sickness or absences, or when a staff member is involved with a special project that requires full-time attention. Otherwise, each staff member handles the mail for her specific assignment regardless of geographical area, and answers A.A. group mail from a specific region.

An exciting aspect of G.S.O. staff service is the opportunity to accept invitations to A.A. conventions, assembly meetings, and state and provincial get-togethers. These trips provide us with an opportunity to become acquainted with A.A.'s all over the two countries and to inform them about services offered by G.S.O. The trips also produce information on local problems and activities, and this can be shared with other groups.

In 1977, more than 1,100 people from all over the world visited G.S.O.

Staff meetings are held three times a month.

Folders containing the week's correspondence of the G.S.O. staff are circulated to all staff members and the Grapevine, along with a folder of publications and one of newspaper clippings.

Cora Louise Belford

Treatment Facilities

New — "Where Do I Go From Here?"

Trustees' committee: A new outline for "A.A. in Treatment Facilities" (formerly "A.A. in Hospitals") was approved by the committee.

We suggested that a slide presentation, similar to "Circles of

Love and Service," be prepared to motivate people to participate in all institutions work as well as to revive sponsorship. This was referred to A.A.W.S.

We recommended that a one-page article be prepared to define A.A.'s role and spell out what A.A. does and does not do, for patients leaving a facility.

We discussed discount literature packages for short-term patients in treatment facilities and felt it would be best for local areas to make up their own.

We recommended that Literature's Audiovisual Subcommittee discuss carrying the A.A. message to patients who cannot cope with the printed word while in early treatment. We also suggested making cassettes or tapes in Spanish.

Ed Small, chairperson

Staff report: As of March 1, 1978, we had 1,348 groups in treatment facilities, a growth of about 65 groups since 1977. This seems to indicate more alcoholics are being referred to A.A. from treatment facilities. Because of the overwhelming flow in some areas, guidelines have been prepared sharing how some areas cope with this influx of new alcoholics.

Correspondence with groups in treatment facilities shows that institutions committees are active. They offer follow-up sponsorship, but there is always need for more A.A.'s interested in this.

The new *Directory of A.A. Groups in Treatment Facilities* is expected to be ready in 1978.

Many regular A.A. groups now meet in treatment facilities, with A.A.'s in the community welcome to attend. (These are listed as regular A.A. groups in the appropriate directory. Listing in the treatment facilities directory indicates that the meeting is for "inside" members only.)

A one-page sheet, "Where Do I Go From Here?," has been prepared for the patient leaving a facility. It makes clear that A.A. on the "outside" is willing to help, and explains that the facility is *not* A.A.

To carry the message to those in treatment facilities, we offer correspondence with the staff member on this assignment and also with outside A.A.'s. Each new treatment facility group gets a Group Handbook and complimentary literature, the *Directory of A.A. Groups in Treatment Facilities*, Box 4-5-9, and, three times yearly, the *Institutions Bulletin*. A discount package of A.A. literature is available to these groups. Guidelines for Institutions Committees are also available. Our filmstrips and films are available on loan to such groups.

Beth Kuhlmann

World Service Meeting

This staff report was given as a presentation. See p. 18.

Reports From the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: This has been a banner year for the Grapevine. With the March issue, the GV achieved a circulation of 100,000 subscriptions. It has also been a year of changes. Kitty Kiernan, circulation manager for almost ten years, retired at the end of December. Jack Morley retires May 1, after 16 years at the Grapevine, eight of them as editor. Jack's best-known contribution may be Victor E., but far more important are his love, dedication, and professional skills as both editor and artist, primary factors in making the Grapevine the outstanding magazine it is today.

At the January 24 meeting of the Grapevine Corporate Board, action was taken to increase the number of board members from nine to 11 by the addition of two regional trustees, one from the U.S. and one from Canada. Since those trustees already have Conference votes, this action does not change the Conference voting ratio.

In compliance with a 1977 Conference action, we turned over to the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board \$492,230 (of which \$388,835 was deferred liability for unfulfilled subscriptions, and \$103,835 was a contribution to the fund). This left the Grapevine with a \$90,765 net worth at year's end.

Charles Hanson, chairperson

Staff report: The year has been one of tremendous growth for the Grapevine, and signs point to even more rapid growth in

the future. The rate of circulation increase gained momentum particularly in the last quarter of 1977 largely because a 1977 Conference action recommended that delegates be responsible for establishing area Grapevine committees, using area and district service structures to achieve the goal of a Grapevine representative in every group. At this writing, there are 68 areas with Grapevine committees and 2,000 GvRs.

Our mail has increased greatly, practically all reflecting enthusiasm. We are receiving more and better manuscripts. Outstanding among the many excellent articles published in the last year was the Bill W. - Yale correspondence of 1954, when Bill was offered an honorary degree of Doctor of Laws. The Grapevine is a "meeting in print," a tool for sober living. In the past 12 issues, we have published primarily articles on the A.A. way of coping with the problems of sober living, on spiritual experience, the Steps and Traditions, carrying the message, and sponsorship. We also try to publish occasional articles by non-A.A.'s who have something significant to say, such as "What A.A. Meetings Taught a Non-A.A. Counselor."

Despite his apparent unwillingness to surrender, Victor E. has still not taken that first drink, thanks to circumstances or, more probably, to his Higher Power.

Jack Morley, Retha Gresham, Ann Warner

Grapevine circulation—geographical breakdown: See inside back cover.

In three sessions, Ask-It Basket questions (written, unsigned) brought up various matters of concern to A.A.'s. Here is a representative selection. In some cases, similar questions have been combined or grouped when a single answer would cover more than one query.

A.A. directories

Q Regarding printouts for directories, would it be possible to allow delegates additional time for returning the information to G.S.O.? Or to schedule this at some time other than the Christmas holidays?

A Our current schedule calls for mailing printouts to delegates in the early fall of 1978, and allowing several months for their return.

Q Could you get a group conscience on listing a group whose name indicates its members have cross addictions?

A A 1974 Conference action stated that all A.A. groups should be listed in the directory. At the 1978 Conference, a show of hands indicated that 54 were in favor of listing and 26 were opposed. (Note: Since listing such groups would involve a change in policy, and Ask-It Basket sessions do not constitute Advisory Actions, this subject will be placed on the agenda of the 1979 Conference for discussion.)

Anonymity

Q Do we have the right to use other members' last names at A.A. meetings?

A "Although no member should ever reveal another's membership, the co-founders and many others have warned over the years that if maintained as an underground movement or secret society, A.A. might well die. But they have just as staunchly warned against anonymity-breaking at the level of press, radio/TV, and films."—"Understanding Anonymity"

Q Is it a violation of anonymity if a tape library of A.A. talks is lent out without the speakers' permission?

A The sense of the meeting was that the practice of using full names is acceptable on tapes, etc. to be used within the Fellowship, provided the permission of the speaker is obtained.

Clubs

Q What is the experience of allowing outside organizations (women's clubs, etc.) to meet in clubs?

A It is up to the clubs—which are not A.A. as such. However, in the acceptance of contributions, a 1967 Advisory Action states that "... clubs should operate within A.A. Traditions and abide by them to the fullest."

Conferences and conventions

Q What is the feeling of the Conference on selling A.A. directories with other A.A. literature at A.A. conferences and other functions where literature is available to outsiders?

A Directories should not be on display for sale to non-A.A.'s.

Q Our area has an annual tri-state convention, which voted to divide the surplus between G.S.O. and the state committees.

One member feels the state should not accept this, saying it's a violation of Tradition Seven.

A The contributions are from an A.A. event, not outside; therefore, G.S.O. accepts contributions of this type, and there is no reason why a state A.A. committee should not.

Q Should we let trinket and A.A. jewelry displays have space to sell these products at conventions?

A It is a matter of local autonomy, but the sense of the meeting was that this practice should not be encouraged.

Cooperation with the professional community

Q Our state commission on alcohol and drug abuse has asked the governor to proclaim a "Freedom From Alcohol" week. A dignitary from Washington and others have been invited to address the legislature, and members of A.A. have been asked to attend as recovered alcoholics. What is your opinion of this?

A In a similar circumstance, one area sent representatives as observers only. Some areas take part in such events as health fairs, but there seemed to be mixed feelings on such participation.

Q Should we permit the National Council on Alcoholism or any other non-A.A. agency to have displays, post signs, or have hospitality rooms at our conventions?

A This is inappropriate, because it suggests affiliation.

Q How many areas have started C.P.C. committees, and is there some way in which experience can be shared?

A More than half of the areas have C.P.C. committees. The *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin* provides an opportunity for areas to share P.I. and C.P.C. experiences.

Correctional facilities

Q Hard-cover books and pamphlets with staples are not allowed in our county jails. Could these be made available without staples?

A Where this is a problem, we suggest that local A.A.'s take the books apart and rebind them.

Finance

Q Can the \$300 personal contribution limit per year be increased in view of the devalued dollar?

A This must be brought about by Conference action.

Q Is there a limit on contributions received at G.S.O. from roundups, conventions, etc.?

A There are no limits on contributions from groups, districts, or any A.A. function.

General Service Board

Q Why does G.S.O. use the General Fund for regional forums?

A Regional forums are board functions, and board expenses are paid from the General Fund.

Q Please explain the royalties on the A.A. books.

A The royalties agreement on the books Bill wrote are covered in a contract between Bill and the board. The royalty is

15% of the retail price. The contract provides that he could pass the royalties along to his widow, and that she could pass them on to another family member who is over 40 years of age at that time. Following the death of the family member, the royalties cease to exist and the money reverts to A.A. The dollar amount is reported yearly in the *Conference Report* [see p. 50].

General Service Conference

Q It has been suggested that candidates for delegate declare their intention one month before the election. Is there a reaction to this?

A Some delegates feel such notice should not be required. Other areas, where nominations from the floor are accepted, still prefer to have advance notice so résumés can be circulated among the groups to obtain a better-informed group conscience. Also, it was pointed out that members who do not wish to serve should make their feelings known beforehand.

Q How many delegates are presently involved in personal sponsorship?

A Almost all.

Q How many areas do not have districts?

A Four.

Q How many areas automatically elect (a) area chairperson as delegate, or (b) delegate as area chairperson?

A Practices vary from area to area.

Q Some state or area assemblies never follow the Third Legacy voting procedures. Why?

A "The A.A. Service Manual" says eligible voters are committee persons and G.S.R.'s. Our area tries to abide by the manual to elect a delegate, but the assembly decides each time that committee persons are not eligible to vote, because the home group of each committee would have two votes. The philosophy of the assembly is that there should be "one group — one vote." What is the rationale behind the manual's instructions that both G.S.R.'s and committee persons should be eligible to vote for the delegate?

A The procedures described in the "The A.A. Service Manual" are suggested procedures only. Ultimately, this is a matter of local autonomy. (See manual, pp. 51-52, 1977 edition.)

Q How do we settle problems between the general service area committee and the intergroup?

A In one area, a member of the general service committee acts as liaison and meets periodically with the intergroup office. The areas of responsibility are spelled out in "The A.A. Service Manual" (p. 83, 1977 edition). One area noted that all such problems disappeared after several people from the central office attended a regional forum.

Q Two questions have come up at our service meetings: (a) A group is close to the dividing line of two areas. The meeting is held in one area, but members live in another. The group is registered in the area where the meetings take place, but the members want the group to be a part of the area they live in. Can they do this? (b) A group wishes to be part of a different area. Its members are closer to the service centers (central office, G.S.R. meetings, district meetings) of the area they wish to belong to. Can they do this?

A Yes. Both can be done. See p. 51 in the 1977 "A.A. Service Manual" — "Who Is Seated?"

Q In my state, there are numerous A.A. entities — i.e., intergroup or central offices, assemblies, institutions committees, etc. — that have accumulated treasuries far in excess of apparent need. Are we breaching our tradition of corporate poverty through this accumulation of funds with no stated A.A. purposes?

A A 1977 Conference action recommended that: "A suggested prudent reserve for a group be dependent on local needs; and that a suggested prudent reserve for central offices, intergroups, and area committees preferably be one to 12 months' operating expense, depending on local needs."



General Service Office

Q Should G.S.O. suggest speakers for conferences and conventions when asked?

A Sense of the meeting: Other than invitations to staff members, leave G.S.O. out of this.

Q I hear Lois W.'s book has a lot of A.A. history in it. Will it be submitted for Conference approval? Will G.S.O. distribute it at a discount to A.A. groups?

A We have nothing to do with this book. The book will not be submitted to us, and so far, G.S.O. has no plans to distribute it.

Q How many copies of "Bill W." did A.A.W.S. commit itself to buy? How many did it actually purchase? How many did G.S.O. distribute?

A G.S.O. was committed to sell 2,500 copies. In 1975, 6,093 copies were sold, and in 1976, 3,067, for a total of 9,160. Then the 1976 Conference recommended that G.S.O. cease to distribute this book.

Q In regard to group information printouts and forms for new groups, would it be feasible to delete the G.S.R.'s home address and use the group mailing address?

A We suggest strongly that every group have its own post office box. When there is a change of G.S.R., the group would still receive its mail.

Q When will district numbers be incorporated on group printouts?

A We are working on such a program for 1979 group information.

Q Could the complicated, confusing form entitled "Group Information Record" be made more simple? A facsimile,

showing one filled out correctly, could be added to "The A.A. Service Manual."

A We are presently redesigning the form. Facsimiles will be included in the manual and "The A.A. Group."

Q Would it be possible to have a quarterly report form for making changes of G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s?

A We have such a form, with old data on the left, new on the right.

Q Why are letters to G.S.O. from individuals answered faster than those from groups?

A If a letter contains an order, a check, a change in listing, etc., it may be delayed before reaching the appropriate staff member. Otherwise, all correspondence is handled as quickly as possible.

Q I'd like details on G.S.R. schools. How do these "schools" operate in view of the G.S.O. position that we do not teach, or formalize educating the A.A. member?

A The word "school" is probably misleading. One area started this type of program a few years ago, discussing "The A.A. Service Manual," a chapter at a time. Also, several past delegates meet with G.S.R.'s and talk on service structure. The paper "Building a Service Structure — One Region's Experience" is available from G.S.O.

Q Why does G.S.O. offer a list of suppliers selling jewelry, films about alcoholism, etc.? Such a list from G.S.O. has been interpreted as A.A. endorsement "by implication."

A Sense of the meeting: The list should be discontinued.

Q A.A. literature has been revised with no indication that it is different. Would it be feasible to indicate on the cover something like "Revised by Conference action 1978"?

A Each time there is a reprinting, there is an indication as to when the printing took place. Most revisions are merely updating and are not by Conference action. Sense of the meeting: Include "Rev." and the date on all reprintings.

Q What percentage of A.A. literature is sold to non-A.A. buyers?

A About 15%. One facility alone buys 10%. We must sell our literature to anyone who wishes to buy it (with the exception of our directories, sold to non-A.A.'s only with the delegate's approval).

Q Is there a list available of free printed helps from G.S.O., such as the information for courts and other referral agencies?

A We are preparing a list of all available service material, and the list will be published in *Box 4-5-9*.

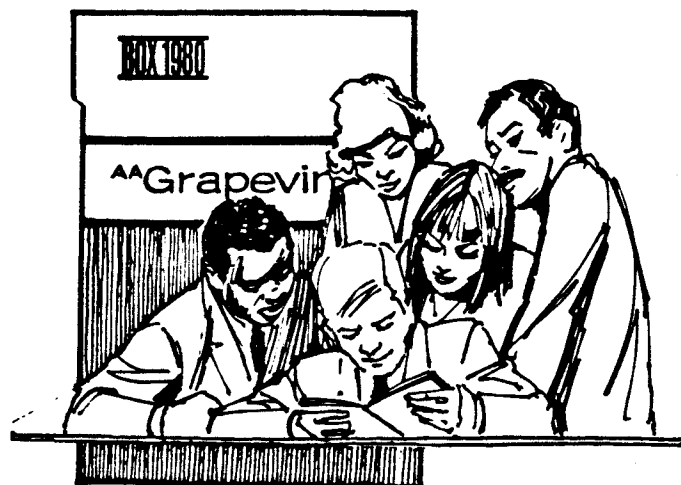
Q Several groups have received wrong orders, such as 50 copies of "Living Sober" instead of 25 copies of "Twelve and Twelve." Any remedy?

A When this happens, please notify us immediately — call collect.

Grapevine

Q The May Grapevine has an article opposed to bumper stickers, e.g., "Easy Does It," etc. What is the opinion of this Conference?

A The Grapevine is, in a sense, a meeting in print. We often hear things at meetings we do not agree with. Sense of the meeting: Bumper stickers are okay for those who want them.



Q One past delegate maintains that he and Bill W. were in favor of Grapevine representatives being given a vote at assembly meetings. In our area, it was suggested that GvRs be given a vote. What is thought of the idea of making the G.S.R. also the GvR?

A Most assemblies give GvRs a voice but no vote, as the G.S.R. votes the group's conscience. Whether the same person is both G.S.R. and GvR is a matter of group autonomy. However, by keeping the jobs separate, another member has an opportunity to serve, and work as GvR may lead to other types of A.A. service.

Group Affairs

Q The group has in excess of \$200 in the group treasury and a member of the group takes off with these funds. This is a felony, because of the amount of money involved. What charges can be brought against this member to get this money returned?

A There is no way A.A. can sue anybody. The best protection against such an occurrence is to require two signatures on checks. In the case of cash, there is nothing that can be done.

Q An A.A. group has had the same G.S.R. for the past eight years, and she does not want to quit. What is this group to do?

A Vote her out.

Q Is there a conflict with a person holding an office in A.A. and at the same time holding an office in Al-Anon? Is there any conflict if a person dually addicted holds office in an A.A. group and an N.A. group simultaneously?

A Restrictions would be unwise, as they could possibly be applied to a variety of non-A.A. organizations such as church groups, Boy Scouts, etc.

Q Several people have come to A.A. who cannot read. Would it be permissible to put the "Twelve and Twelve" explanation of the Steps on tape for these people?

A Yes.

Q Do we tend to commercialize A.A. by holding increasing numbers of social functions to raise money, rather than relying on group and/or individual contributions (passing the basket) to support our services?

A Practices vary from area to area. Some areas have found that

attendance increases when social functions are kept on a cost or slightly-above-cost basis.

Q What is the legal position of an A.A. member signing a contract for an A.A. group? Specifically, a lease to rent a facility?
A The person who signs the lease would be responsible. There is a moral responsibility on the part of the group, but no legal obligation.

Q Is a "meeting" that is not a group self-supporting?
A Any A.A. entity should be self-supporting.

Literature

A The 1976 *Conference Report* stated that delegates were to tell their areas that "only" the stories in the third edition of the Big Book would be changed. Why the deletions from the foreword without Conference approval?

A The above statement was referring to the "text" of the Big Book. It was felt that in the interest of accuracy and honesty, outdated figures and statistics that could not be validated should be deleted. Since the foreword is not part of the text, Conference approval was not considered necessary at the time the deletions were made. The topic was already on the agenda of the 1978 Conference Literature Committee; its recommendations resulted in Advisory Actions 22 and 23 (p. 48).

Q Could A.A.W.S. publish a Conference-approved book to be used instead of "Twenty-Four Hours a Day," published by Hazelden?

A We could, if so directed. However, "As Bill Sees It" is the

equivalent. It is not along the lines of the "24-hour book," because we are not religion-oriented.

Q When will the new corrected edition of "As Bill Sees It" be ready?

A It is now available. Changes involved new page references for excerpts from "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions," in which pages had to be renumbered in order to include the long form of the Traditions.

Public Information

Q When will the results of the survey taken in July 1977 be available to the Fellowship?

A In September 1978.

Q Does our Conference approve the Florida TV tapes? Will they appear on our Literature Order Form? Can they be ordered now?

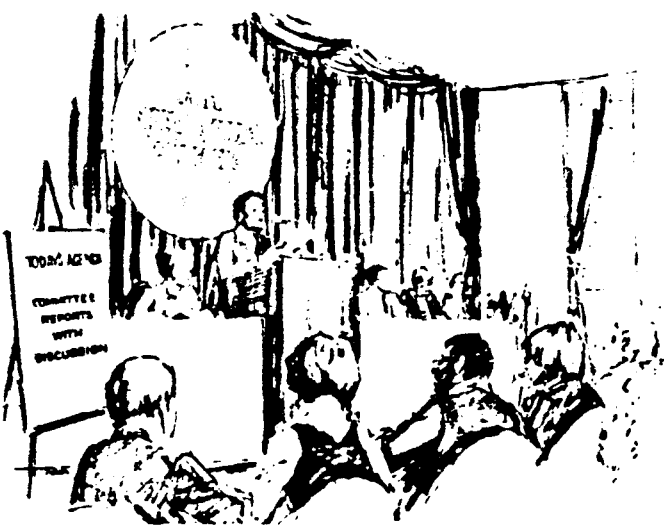
A The 1978 Conference approved them. They are available now. Please contact G.S.O. for specific information.

Treatment Facilities

Q Has any area experienced patients' being charged for A.A. meetings in treatment facilities?

A This has been encountered at the corporate level, at rehabs, and at the Federal and local government level. Explaining the A.A. program to those in charge of such alcoholism programs was suggested.

Collective Group Conscience Voiced



The group conscience of the Fellowship in the U.S. and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory (to the board) Actions, which the General Service Board approved in its legally required annual meeting just after the Conference. In addition to the actions introduced on the floor before the whole Conference, others were based upon the reports of the Conference committees. (Members and officers of the 1978 committees are listed on p. 56.)

Floor Actions

1 After considerable discussion following the presentation on "The Role of the General Service Trustee — U.S./Canada," a motion was carried requesting the General Service Board of trustees to make a study of the possibility of restructuring the A.A. Conference regions and report back to the 1979 Conference.

2 Following the presentation on the possible relocation of the General Service Office, the Conference reaffirmed the recommendation of the 1977 General Service Conference that it would not be in the best interest of the Fellowship to relocate

the General Service Office at this time.

3 A motion was carried that the film of the 1960 International Convention in Long Beach, Calif., be kept for archival purposes only.

4 The following Class B regional trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board: George Dorsey, Pacific U.S. (four years); Fernand Ippersiel, Eastern Canada (four years).

Presentations related to Floor Action 1: p. 16

Presentation related to Floor Action 2: p. 13

Presentations and workshop related to Floor Action 3: pp. 25-27, 28

Floor Action 4: brief biographies of new trustees on pp. 58-59

Agenda

5 That the theme of the 1979 General Service Conference be built around "The Legacies: *Our* Heritage and *My* Responsibility."

6 The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 1979 Conference consist of six speakers — three delegates and three members of the G.S.O./GV staffs — and that all members of the G.S.O. and GV staffs be seated on the dais. It further recommended that the format of the meeting be reviewed each year by the Conference Agenda Committee.

7 The following be subjects for presentations at the 1979 Conference: archives; the Three Legacies; "Let Gratitude Be Our Attitude"; "Are We Building a Class Distinction in Service?"; "The Vote and the Voice — Who Is in Control?"; "Our Responsibilities to the Future"; "How Do Roundups, Jamborees, Cruises, Rallies, etc. Fit Into A.A. Tradition?"

8 A topic for a workshop at the 1979 Conference be "Group Autonomy and A.A. Unity," and a question be included in this workshop concerning the difference between an A.A. group and an A.A. meeting.

9 The subject of listing special-interest groups in the A.A. directories not be included on the agenda of the 1979 Conference.

10 In response to a request from a past delegate that levels of service (group, district, area) be explored to try to determine whether the current structure provides maximum opportunity for the best possible service in the Fellowship, the committee felt that the current structure does provide such opportunity.

Cooperation with the Professional Community

11 A.A. members who meet with the administration of a treatment facility concerning the formation of an A.A. group on its premises should explain group autonomy as well as what A.A. can and cannot do (Traditions), and also should have a good understanding of the facility's rules and regulations. After mutual agreements are reached, it is important that this information be shared with the A.A.'s who will be attending the group's meetings. It was suggested that groups meeting in treatment facilities try to abide by the self-support Tradition. If money for rent is not accepted by a facility, groups should contribute

in some other way. It was also felt that A.A.'s employed by the facility should not run the groups at the facility.

Presentations and workshops related to cooperation with the professional community: pp. 10-11, 15, 22-23, 27-28

Correctional Facilities

12 It was recommended that the manuscript of the new inmate pamphlet, "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," be accepted pending mail-poll approval by the committee of the final edited version and illustrations, and that production then proceed under the direction of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities, with the word "hell" being omitted from the title. The committee further recommended that consideration be given to the use of color illustrations if financially feasible.

13 It was recommended that a future Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities consider developing a booklet aimed at the alcoholic inmate, if warranted.

Presentation on correctional facilities: p. 11

Finance

14 That a new pamphlet on finance, in at least two colors, be prepared and distributed to stress: (a) self-support through the 60-30-10 plan; (b) how the 60-30-10 plan helps carry the A.A. message around the world.

It was further recommended that the title of the pamphlet be "Self Supporting? The 60-30-10 Plan." It was also recommended that G.S.O. prepare and distribute a chart illustrating how money flows through the G.S.O. finance structure.

15 Group treasurers continue to be reached through the G.S.R.'s and through the local service level. It was further recommended that, when it becomes feasible, contributions be acknowledged, as received, to group treasurers or to whoever the sender may be.

16 The delegate area contribution to Conference expense be increased from \$200 to \$300.

Presentations on finance: pp. 14-15, 20-22

Grapevine

17 That delegates continue their efforts in using the area and district service structure to achieve the goal of a Grapevine representative in every group.

18 A Grapevine information table be made a regular feature at all conferences, conventions, and assemblies. (A Grapevine Conference Display Kit is available at no cost.)

19 Committees on public information, cooperation with the professional community, correctional facilities, and treatment facilities explore the use of the A.A. Grapevine in their endeavors.

20 Area and state functions consider Grapevine workshops similar to other workshops held at the area level from time to time.

Literature

21 That neither a story about someone with a language barrier nor a story about a physician be added to the pamphlet "Do You Think You're Different?" at this time.

22 In the next printing of "Alcoholics Anonymous," the foreword of the second edition be included as it was originally published in the second edition.

23 It was strongly recommended that the delegates should be made aware of any changes under consideration in the book "Alcoholics Anonymous" prior to publication.

24 No changes be made in the pamphlet "Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?" as there is no need for clarification.

25 The test film shown to the Conference Literature Committee be expanded to a film approximately 25 minutes in length for the purpose of carrying the A.A. message to the general public, with the understanding that the film will be presented to the 1979 General Service Conference for approval prior to distribution.



Test footage shown at Conference demonstrated protection of anonymity.

26 The Conference Literature Committee recommended that a change be made in its scope to read: "To review new literature and audiovisual needs," and that this proposal be forwarded to the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference for review at its quarterly meeting in July in order to avoid possible overlap or duplication of the various Conference committees' functions.

Conference Policy/Admissions

27 It was recommended to the Conference Report and Charter Committee that a section be added to Chapter V of "The A.A. Service Manual" regarding applications for additional areas and delegates, and that excerpts from Bill's 1961 memo on the size of the Conference be included as well as the information that application forms are available from G.S.O.

28 The questionnaire for the 28th General Service Conference was satisfactory, and no changes were suggested.

29 The committee felt that the description in Chapter VII of "The A.A. Service Manual" on why the Conference has committees is adequate, and suggested that reports of the trustees' quarterly meetings continue to be sent to members of the corresponding Conference committees. Communication between committee members and G.S.O. between Conferences should be encouraged.

30 Selections from Conference talks made by Bill and Bern Smith beginning with the First General Service Conference, in 1951, be circulated to the Conference and trustees' Literature Committees so that consideration could be given to making this material available to the Fellowship in printed form.

31 The opening date for the 1979 General Service Conference be delayed until April 22 in order to permit delegates to avoid travel complications.

32 The Conference did not accept the recommendation of the committee re observers at committee meetings. It was the sense of the meeting that we adhere to paragraph 2, on *Composition* of the Conference ("A.A. Service Manual," page 23).

Public Information

33 That existing G.S.O. TV spot announcements and the TV spots made available by the Northern Florida Public Information Committee remain in use at this time. It was further suggested that new TV spot announcements be considered by the 1979 Conference Public Information Committee and that when they are made, they deal more with the alcoholic than with his family.

34 The existing radio spot announcements continue to be used, and the radio spots reported on by the committee member from Tennessee be reviewed by the trustees' Public Information Committee for possible distribution in the United States and Canada.

35 It was recommended that the following items be added to the Public Information Kit: "A.A. at a Glance," "Is A.A. for You?," "This Is A.A.," and a one-sheet piece describing the one-way display and how to order it.

36 A sentence describing the one-way display and how to order it should be added under "Displays" in the P.I. Guidelines.

37 The A.A. Public Information Manual be reviewed, updated, and made consistent with other materials in the Public Information Kit, the statistics be updated, and a notation be made in the new manual stating that it supersedes the manual printed in February 1973.

38 It was recommended that Background Editorial and Background Radio and TV Material be reviewed and updated by the trustees' Public Information Committee.

39 In order to encourage attendance at public information meetings by non-A.A.'s, the current Guidelines be amended to include personal contact as a follow-up to invitations extended to the public.

40 One of the Canadian P.I. committees be invited to do an article on public information meetings and/or industrial luncheons for the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*, since they seem to have greater success in getting the non-A.A. public to attend such functions.

41 A.A. members be encouraged to invite their doctors, lawyers, etc. to their group anniversary meetings.

42 It was recommended that there was no further necessity for a special meeting of the Conference Committees on Public Information and Cooperation with the Professional Community. However, it was suggested that a table be set aside at lunch for members of the P.I. and C.P.C. Committees on one day of the Conference for the purpose of sharing.

Presentations on public information: pp. 10, 25-26

Report and Charter

43 That Article 5 on page 24 of "The A.A. Service Manual" be amended to read: "*Area Assemblies: Composition of:* Assemblies, designated as area assemblies, are composed of the elected general service representatives of all A.A. groups desiring to participate, district committee members, and area committee officers in each of the delegate areas of the United States and Canada."

44 Changes on page 53 of "The A.A. Service Manual" be made to read: "After group expenses are met, a suggested division among the three services listed above is the 60-30-10 plan (60%, intergroup or central office; 30%, General Service Office; and 10%, area committee)."

45 At the end of the third paragraph on page 39 of "The A.A. Service Manual," the following be added: "When redistricting, group approval is essential."

46 The Conference did not accept the committee's recommendation to include in "The A.A. Service Manual" in chapters relative to service work the suggestion that trusted servants at all levels be reimbursed for expenses in service work.

47 The map on page 97 of "The A.A. Service Manual" read: "Southeast Region (includes Puerto Rico and the Bahama Islands)."

48 A paragraph or two be added on suggested guidelines for area and central office newsletters, possibly at the end of the chapter, on page 87 of "The A.A. Service Manual."

49 G.S.O. expand the index in the back of "The A.A. Service Manual" for review by the Conference Report and Charter Committee in 1979.

50 The following be added to page 46 of "The A.A. Service Manual": "Alternate D.C.M.'s are also voting members of the committee in the absence of the D.C.M." (Delete "See preceding chapter.")

51 All groups in the U.S. Virgin Islands and the Bahama Islands be listed in the next printing of the *Eastern U.S. A.A. Directory*.

52 The Conference Report and Charter Committee accepted



the recommendation of the Committee on Conference Policy/Admissions that a section be added to Chapter V in "The A.A. Service Manual" regarding applications for additional areas and delegates, and that excerpts from Bill's 1961 memo on the size of the Conference be included as well as the information that application forms are available from G.S.O.

53 The Conference Report and Charter Committee recommended that its scope be expanded to include the responsibility for proposing changes in the format or composition of the six directories: Eastern U.S., Western U.S., Canadian, International, Treatment Facilities, and Correctional Facilities. The committee further recommended that this proposal be forwarded to the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference for review at its quarterly meeting in July in order to avoid possible overlap or duplication of the various Conference committees' functions.

Treatment Facilities

54 That the outline for revision of the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Facilities" be approved with suggestions to be incorporated in the pamphlet.

Presentations and workshops related to treatment facilities: pp. 10-11, 15, 22-23, 27-28

Committee on Trustees

55 That the following persons be elected as trustees of the General Service Board at its annual meeting [see p. 39; Conference and board approved the slate presented by the trustees' Nominating Committee]; and that the following be elected as officers of the General Service Board at its annual meeting [see p. 39; slate of officers also approved].

56 The title "general service trustee - U.S./Canada" be changed to "trustee-at-large."

57 Trustee candidate resúmes continue to carry the question regarding employment in the alcoholism field.

58 The Conference unanimously reaffirmed the 1977 recommendation of the Conference Committee on Trustees that a Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee continue to serve as chairperson of the board.

Presentations related to Advisory Action 56: p. 16

INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Office

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1977

INCOME	1977	1976
Net sales, after book discounts waived of \$74,092 in 1977 and \$133,767 in 1976	\$2,383,334	\$2,244,212
Less: Cost of printing	677,503	591,161
Royalties	296,957	263,670
Gross profit from literature	1,408,874	1,389,381
Contributions – A.A. groups and members	1,004,608	946,633
Interest income	40,699	41,838
<u>Total income</u>	<u>2,454,181</u>	<u>2,377,852</u>
EXPENSES		
Salaries	954,842	899,711
Rent	110,046	97,680
Box 4-5-9	49,510	45,153
A.A. directories	57,780	63,562
Other service printing	57,096	48,801
Shipping and mailing	209,561	193,115
Other office expenses	213,355	196,969
Insurance and payroll taxes	100,052	85,185
Professional services	27,344	24,086
Board, committee, and staff meetings	43,723	36,324
1976 World Service Meeting	–	26,301
Writing, research	22,551	5,143
P.I.C. and C.P.C.C. travel	24,558	33,384
General Service Conference	76,166	64,717
E.D.P. system development	166,882	9,146
Regional forums and other expenses	31,947	16,671
Office relocation study	–	5,000
<u>Total Expense</u>	<u>2,145,413</u>	<u>1,850,948</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>308,768</u>	<u>526,904</u>

NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION

Publishing – A.A. World Services, Inc.	\$ 546,590	\$ 776,670
General Fund – General Service Board	(237,822)	(249,766)

CHANGES IN OTHER FUNDS – 1977

	Reserve	Deferred Pension
Balance, January 1	\$ 480,737	\$ 45,193
Book discounts		74,092
Transfers from: A.A. World Services, Inc.	835,400	
A.A. General Service Board – General Fund	282,000	
A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	103,835	1,750
Investment Income	54,446	2,467
Less: Current funding costs		(77,648)
Past service costs		(32,703)
Actuary fee		(13,151)
Balance, December 31	<u>1,756,418</u>	<u>-0-</u>

() denotes red figures.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.—Notes to Financial Statements, December 31, 1977

Note A – Purposes and Restrictions of Different Funds

The RESERVE FUND was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which, during 1977, was redefined as one year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The 1977 General Service Conference recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That Advisory Action was approved by the board of trustees, and the operating entities transferred all of their funds in excess of those required for working capital. The transfer from The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., included amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers and is, therefore, reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund.

INCOME STATEMENT

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1977

Financial statements

	1977	1976
INCOME – from subscriptions and other sales	<u>\$541,798</u>	<u>\$483,515</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries	\$ 62,707	\$ 56,148
Printing	116,847	102,376
Mailing – Service	37,957	28,405
– Postage	26,379	20,948
Other printing costs	4,350	4,029
Calendar costs	19,264	18,278
Occupancy costs	10,117	9,605
Telephone	1,603	1,367
Office supplies and expenses	4,240	3,438
Other editorial expenses	6,989	3,284
Office cleaning	<u>2,614</u>	<u>2,511</u>
<u>Total</u>	293,067	250,389
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries	81,923	61,056
Data processing costs	23,559	19,409
Stationery and supplies	4,650	3,397
Occupancy costs	10,117	9,605
Telephone	1,603	1,367
Other office expense	4,730	1,189
Selling expense – Regular	24,883	16,071
– GvR program	2,589	–
Postage	14,770	10,989
Office cleaning	2,614	2,511
Bad debts	<u>418</u>	<u>557</u>
<u>Total</u>	171,856	126,151
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Transition salaries	13,494	37,544
Consultant fees	4,500	–
Insurance	5,138	4,539
Legal and accounting	5,700	5,100
Payroll taxes	10,150	9,469
Meetings and conferences	962	727
Furniture and equipment	1,445	550
Contribution to Retirement Plan	<u>3,500</u>	<u>3,500</u>
<u>Total</u>	<u>44,889</u>	<u>61,429</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>509,812</u>	<u>437,969</u>
INCOME FROM OPERATIONS	31,986	45,546
Interest earned	<u>22,393</u>	<u>23,717</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>54,379</u>	<u>69,263</u>

(continued)

The DEFERRED PENSION FUND was established in 1965 to receive moneys for the Retirement Plan for the employees of A.A. World Services, Inc., and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., prior to transfer to the trustee of the A.A. Retirement Trust. The 1977 General Service Conference recommended – and the board of trustees approved – discontinuing book discount contributions to the Deferred Pension Fund as of July 1, 1977. The cost of the Retirement Plan will henceforth be borne entirely by the operating entities of the General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

The GENERAL FUND comprises those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed.

(continued)

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1977

	December 31, 1977		December 31, 1976	
OPERATING FUNDS	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
ASSETS				
Cash	\$ 130,839	\$ 153,673	\$ 142,938	\$ 112,283
Savings accounts and certificates	576,420	207,677	1,166,691	274,483
Investment (Note C)	—	114,198	—	125,144
Accounts receivable	64,599	1,271	90,355	4,711
Due from Grapevine	2,334	—	30,000	—
Inventories	446,602	6,673	321,700	2,502
Prepaid expenses	49,766	16,403	37,713	16,986
<u>Total Assets</u>	<u>1,270,560</u>	<u>499,895</u>	<u>1,789,397</u>	<u>536,109</u>
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and accruals payable	183,178	11,985	122,729	39,667
Due Pension Fund	—	—	10,254	—
Due Reserve Fund	339,600	—	100,000	—
Prepaid subscriptions	—	388,395	—	349,221
Reserve for Retirement Plan payments	—	8,750	—	7,000
<u>Total Liabilities</u>	<u>522,778</u>	<u>409,130</u>	<u>232,983</u>	<u>395,888</u>
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	1,556,414	140,221	1,089,510	110,958
Net income for year (Exhibits A and B)	308,768	54,379	526,904	69,263
Transfer from (to)				
Reserve Fund	(1,117,400)	(103,835)	(100,000)	—
General Fund	—	—	40,000	(40,000)
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>747,782</u>	<u>90,765</u>	<u>1,556,414</u>	<u>140,221</u>
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	\$ 690,769		\$1,217,401	
General Fund — G.S.B. (Note B)	57,013		339,013	
Total Operating Funds — as above	747,782		1,556,414	
Reserve Fund	1,756,418		480,737	
Deferred Pension Fund	—		45,193	
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>2,504,200</u>		<u>2,082,344</u>	
RESERVE AND DEFERRED PENSION FUNDS	Reserve		Deferred Pension	
Cash	\$ 27,182		\$ 54,865	
Savings accounts and certificates	622,045		—	
Due from A.A.W.S.	57,600		—	
Due from General Fund	282,000		—	
Due from A.A. Grapevine	274,197		—	
U.S. Treasury obligations	653,700		—	
Government agency and corporate bonds	210,297		—	
Accrued interest	17,792		—	
Less: Liability for Grapevine subscriptions	(388,395)		—	
Due trustees	—		(54,865)	
<u>Balance, December 31</u>	<u>1,756,418</u>		<u>-0-</u>	

() denotes red figures.

(continued)

Note B —After transfers of \$237,822 in 1977 and \$500,000 in 1976 from Publishing to General Fund.**Note C** — Grapevine investment with Reserve Fund — \$388,395, less amounts pending transfer, \$274,197, resulting in a net investment of \$114,198 at December 31, 1977.

The financial statements and foregoing notes have been prepared from the reports on the three separate corporations submitted by our independent certified public accountant.

1978 G.S.O. Budget

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. – PUBLISHING

Income: Sales income has been budgeted at \$2,680,700. Allowing for a continuing trend established in the latter part of 1977, and taking the growth of the Fellowship into consideration, the net increase in sales over 1977 is expected to be 12.2%. During 1978, it is anticipated that A.A.W.S., Inc., will distribute 237,000 copies of "Alcoholics Anonymous," 121,500 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" – regular edition, 31,600 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" – pocket edition, 17,500 "A.A. Comes of Age," 31,100 "As Bill Sees It," 105,000 booklets, and 6,200,000 pamphlets and miscellaneous items. After deducting \$1,152,700 – the cost of producing the literature and the royalties paid on book sales – the gross profit from sales is estimated to be \$1,528,000. Adding interest earned on daily cash flow, the total income from the publishing activity is expected to be \$1,538,000.

Expenses: Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at \$946,000. Including employee retirement costs, no longer funded by discounts donated, total expenses are budgeted to be 7.2% higher than 1977. Net publishing income, after operating expenses, is expected to be \$592,000.

GENERAL FUND – GROUP SERVICES

Income: Against the cost of servicing groups, contributions have been budgeted at \$1,087,600. Because 1977 contributions fell below budget, the increase has been set at a conservative 8.2% over the previous year.

Expenses: Total expenses, representing the cost of group services that are charged against group contributions, are expected to be \$1,168,000. Included in this portion of the General Service Office budget is the cost of the General Service Conference, totaling \$83,900. Total service expenses are budgeted to be \$80,400 greater than contribution income. This deficit will be funded from net income of the publishing operation.

GENERAL FUND – OTHER EXPENSES

Other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$237,300, less the interest earned on a day-of-deposit-to-day-of-withdrawal account. These expenses represent the cost of the quarterly trustee meetings, the expenses of the Public Information Committee and the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, the cost of regional forums, legal and auditing expenses, the World Service Meeting, plus other special projects such as a proposed film, estimated to cost \$75,000, and archival expenses. This net expense, totaling \$222,300, will also be funded out of the income from the publishing operation.

After budgeted deficits in the amount of \$302,700, the total net income for the General Service Office is anticipated to be \$289,300. After satisfying operating requirements, the balance of this net will be transferred to the General Service Board Reserve Fund.

1978 Grapevine Budget

Total income: Estimated income, from magazine and other sales, is budgeted at \$585,000. This represents an increase of \$43,000, or 8%, over 1977.

Total expenses: Editorial and printing costs are budgeted \$41,400 higher than 1977; circulation and business expense, \$9,400 higher; and general and administration expenses, \$11,800 lower than 1977. All expenses totaled are expected to be \$553,800, an increase of 8.6%.

Income from operations is budgeted at \$31,200. After satisfying operating needs, the balance of the net income will be transferred to the General Service Board Reserve Fund.

1978 G.S.O. Budget

Financial statements

The budget for 1978 operations of G.S.O. activities is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. – PUBLISHING

INCOME

Sales	\$2,680,700*
Less: Cost of products and royalties	1,152,700
Gross profit from sales	\$1,528,000
Interest income	10,000
Total income	<u>1,538,000</u>

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of income (expense)	<u>592,000</u>
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*Based on the sale of:

237,000 books – "Alcoholics Anonymous"
121,500 books – "Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions" (reg.)
31,600 books – "Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions" (pocket)
17,500 books – "A.A. Comes of Age"
31,100 books – "As Bill Sees It"

and

Pamphlets, booklets, and miscellaneous items

GENERAL FUND – GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$1,087,600
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TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of income (expense)	<u>(80,400)</u>
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****Includes cost of General Service Conference – \$83,900**

GENERAL FUND – OTHER EXPENSES

INCOME

Interest	\$ 15,000
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TOTAL EXPENSE

Excess of income (expense)	<u>(222,300)</u>
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*****Board meetings, P.I.C. expense, C.P.C. expense, legal and auditing fees, regional forums, World Service Meeting, etc.**

The publishing activity will contribute \$302,700 to offset the budgeted deficits.

1978 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and other sales	\$ 585,000
Total costs and expenses	553,800
Net income from operations	<u>31,200</u>

U.S.	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	Amount of contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per capita
Alabama	135	77	57.0%	\$ 4,772.51	1,885	\$2.53
Alaska	68	32	47.0	1,938.41	743	2.60
Arizona	285	129	45.3	8,579.04	3,827	2.24
Arkansas	134	67	50.0	4,260.87	1,897	2.24
California	2,546	1,339	52.6	105,116.10	76,405	1.37
Colorado	304	179	58.9	15,092.69	4,286	3.52
Connecticut	497	262	52.7	19,970.99	9,224	2.16
Delaware	69	51	73.9	4,268.12	966	4.41
District of Columbia	81	51	63.0	6,308.23	2,567	2.45
Florida	727	425	58.4	42,863.01	11,050	3.87
Georgia	286	215	75.2	13,774.74	4,384	3.14
Hawaii	98	44	44.9	3,294.79	1,685	1.95
Idaho	92	44	47.8	2,488.99	999	2.49
Illinois	1,372	894	65.1	34,774.39	25,387	1.36
Indiana	389	239	61.4	17,403.29	5,838	2.98
Iowa	233	127	54.5	13,332.66	4,564	2.92
Kansas	189	126	66.7	10,177.05	4,025	2.52
Kentucky	215	124	57.7	13,286.78	2,674	4.96
Louisiana	195	114	58.5	6,778.81	2,575	2.63
Maine	112	68	60.7	3,478.40	1,503	2.31
Maryland	453	263	58.0	20,839.64	6,722	3.10
Massachusetts	633	318	50.2	25,998.91	14,761	1.76
Michigan	646	374	57.9	36,671.90	13,637	2.68
Minnesota	649	371	57.2	37,636.91	19,379	1.94
Mississippi	94	59	62.8	2,962.00	1,203	2.46
Missouri	342	202	59.1	12,944.23	4,675	2.76
Montana	121	63	52.1	3,813.58	1,306	2.92
Nebraska	212	129	60.8	11,093.85	3,271	3.39
Nevada	93	53	57.0	3,005.75	1,255	2.39
New Hampshire	112	59	52.7	3,088.59	1,815	1.70
New Jersey	562	328	58.4	26,338.47	9,576	2.75
New Mexico	97	68	70.1	4,276.26	1,183	3.61
New York	1,228	606	49.3	54,510.05	24,326	2.24
North Carolina	314	220	70.1	14,598.20	4,760	3.06
North Dakota	104	73	70.2	4,354.21	1,397	3.11
Ohio	778	332	42.7	22,103.33	14,797	1.49
Oklahoma	192	156	81.2	11,661.06	2,304	5.06
Oregon	204	113	55.4	8,282.91	2,399	3.45
Pennsylvania	670	415	61.9	38,393.77	11,885	3.23
Rhode Island	91	50	54.9	3,999.26	1,210	3.30
South Carolina	122	82	67.2	9,185.89	1,806	5.08
South Dakota	100	55	55.0	4,406.97	1,513	2.91
Tennessee	188	103	54.8	5,622.97	2,492	2.25
Texas	662	371	56.0	36,761.41	15,166	2.42
Utah	105	61	58.1	3,444.60	1,186	2.90
Vermont	59	36	61.0	2,980.45	723	4.12
Virginia	345	255	73.9	19,310.96	5,520	3.49
Washington	432	255	59.0	22,551.39	6,017	3.74
West Virginia	94	65	69.1	4,038.16	1,112	3.63
Wisconsin	507	287	56.6	17,054.86	6,890	2.47
Wyoming	56	30	53.6	1,500.45	539	2.78
Commonwealth of P.R.	79	49	62.0	2,450.99	1,290	1.89
Canal Zone	3	-0-	-0-	-0-	80	-0-
Bahama Islands	5	-0-	-0-	-0-	78	-0-
Virgin Islands of U.S.	3	1	33.3	300.00	50	6.00
TOTAL for U.S.	18,382	10,509	57.2%	\$808,141.85	352,807	\$2.29

CANADA	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	Amount of contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per capita
Alberta	248	143	57.7%	\$ 10,651.99	2,866	\$3.71
Atlantic Provinces						
New Brunswick	90	56	62.2	3,083.49	1,006	3.06
Nfld. & Lab.	41	17	41.5	753.46	446	1.68
Nova Scotia	103	64	62.1	4,426.02	1,159	3.81
Prince Edward Island	37	26	70.3	1,722.46	610	2.82
British Columbia	403	217	53.8	24,024.49	5,440	4.41
Manitoba	128	64	50.0	7,040.53	2,535	2.77
N.W. Territories	11	7	63.6	225.68	112	2.01
Ontario	806	449	55.7	62,905.90	12,912	4.87
Quebec	861	353	41.0	59,943.07	20,707	2.89
Saskatchewan	218	130	59.6	8,608.16	2,901	2.96
Yukon Territory	4	3	75.0	268.40	89	3.01
TOTAL for CANADA	2,950	1,529	51.8%	\$183,654.44	50,783	\$3.61
TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA	21,332	12,038	56.4%	\$991,796.29	403,590	\$2.46

FOREIGN AND OTHER

Foreign	5,604.01
International Doctors in A.A.	300.00
International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A.	1,565.47
Hospital Groups	6,263.21
Prison Groups	325.50
World Hello	82.90
Internationalists	328.95
Internationalists Groups	117.15
International Lawyers in A.A.	100.00
GRAND TOTAL	\$1,006,483.48

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON - 1977-1976

	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	Amount of contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per capita
U.S. 1977	18,382	10,509	57.2%	\$808,141.85	352,807	\$2.29
U.S. 1976	16,557	9,396	56.7	764,510.47	320,913	2.38
Increase (Decrease)	1,825	1,113	.5%	\$ 43,631.38	31,894	(\$.09)
Canada 1977	2,950	1,529	51.8%	\$183,654.44	50,783	\$3.61
Canada 1976	2,683	1,419	52.9	167,579.25	47,843	3.50
Increase (Decrease)	267	110	(1.1%)	\$ 16,075.19	2,940	\$.11
U.S. and Canada 1977	21,332	12,038	56.4%	\$991,796.29	403,590	\$2.46
U.S. and Canada 1976	19,240	10,815	56.2	932,089.72	368,756	2.53
Increase (Decrease)	2,092	1,223	.2%	\$ 59,706.57	34,834	(\$.07)

1977 Group Contributions by Delegate Area

Group contributions

Area #	General Service Conference Area	Total # of Gps.	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	Total Group contrib.	No. of Members	Contrib. per capita
1.	Alabama/N.W. Florida	163	92	56.4%	\$ 5,585.12	2,099	\$2.66
2.	Alaska	68	32	47.0	1,745.41	743	2.34
3.	Arizona	285	129	45.2	8,332.79	3,827	2.17
4.	Arkansas	134	67	50.0	3,397.87	1,897	1.79
5.	California						
5.	Southern	694	302	43.5	23,276.33	33,588	.69
6.	Northern Coastal	720	422	58.6	28,620.03	16,475	1.73
7.	Northern Interior	276	138	50.0	7,131.21	5,447	1.30
8.	San Diego	234	146	62.3	8,147.25	5,418	1.50
9.	Mid-Southern	622	321	51.6	26,491.81	15,477	1.71
10.	Colorado	304	179	58.8	13,310.11	4,286	3.10
11.	Connecticut	497	262	52.7	14,722.83	9,224	1.59
12.	Delaware	69	51	73.9	3,936.47	966	4.07
13.	Dist. of Columbia	158	114	72.1	12,099.23	4,593	2.63
14.	Florida						
14.	Northern	217	117	53.9	6,579.67	3,009	2.18
15.	Southern	482	291	60.3	24,780.16	7,827	3.16
16.	Georgia	286	215	75.1	13,163.84	4,384	3.00
17.	Hawaii	98	44	44.8	2,911.56	1,685	1.72
18.	Idaho	69	35	50.7	1,618.44	734	2.20
19.	Illinois						
19.	Chicago	752	555	73.8	12,253.73	15,302	.80
20.	Northern	441	247	56.0	14,913.17	7,498	1.98
21.	Southern	179	82	45.8	4,419.77	1,900	2.32
22.	Indiana						
22.	Northern	238	147	61.7	8,477.72	3,374	2.51
23.	Southern	151	87	57.6	7,329.11	2,464	2.97
24.	Iowa	233	127	54.5	11,605.56	4,564	2.54
25.	Kansas	189	126	66.6	8,906.35	4,025	2.21
26.	Kentucky	215	124	57.6	11,428.12	2,785	4.10
27.	Louisiana	195	114	58.4	6,462.81	2,575	2.50
28.	Maine	120	74	61.6	3,331.30	1,609	2.07
29.	Maryland	366	202	55.1	11,838.83	4,483	2.64
30.	Massachusetts						
30.	Eastern	546	276	50.5	18,702.31	13,068	1.43
31.	Western	87	42	48.2	3,433.60	1,693	2.02
32.	Michigan						
32.	Central	193	114	59.0	11,170.98	4,665	2.39
33.	Southeastern	242	133	54.9	14,219.97	5,491	2.58
34.	Western	162	82	50.6	6,101.49	2,573	2.37
35.	Minnesota						
35.	Northern	239	144	60.2	6,878.15	5,516	1.24
36.	Southern	410	234	57.0	18,848.11	13,863	1.35
37.	Mississippi	94	59	62.7	2,712.00	1,203	2.25
38.	Missouri						
38.	Eastern	235	145	61.7	7,318.06	2,541	2.87
39.	Western	107	67	62.6	4,831.17	2,134	2.26
40.	Montana	121	63	52.0	3,735.28	1,306	2.86
41.	Nebraska	212	129	60.8	9,475.90	3,271	2.89
42.	Nevada	93	53	56.9	2,325.22	1,255	1.85
43.	New Hampshire	112	59	52.6	2,949.09	1,815	1.62
44.	New Jersey						
44.	Northern	439	241	54.8	16,781.83	8,012	2.09
45.	Southern	123	87	70.7	7,758.14	1,496	5.18
46.	New Mexico	97	68	70.1	3,488.68	1,183	2.94
47.	New York						
47.	Central	213	97	45.5	5,965.49	2,945	2.02
48.	Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire	178	84	47.1	4,320.85	2,260	1.91
49.	Southeastern	725	368	50.7	35,532.21	17,908	1.98
50.	Western	112	57	50.8	2,931.34	1,587	1.84

Area #	General Service Conference Area	Total # of Gps.	#Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	Total Group contrib.	No. of Members	Contrib. per capita
51.	North Carolina	314	220	70.0%	14,414.85	4,760	\$3.02
52.	North Dakota	104	73	70.1	4,167.92	1,397	2.98
53.	Ohio						
53.	Cent. & S.E.	185	96	51.8	4,649.95	2,563	1.81
54.	Northeastern	411	138	33.5	7,122.35	10,858	.65
55.	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.	128	79	61.7	4,766.39	1,650	2.88
56.	S.W. Ohio/N. Kentucky	141	93	65.9	4,456.42	1,881	2.36
57.	Oklahoma	192	156	81.2	10,483.61	2,304	4.55
58.	Oregon	204	113	55.3	6,167.25	2,399	2.57
59.	Pennsylvania						
59.	Eastern	419	253	60.3	22,358.67	7,943	2.81
60.	Western	251	162	64.5	10,949.70	3,946	2.77
61.	Rhode Island	89	51	57.3	3,562.45	1,176	3.02
62.	South Carolina	122	82	67.2	4,974.24	1,806	2.75
63.	South Dakota	100	55	55.0	3,711.81	1,513	2.45
64.	Tennessee	188	103	54.7	4,779.22	2,492	1.91
65.	Texas						
65.	Northeastern	175	92	52.5	9,021.01	4,941	1.82
66.	Northern	141	79	56.0	4,856.77	2,788	1.74
67.	Southeastern	147	76	51.7	7,877.10	3,844	2.04
68.	Southwestern	199	124	62.3	7,909.52	3,593	2.20
69.	Utah	105	61	58.0	3,432.80	1,186	2.89
70.	Vermont	59	36	61.0	2,949.45	723	4.07
71.	Virginia	336	249	74.1	18,242.76	5,386	3.38
72.	Washington	432	255	59.0	19,822.46	6,017	3.29
73.	West Virginia	94	65	69.1	3,050.87	1,112	2.74
74.	Wisconsin						
74.	N. Wis./Upper Peninsula Mich.	267	161	60.2	10,514.99	3,628	2.90
75.	Southern	286	160	55.9	8,240.12	3,747	2.19
76.	Wyoming	56	30	53.5	1,355.45	539	2.51
77.	Puerto Rico	79	49	62.0	2,304.63	1,290	1.78
78.	Alberta/N.W.T.	248	143	57.6	9,674.39	2,866	3.37
79.	British Columbia/Yukon	379	203	53.5	16,638.81	5,218	3.18
80.	Manitoba	128	64	50.0	6,045.28	2,535	2.38
81.	New Brunswick/P.E.I.	127	82	64.5	4,414.19	1,616	2.73
82.	Nova Scotia/Nfld./Lab.	144	81	56.2	5,006.64	1,605	3.11
83.	Ontario						
83.	Eastern	340	173	50.8	20,066.02	6,317	3.18
84.	Northeastern	120	59	49.1	4,638.60	1,286	3.61
85.	Northwestern	50	25	50.0	2,598.74	927	2.80
86.	Western	317	195	61.5	26,630.47	4,488	5.93
87.	Quebec						
87.	Southwestern	317	221	69.7	25,519.40	8,410	3.03
88.	Southeastern	145	25	17.2	1,333.01	3,268	.41
89.	Northeastern	200	37	18.5	4,806.58	4,312	1.11
90.	Northwestern	180	45	25.0	2,008.19	4,316	.47
91.	Saskatchewan	218	130	59.6	7,614.48	2,901	2.62
Total U.S. & Canada		21,332	12,038	56.4%	\$839,434.03	403,590	\$2.07

Contributions reported on this schedule represent only those received directly from individual groups and do not include contributions received as specials, individual, in-memoriam, and anniversary.

Therefore, you will note, the Total Group Contributions on this report will not agree with the total appearing on the Contributions - by state and province - report.

1978 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

- **Grace Day, W.Va.**
Fran Polek, Wash.
*****Harriet Rawls, S. Fla.**
Lewis Wilder, N. Ind.

Bob Gadoury, R.I.
Bill Geoghan, Del.
Lloyd King, N.B./P.E.I.
Lew Lee, Wyo.

Secretary: Phyllis Masback

Finance

- **Dave Aronofsky, N.E. Tex.**
Warren Kelly, Ala./N.W. Fla.
*****Ken King, E. Pa.**
Dean Young, S. Ill.

J. D. Higginbotham, Miss.
Goldene Lahann, Mid-S. Calif.
Bob Morris, Ariz.
Duffy Salvog, N. Minn.

Secretary: Dennis Manders

Conference Policy/Admissions

- **Donald Heilman, S. Minn.**
*****Gerry LaPointe, N.E. Que.**
Jessie Parks, S.E. Mich.
Al Regeling, N. N.J.

Everett Edwards, Md.
Mark Peterson, Me.
Keith Strickland, Ga.
Orville Young, W. Ont.

Secretary: Cora Louise Belford

Committee on Trustees

- **Elizabeth H. Erhard, Okla.**
Rolly Provost, E. Ont.
Tom Sinclair, B.C./Yukon
*****Dick Sutherland, S. Calif.**

Frank Stewart, S.C.
Bob Tapola, N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.
Marvin Wilson, Mont.
Woody Wooldridge, N.H.

Secretary: June Russell

Conference Report and Charter

- *Laurent Biron, S.E. Que.**
*****Tom Dougherty, Chicago**
****Paul Joachim, E. Mass.**
Bob Wall, Cent. N.Y.

Helen Harmon, Man.
Bill Hopkins, Kans.
Nick Krebs, S.Dak.
Gene Loomis, N. Wis./Upper Peninsula Mich.

Secretary: Susan Daly

Grapevine

- ***Al Ashmanskas, E. Mo.**
Mike Flemming, N.S./Nfld./Lab.
***LeRoy Iszler, Cent. Mich.**
****Dean Kirkham, N. Coastal Calif.**
Allen Phillips, Ark.

Ramon Acevedo, P.R.
John Maloney, W. Mass.
Ivan Strome, Alta./N.W.T.
Michael Thies, S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.

Secretary: Retha Gresham

Public Information

- **Ray Anderson, W. Mo.**
Marv Brisson, N.W. Ont.
*****Bob Hawkes, La.**
Garrett Taylor, D.C.

Nada Butz, N.Dak.
Ed Flanagan, Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire
Bill Killebrew, Tenn.
Ruth Peterson, N. Ill.
Al Siska, W. Mich.

Secretary: Betty Liddle

- *Alternate delegate*
***Chairperson*
****Alternate chairperson*

Cooperation with the Professional Community

- Jim Dickens, Nev.**
*****Ken Dolliver, N.E. Ont.**
****Bob Hiebel, Cent. & S.E. Ohio**
Jack Wilson, Utah

Angelo Carpentier, N.W. Que.
Roger Gleason, Nebr.
Barbara Marsh, Vt.
Smoky Woodson, W. N.Y.

Secretary: Sarah Pierce

Literature

- **Fred Boyd, N.E. Ohio**
*****Bob Britt, Va.**
Reed Edgar, Colo.
Jim Shannon, S.E. N.Y.

Joe Clements, Idaho
Annette Fiel, N. Int. Calif.
Al Hergott, Sask.
Skeeter Shillings, S.W. Tex.
Jane Story, S. N.J.

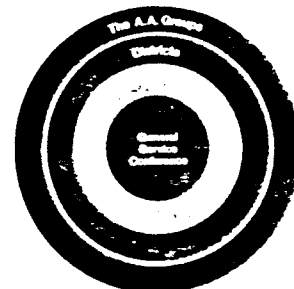
Secretary: Lois Fisher

Treatment Facilities

- **Harry Dorsett, N.C.**
John Gans, S. Wis.
Skeeter Hayes, S.E. Tex.
*****Lenore Jefferson, E. Pa.**

Buck Bruner, S. Ind.
Thurman Dunn, N.M.
Cliff Locke, San Diego
Leon Richards, Ky.

Secretary: Beth Kuhlmann



Correctional Facilities

- Vic Blair, Hawaii**
****Donald Hart, Iowa**
*****Barbara Scharla-Nielsen, N. Fla.**

***Pierre Prenoveau, S.W. Que.**
Dick Juelson, Alsk.
Ken Savoloja, Oreg.
Jan Williamson, N.W. Tex.

Secretary: Vincina McCarthy

New chairpersons and alternate chairpersons

Meeting during the Conference, each committee elected from among its Panel 28 members the following, who took office immediately after the Conference.

Committee

Conference Agenda
 Conference Report and Charter
 Cooperation with the Professional Community
 Correctional Facilities
 Finance
 Grapevine
 Literature
 Conference Policy/Admissions
 Public Information
 Treatment Facilities
 Committee on Trustees

Chairperson

Bob Gadoury, R.I.
Gene Loomis, N.Wis./Upper Peninsula Mich.
Barbara Marsh, Vt.
Jan Williamson, N.W. Tex.
Bob Morris, Ariz.
Ivan Strome, Alta./N.W.T.
Al Hergott, Sask.
Keith Strickland, Ga.
Al Siska, W. Mich.
Buck Bruner, S. Ind.
Woody Wooldridge, N.H.

Alternate chairperson

Bill Geoghan, Del.
Bill Hopkins, Kans.
Smoky Woodson, W. N.Y.
Ken Savaloja, Oreg.
J. D. Higginbotham, Miss.
Ramon Acevedo, P.R.
Joe Clements, Idaho
Mark Peterson, Me.
Nada Butz, N.Dak.
Thurman Dunn, N.M.
Bob Tapola, N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.

1978 Trustees' Committees

Roasters

Archives

Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.,
chairperson
Jerry Danzig
Mike Rainbolt
Samuel Smith
George Gordon, Ph.D., *consultant*
Nell Wing, *archivist*
Frank Mauser, *secretary*

Conference

John Waterfield, *chairperson*
Jerry Danzig
Virginia Hallman
Don Nicolson
Stan Wilsey
Phyllis Masback, *secretary*

Cooperation with the Professional Community

Gordon Patrick, *chairperson*
Milton Maxwell, Ph.D.
John Bealer, M.D.
Hal Marley
Don Nicolson
Samuel Smith
Ross Von Wiegand
Peter Watters
Barry Leach, *consultant*
Sarah Pierce, *secretary*

Correctional Facilities

W. J. Estelle Jr., *chairperson*
Cecil Corrigan
Timothy Danaher
William Dunkin
Lucas Gonzalez
Virginia Hallman
Ray Leary
Jeannette Spencer
Vincina McCarthy, *secretary*

Employee Retirement

Arthur Miles, *chairperson*
Michael Alexander
John Bealer, M.D.
Jerry Danzig
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A.
Martin Le Boutillier
Fred Sengstacke
Robert Pearson, *secretary*
Dennis Manders, *assistant secretary*

Finance

Arthur Miles, *chairperson*
Michael Alexander
John Bealer, M.D.
Mac Cheater
Don Daly
Ruth Hartshorn
Martin Le Boutillier
Don Nicolson
Fred Sengstacke
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*

General Service Sharing Session

Membership comprises all trustees
(see following pages).
Stan Wilsey, *chairperson*
Cora Louise Belford, *secretary*

International Convention/ A.A. Regional Forums

Peter Watters, *chairperson*
Cecil Corrigan
Mike Rainbolt
Ed Small
Stan Wilsey
Susan Daly, *co-secretary*
Betty Liddle, *co-secretary*

Literature

Don Nicolson, *chairperson*
Gordon Patrick
Charles Hanson
Cecil Corrigan
Ruth Hartshorn
Jack Morley
John Ryall
Samuel Smith
Jacquelyn Solomon
Janet Graves, *consultant*
Barry Leach, *consultant*
Lois Fisher, *secretary*

Nominating

Charles Hanson, *chairperson*
Mac Cheater
W. J. Estelle Jr.
Gordon Patrick
Mike Rainbolt
Jacquelyn Solomon
John Waterfield
Peter Watters
Stan Wilsey
June Russell, *secretary*

Public Information

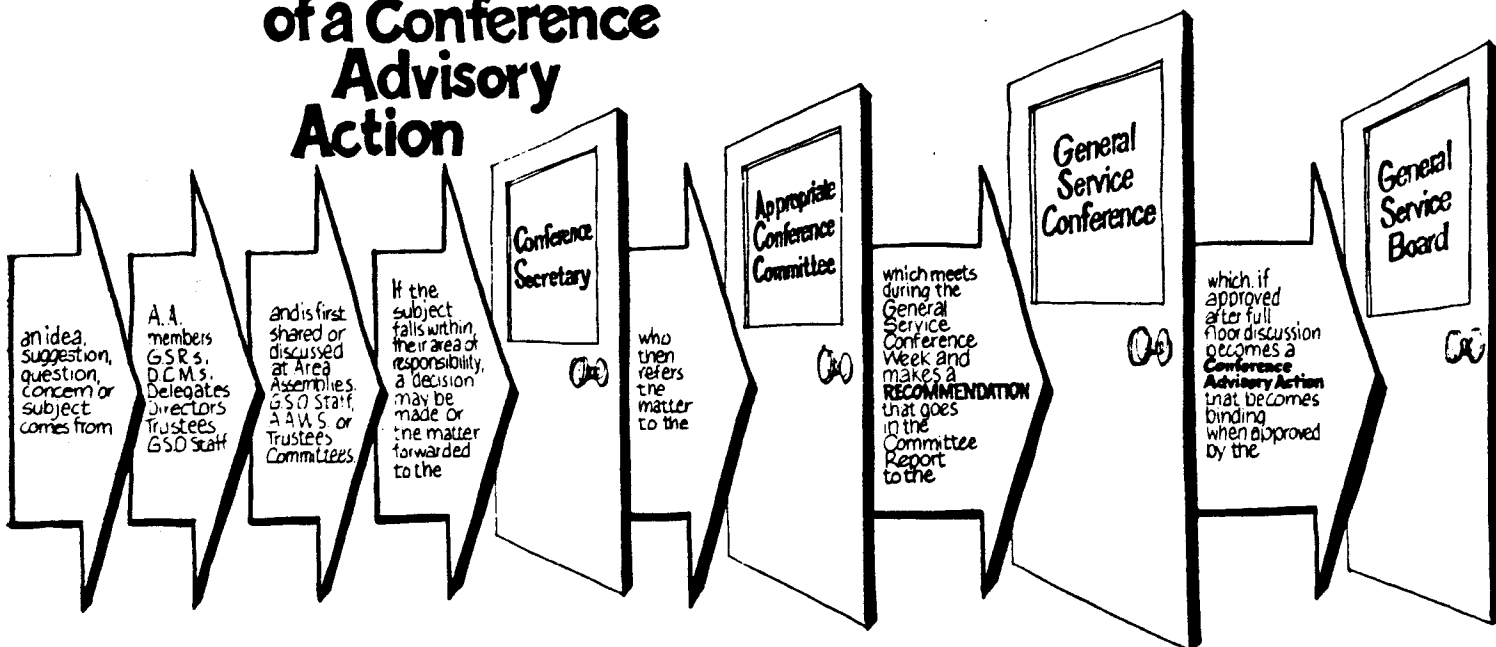
Jerry Danzig, *chairperson*
John Bragg
William Croke
Denison Demac
Janet Graves
Charles Hanson
Ruth Hartshorn
Fay Stanley Shulman
Ed Small
Dee Powell, *consultant*
Betty Liddle, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

Ed Small, *chairperson*
Mac Cheater
Hal Harmon
Frank Herzlin
Henry Hudson
Ray O'Keefe
Robert Pope
Emily Rayford
Jerome Thompson
Beth Kuhlmann, *secretary*

John L. Norris, M.D., and Robert Pearson are ex officio members of all committees. Committee secretaries and consultants do not vote.

Flow Chart of a Conference Advisory Action



"Were it not for Committees, it is doubtful that any Conference could get over a fraction of the ground it now covers. As the Conference has grown in size and influence the Committees' importance has grown even more."
...from the A.A. Service Manual, p 72

1978 Conference Members

Nonalcoholic (Class A) trustees

***John L. Norris, M.D.** (Box 251, New London, NH 03257), is chairperson of the General Service Board and the General Service Conference. [His retirement took effect at the end of the 1978 Conference meeting.] He is also a member of the Nominating Committee and was elected to the board in January 1951. Before his professional retirement, "Dr. Jack" was associate medical director of Eastman Kodak Co., Rochester, N.Y. He is former chairperson of the Governor's Committee on Alcoholism and former president of the Industrial Medicine Association and the American Academy of Occupational Medicine.

Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D. (25 Bacchus Ct., Olympia, WA 98503), was elected to the board in April 1971. [He was elected as its chairperson April 22, 1978.] Before his retirement in 1975, Milton was professor of sociology in the Center of Alcohol Studies at Rutgers University, New Brunswick, N.J. From 1965 through 1973, he was also executive director of the Rutgers Summer School of Alcohol Studies. Milton is chairperson of the Archives Committee and co-chairperson of the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

Michael Alexander (150 E. 69th St., New York, NY 10021) was elected a trustee in 1976 after 20 years as legal adviser to the board. A partner in the law firm of Smith, Steibel, Alexander, and Saskor, P.C., he was long an associate of the late Bernard Smith — so significant in the history of A.A. Mike is a director of the British American Chamber of Commerce, a trustee and past president of the Consular Law Society, and a director of the Ireland-U.S. Council for Commerce and Industry. He is a member of the Finance Committee and nonvoting consultant on the Employee Retirement Committee.

John D. Bealer, M.D. (3639 Emerson Cir., Bethlehem, PA 18017), elected to the board in April 1971, is assistant corporate medical director of Bethlehem Steel Corp. He has long been interested in the problem of alcoholism in industry and is a member of the American Medical Society on Alcoholism and a director of the National Council on Alcoholism. Dr. John is chairperson of A.A. World Services and serves on the Committees on Finance, Employee Retirement, and Cooperation with the Professional Community.

W. J. Estelle Jr. (director, Texas Department of Corrections, Box 99, Huntsville, TX 77340) was named a trustee in April 1977. He is born in Indiana but educated in California, where he began his 18-year career in corrections. He then spent two years as warden of Montana State Prison. Jim has taught courses in corrections in two California colleges and is a member of seven professional societies concerned with criminal justice, corrections, and services to children and youth. He is chairperson of the Committee on Correctional Facilities and also serves on the Nominating Committee.

Arthur J. Miles (Dime Savings Bank of New York, Fifth Ave. and 48th St., New York, NY 10017) was elected to the board in 1970. He is an executive vice-president and treasurer of the Dime Savings Bank of New York and is on the board of trustees of the Cultural Institutions Retirement System. He is also a member of the New York Society of Security Analysts and the National Association of Business Economists. He is chairperson

of the Finance, Employee Retirement, and Reserve Fund Investment Policy Committees and treasurer of the General Service Board.

Gordon M. Patrick (Box 100, Lyndhurst, Ont. KOE 1N0, Canada), elected to the board in 1975, is president of Gordon Patrick Associates, a firm of consultants specializing in occupational alcoholism. Formerly associated with the Addiction Research Foundation of Ontario and the Donwood Institute, he is a member of the Association of Labor-Management Administrators and Consultants on Alcoholism and serves the Alcohol and Drug Problems Association of North America as vice-chairperson of its Occupational Program Section, which he helped to found. Gordon is chairperson of the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community and also serves on the Literature and Nominating Committees.

Alcoholic (Class B) trustees

N. M. ("Mac") Cheater (5 Frost Ave., Winnipeg, Man. R3K 0E1, Canada) was elected general service trustee—Canada [now termed trustee-at-large] in 1975. He had his last drink in 1956. A Panel 12 delegate, Mac introduced Big Book study sessions in his province. He chaired the first Winter Conference in Manitoba. Mac is sales manager of a television station. He serves on the Finance, Nominating, and Treatment Facilities Committees and as a delegate to the World Service Meeting.

Cecil ("Cec") E. Corrigan (12-12th St. E., Prince Albert, Sask. S6V 2L9, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in 1976, with 24 years' sobriety. He was a Panel 8 delegate. Cec has had two decades of experience in management of ladies' wear and fur businesses, and also has interests in real estate. He serves on the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, Correctional Facilities, and Literature Committees.

Jerry A. Danzig (993 Park Ave., New York, NY 10028), after ten years' sobriety, became a general service trustee in April 1977. Since 1972, he has been a director of A.A.W.S. He is chairperson of the Public Information Committee and a member of the Archives, Conference, and Employee Retirement Committees. He served the New York Intergroup P.I. Committee for two years. Jerry has been officer of a broadcast network and special assistant to two New York governors. He is a partner in a management consultant firm.

****George Dorsey** (4761 Paradise Dr., Tiburon, CA 94920), sober since 1961, was elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in 1978. He was a Panel 25 delegate and chairperson of the 1976 Conference Finance Committee. George had previously served as a G.S.R., D.C.M., and alternate delegate. Prior to general service activities, he served for several years in various capacities for the San Francisco Bay Area Intercounty Fellowship, and has been on its Twelfth Step list for 15 years. George is vice-president and director of an insurance corporation.

Virginia C. Hallman (4304 N. Alpine Ave., P.O. Box 11507, Shorewood, WI 53211) was elected East Central U.S. regional trustee in April 1977, after 24 years' sobriety. She was secretary of the Milwaukee Central Office four years and was a delegate (Panel 23). She has also been active as a volunteer in behalf of a recovery home for women and a local alcoholism

council. She is office manager of a manufacturing firm. Now on the Conference and Correctional Facilities Committees, she will be a delegate to the 1978 World Service Meeting.

Charles H. Hanson (42 Puritan Rd., Fairfield, CT 06430) was elected general service trustee in 1975. He is chairperson of the Grapevine Corporate Board and the Nominating Committee, and serves on the Public Information and Literature Committees. Chuck had his last drink in 1966. He is a frequent Grapevine contributor, and is now president of an advertising agency, after supervisory duties in three of the best-known Madison Avenue firms.

Ruth K. Hartshorn (190-18 89th Ave., Hollis, NY 11423) was elected general service trustee—U.S. [now termed trustee-at-large] in 1977 after 17 years of sobriety. She became a G.S.R. in 1961, has worked on all state and local conventions since 1963, was a Panel 23 delegate, and helps local intergroups. She is active in her church, operates an antiques and collectibles store, and is treasurer of a realty company. Ruth serves on the Finance, Literature, and Public Information Committees.

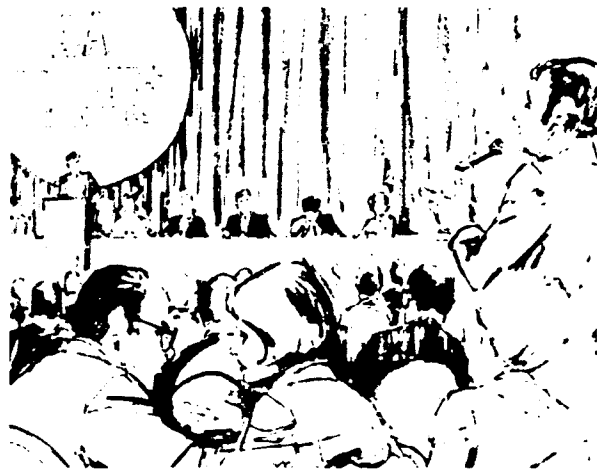
***Fernand Ippersiel** (1025 Sherbrooke E., #1504, Montreal, Que., Canada) was chosen Eastern Canada regional trustee in 1978, after 17 years of sobriety. He was a Panel 18 Conference delegate and became editor of *La Vigne A.A.* in 1968. He was chief translator of the Big Book and the Twelve Concepts into French. Fernand is a television producer.

Martin Le Boutillier (1165 Fifth Ave., New York, NY 10029) started his general service trusteeship in April 1977, after 12 years of sobriety. He is a former president of New York Intergroup. He has been a director of A.A.W.S. since 1974, and serves on the Finance and Employee Retirement Committees. Martin is an officer of a large Wall Street firm.

Don Nicolson (1015 5th Ave. N. — #12, Moorhead, MN 56560), elected West Central regional trustee in 1976, had his last drink in 1948. He was a Panel 12 delegate. He lectures in the alcoholism treatment unit of a hospital. Don is partner in a company holding 35 franchised food stores in nine states. He serves on the Conference, Cooperation with the Professional Community, and Finance Committees, and is chairperson of the Literature Committee.

Mike Rainbolt (P.O. Box 248, Cordell, OK 73632) was elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in 1975, with 28 years' sobriety. After group and area service, he was a Panel 15 delegate and later chaired his state P.I. Committee. Mike has a background in real estate and land titles and is a petroleum landman, operating his own oil and gas exploration firm. He serves on the Archives, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and Nominating Committees.

Edward J. Small (P.O. Box 582, Cooper Union Sta., New York, NY 10003) was elected general service trustee in August 1976. Ed had his last drink in 1965. After stints at all group jobs, including G.S.R., Ed served New York Intergroup and became a regular Grapevine contributor. He is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board and the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums and Public Information Committees, and is chairperson of the Committee on Treatment Facilities. Ed



directs a health program for a large publishing firm and belongs to several professional societies interested in alcoholism.

Samuel E. Smith (820 N.W. 87 Ave., Apt. 203, Miami, FL 33126), 12 years sober, was elected from the Southeastern Region in April 1977. Active in the Third Legacy since 1968, Sam served as a delegate on Panel 25. He has also twice been chairperson of a gratitude dinner and his local intergroup banquet, and has been active in local P.I. He has been an attorney 24 years. Sam is a member of the Committees on Archives, Literature, and Cooperation with the Professional Community.

John E. Waterfield (2900 Adams Mill Rd., N.W., Washington, DC 20009) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in 1975, with 18 years' sobriety. John was a Panel 23 delegate, having served previously in many group, intergroup, and G.S. area capacities. He set up a one-to-one "sponsorship" program for informing medical students about A.A., and originated the mini-conference idea. John has his own creative advertising and marketing business. He is chairperson of the Conference Committee and also serves on the Nominating Committee.

***Peter A. G. Watters** (366 Rebecca St., Oakville, Ont. L6J 5A8, Canada) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in 1974. Pete has been sober since 1960. He was chairperson of Toronto Intergroup 1956-66, Conference delegate 1967-68, and chairperson of the Ontario G.S. Committee. He has been on advisory committees to local recovery and addiction-research facilities. Pete is vice-president and owner of an education products distributorship. He serves on the Nominating Committee and the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community and is chairperson of the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee.

***Stanley R. Wilsey** (110 Toyon Dr., Fairfax, CA 94930) had been sober 23 years when elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in 1974. Stan has been a Conference delegate and editor of *Good News*, local A.A. newspaper, and was advisory co-chairperson of the 1960 International A.A. Convention in Long Beach. He is a consultant for vehicle dealers in the San Francisco Bay area. Stan is a member of the Nominating, Conference, and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

1978 Conference Members

A.A. World Services directors

John D. Bealer, M.D., <i>chairperson</i>	Martin Le Boutillier, <i>treasurer</i>
Robert G. Pearson, <i>president</i>	John Bragg
Jacquelyn Solomon, <i>first vice-president</i>	Jerry Danzig
Cora Louise Belford, <i>second vice-president</i>	John E. Waterfield
	Peter A. G. Watters

A.A. Grapevine directors

Charles H. Hanson, <i>chairperson, president</i>	Austin MacCormick
Jack Morley, <i>vice-president, secretary</i>	Polly Marsh
Donald F. Daly, <i>treasurer</i>	John Ryall
Kathleen Kiernan	Fred J. Sengstacke
	Edward J. Small

General Service Office staff

Robert G. Pearson, <i>general manager</i>	Beth Kuhlmann
Frank Mauser, <i>administrative assistant</i>	Betty Liddle
Cora Louise Belford	Phyllis Masback
Susan Daly	Vincina McCarthy
Lois Fisher	Sarah Pierce
	June Russell
	Mary Ellen Welsh

Grapevine staff

Jack Morley, <i>editor</i>	Retha Gresham, <i>managing editor</i>
Ann Warner, <i>associate editor</i>	

Others attending Conference (*not as voting members*)

Non-A.A.

Bernie Brenneis, *supervisor, Mail Department*
 Donna Berkowitz, *office manager*
 Charles Columbia, *assistant controller*
 Elizabeth Garcia, *supervisor, Steno/Clerical Department*
 Edward Gordon, *assistant controller*
 Shirley Grant, *personnel manager*
 Robert Hughie, *supervisor, Shipping Department*
 Wilma Joseph, *supervisor, File Department*
 John Kirwin, *supervisor, Accounting Department*
 Lena Machado, *supervisor, Records Department*
 Dennis Manders, *controller*
 Dorothy McGinity, *assistant to the Conference secretary*
 Madeline Whitlock, *secretary, A.A. World Services*
 Nell Wing, *archivist*
 Owen J. Flanagan, *independent C.P.A.*

A.A.

Janet Graves, *production, Conference Report*
 Barry Leach, *editor, Conference Report*
Two observers from trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community
Two observers from trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities
Two observers from trustees' Finance Committee
Two observers from Grapevine Editorial Board
Two observers from trustees' Literature Committee
Two observers from trustees' Public Information Committee
Two observers from trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities

Area delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 28th Conference includes Panel 27 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 28 (new delegates).

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/NW. Florida	1	27	Warren Kelly, 6 Oak St., Chickasaw, AL 36611
Alaska	2	28	Dick Juelson, P.O. Box 286, Kodiak, AK 99615
Arizona	3	28	Bob Morris, 2880 N. El Burrito, Tucson, AZ 85705
Arkansas	4	27	Allen Phillips, P.O. Box 626, Springdale, AR 72764
California	5	27	Southern - Dick Sutherland, 5021 Laguna St., Bakersfield, CA 93306
	6	27	Northern Coastal - Dean Kirkham, 3800 Lyon Ave., Oakland, CA 94601
	7	28	Northern Interior - Annette Fiel, 6346 N. Van Ness, Fresno, CA 93711
	8	28	San Diego - Clifford L. (Cliff) Locke, 1232 30th, San Diego, CA 92102
	9	28	Mid-Southern - Goldene Lahnann, 4360 Watkins Dr., Riverside, CA 92507
Colorado	10	27	J. L. Reed Edgar, 1119 Detroit St., Denver, CO 80206
Connecticut	11	27	Robert (Bob) Gilman, 20 Mt. Sanford Rd., Cheshire, CT 06410
Delaware	12	28	William F. (Bill) Geoghan, Rte. 1, Box 379-D, Seaford, DE 19973
District of Columbia	13	27	Garrett Taylor, 50 55th St., S.E., Washington, DC 20019
Florida	14	27	Northern - Barbara Scharla-Nielsen, 205 7th Ave., Indianalantic, FL 32903
	15	27	Southern - Harriet P. Rawls, 6580 S.W. 38th St., Miami, FL 33155
Georgia	16	28	Keith Strickland, P.O. Box 262, Nahunta, GA 31553
Hawaii	17	27	V. P. (Vic) Blair, 46-283 Kahuhipa St., Apt. 901, Kaneohe, HI 96744

State	Area no.	Panel		State	Area no.	Panel	
Idaho	18	28	Joe Clements, P.O. Box 573, 400 Third Ave., Twin Falls, ID 83310	Mississippi	37	28	J. D. Higginbotham, 614 Meeks St., Tupelo, MS 38801
Illinois	19	27	Chicago - Tom Dougherty, 900 Shermer Rd., Glenview, IL 60025	Missouri	38	27	Albert (Al) Ashmanskas, 1045-D Mersey Bend Dr., St. Louis, MO 63129
	20	28	Northern - Ruth E. Peterson, 30 N. Broadview, Lombard, IL 60148		39	27	Western - A. Ray Anderson, 1610 TBN Bldg., 1125 Grand Ave., Kansas City, MO 64106
	21	27	Southern - Dean Young, 102 E. Chestnut, Bondville, IL 61815	Montana	40	28	Marvin Wilson, Box 758, Helena, MT 59601
Indiana	22	27	Northern - Lewis (Lew) Wilder, 52626 Hasting St., South Bend, IN 46615	Nebraska	41	28	Roger Gleason, 3062 Poppleton Ave., Apt. 4, Omaha, NE 68105
	23	28	Southern - O. S. (Buck) Bruner Jr., O. S. Bruner Agency, Inc., 3901 Meridian St., Suite 450, Indianapolis, IN 46208	Nevada	42	27	James (Jim) E. Dickens, P.O. Box 2876, Reno, NV 89505
Iowa	24	27	Donald D. (Don) Hart, 1204 Bluff St., Cedar Falls, IA 50613	New Hampshire	43	28	David (Woody) Wooldridge, 8 Wallis Rd., Portsmouth, NH 03801
Kansas	25	28	William (Bill) G. Hopkins, P.O. Box 18093, Wichita, KS 67218	New Jersey	44	27	Northern - Albert (Al) H. Regeling Sr., 117 Hamburg Tpk., Riverdale, NJ 07457
Kentucky	26	28	Leon Richards, 750 N. 23rd St., Paducah, KY 42001		45	28	Southern - Jane R. Story, 4A4 Arbor Green, Edgewater Park, Beverly, NJ 08010
	27	27	Robert H. (Bob) Hawkes, 152 Albert Ave., Shreveport, LA 71105	New Mexico	46	28	Thurman Dunn, 1100 Canyon Rd., Alamogordo, NM 88310
Maine	28	28	Mark Peterson, Box 68, Sinclair, ME 04779	New York	47	27	Central - H. Robert (Bob) Wall, 384 Front St., Owego, NY 13827
Maryland	29	28	Everett E. (Ed) Edwards, 4718 Meise Dr., Baltimore, MD 21206		48	28	Hudson / Mohawk / Berkshire - Edward W. (Ed) Flanagan, 13 Rapple Dr., Albany, NY 12205
Massachusetts	30	27	Eastern - Paul Joachim, Box 112, 7 Crown St., Billerica, MA 01866		49	27	Southeastern - Jim Shannon, 3150 Bailey Ave., Bronx, NY 10463
	31	28	Western - John F. Maloney, 13 Fairdel St., Springfield, MA 01108		50	28	Western - Al (Smoky) Woodson, 514 S. Division St., Buffalo, NY 14216
Michigan	32	27	Central - LeRoy Iszler, Rte. 3, 10615 Frost Rd., Portland, MI 48875	North Carolina	51	27	Harry R. Dorsett, 1216 Brookwood Rd., Shelby, NC 28150
	33	27	Southeastern - Jessie Parks, 13933 Brest Rd., Southgate, MI 48195	North Dakota	52	28	Nada Butz, 138 28th St., S.W., Minot, ND 58701
	34	28	Western - Albert H. (Al) Siska, 1410 Henderson Dr., Kalamazoo, MI 49007	Ohio	53	27	Central & Southeastern - Bob Hiebel, 4996 Northtowne Blvd., Columbus, OH 43229
Minnesota	35	28	Northern - Garfield (Duffy) Salvog, 322 N. 9th, Brainerd, MN 54601		54	27	Northeastern - Fred Boyd, 1622 Shannon Rd., Girard, OH 44420
	36	27	Southern - Donald E. (Don) Heilman, Lot 15, Summit Park, St. Peter, MN 56082		55	28	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Michigan - Robert C. (Bob) Tapola, 1255 S. Byrne, B-103, Toledo, OH 43614

1978 Conference Members

State	Area no.	Panel		Area no.	Panel
Ohio	56	28 S.W. Ohio/N. Kentucky – Michael Thies, 3431 Todds Run Rd., Williamsburg, OH 45176	Puerto Rico	77	28 Ramon Acevedo, Calle Ambar #19, Villa Blanca, Caguas, PR 00625
Oklahoma	57	27 Elizabeth H. Erhard, 1804 S. Quaker Ave., Tulsa, OK 74120			
Oregon	58	28 Ken Savaloja, 16615 S.W. 128th, Tigard, OR 97223	CANADA		
Pennsylvania	59	27 Eastern – Lenore V. Jefferson, 72 Drimmers Lane, Wayne, PA 19087	Province	Area no.	Panel
	60	27 Kenneth M. (Ken) King, 7 Ferncliff Beach, Erie, PA 16505	Alberta/ Northwest Territories	78	28 Ivan Strome, Box 6729, Fort St. John, B.C., Canada V1J 4J2
Rhode Island	61	28 Robert H. (Bob) Gadoury, 21 Irene Lane, Coventry, RI 02816	British Columbia/ Yukon	79	27 Thomas (Tom) E. Sinclair, 712 Pine St., Victoria, B.C., Canada V6C 2L8
South Carolina	62	28 Frank B. Stewart, Rte. 1, Box 130, Silverstreet, SC 29145	Manitoba	80	28 Helen Harmon, P.O. Box 391, Melita, Man., Canada R0M 1L0
South Dakota	63	28 Nick Krebs, 601 Third Ave. W., Lemmon, SD 57638	New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	81	28 Lloyd King, R.R. #1, Charlotte-town, P.E.I., Canada C1A 7J6
Tennessee	64	28 William C (Bill) Killebrew, P.O. Box 40067, Nashville, TN 37204	Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/ Labrador	82	27 Michael A. (Mike) Flemming, P.O. Box 133, New Waterford, N.S., Canada B1H 4K4
Texas	65	27 Northeastern – David H. (Dave) Aronofsky, 2503 W. Jefferson, Dallas, TX 75211	Ontario	83	27 Eastern – Rolly Provost, Falcon Tower Apts., 52-201 Ontario St., Cobourg, Ont., Canada K9A 3B7
	66	28 Northwestern – Jan K. Williamson, 3208 Lamplighter Pl., El Paso, TX 79925		84	27 Northeastern – Ken Dolliver, 37 Elmhurst Crescent, Sudbury, Ont., Canada P3A 1A3
	67	27 Southeastern – Leo (Skeeter) Hayes, 209 Norwood #2, Houston, TX 77011		85	27 Northwestern – Marv Brisson, Box 11, Site 24, R.R. 2, Dryden, Ont., Canada P8N 2Y5
	68	28 Southwestern – M. D. (Skeeter) Shillings, P.O. Box 408, Port Lavaca, TX 77979		86	28 Western – Orville Young, R.R. #4, Creemore, Ont., Canada L0M 1G0
Utah	69	27 Jack Wilson, 2197 W. 5075 S., Roy, UT 84067	Quebec	87	28 *Southwestern – Pierre Preno-veau, 7736 St. Denis St., Montreal, Que., Canada H2R 2E8
Vermont	70	28 Barbara Marsh, 35 S. Summit St., Essex Junction, VT 05052		88	27 *Southeastern – Laurent Biron, 1700 O'Reilly, Sherbrooke, Que., Canada J1J 1C1
Virginia	71	27 Robert (Bob) Britt, 418 Painter St., Norfolk, VA 23505		89	27 Northeastern – Gerry LaPointe, 946 Dumas, St-Jean Chrysostome, Co. Levis, Que., Canada G0S 2T0
Washington	72	27 Fran J. Polek, 2301 E. 61st Ave., Spokane, WA 99203		90	28 Northwestern, Angelo Carpentier, 293 Palance, Vanier, Ont., Canada K1L 7V5
West Virginia	73	27 Grace Day, P.O. Box 5242, Charleston, WV 25311	Saskatchewan	91	28 Albert J. (Al) Hergott, Box 1030, Humboldt, Sask., Canada S0K 2A0
Wisconsin	74	28 N. Wisconsin/Upper Peninsula Michigan – Gene Loomis, 612 Third St., Marshfield, WI 54449			
	75	27 Southern – John M. Gans, 2820 W. Wells, Milwaukee, WI 53208			
Wyoming	76	28 Lew Lee, Box 244, Lander, WY 82520			

*Alternate delegate

Literature distributed – 1977

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	211,787
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	108,431
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	28,227
A.A. Comes of Age	15,701
As Bill Sees It	27,829
Alcoholics Anonymous – Spanish edition	3,200
As Bill Sees It – Spanish edition	2,300
A.A. Comes of Age – Spanish edition	600
Total	398,075

Booklets

Living Sober	65,501
Came to Believe	28,019
Living Sober – Spanish edition	2,530
Total	96,050

Pamphlets

A.A. – a Community Resource	70,700
A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee	39,800
A.A. and the Armed Services	59,800
A.A. and the Medical Profession	38,700
A.A. for the Woman	129,900
A.A. – 44 Questions	312,500
The A.A. Group	70,600
A.A. in Hospitals	37,100
A.A. in Prisons	20,900
A.A. in Your Community	113,100
The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse	104,300
The A.A. Service Manual	17,900
A.A. Tradition – How It Developed	40,400
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	15,700
Alcoholism Is a Management Problem	39,900
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	205,300
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	43,000
The Co-Founders of A.A.	34,000
Do You Think You're Different?	192,200
G.S.R.	57,800

How A.A. Members Cooperate	26,200
How It Works	161,400
If You Are a Professional	62,300
Inside A.A.	69,200
Is A.A. for You?	417,200
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	181,300
It Happened to Alice	48,600
The Jack Alexander Article	68,800
The Last Talks of A.A.'s Co-Founders	39,200
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	25,200
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	99,300
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	90,900
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	32,600
Problems Other Than Alcohol	85,500
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	150,400
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	23,800
This Is A.A.	319,500
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	38,000
Too Young? (new)	89,000
Twelve Concepts for World Service	4,900
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	51,000
Understanding Anonymity	83,600
What Happened to Joe	76,900
Young People and A.A.	160,900
Foreign translations	110,700
Total	4,160,000

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards – two-fold	557,600
Wallet cards – I Am Responsible	93,700
Wallet cards – Anonymity	51,600
Parchment – scrolls	4,559
Placards	742
A.A. Guidelines	54,400
Group Handbook	4,120
Wire racks	1,067
Cassettes	601
A.A. Public Information Manual	2,310
Hanging displays	814
Fact Files	3,520

Grapevine circulation – geographical breakdown

Circulation 4/1/78 - 100,500; circulation 4/1/77 - 91,225; increase for period - 9,275

U.S.	No. GvRs		Circulation		% In-crease		No. GvRs		Circulation		% In-crease		No. GvRs		Circulation		% In-crease
	3/78	6/77	4/1/77	4/1/78			3/78	6/77	4/1/77	4/1/78			3/78	6/77	4/1/77	4/1/78	
Ala.	12	2	708	835	17	Mont.	7	1	460	565	22	P.R.	1	1	201	130	-
Alsk.	2	1	274	242	-	Nebr.	12	4	910	1,078	18	U.S. Poss.			125	129	-
Ariz.	6	4	877	949	8	Nev.	3	0	302	350	15		1,886	268	77,711	85,505	10
Ark.	103	2	638	741	16	N.H.	5	3	599	625	4						
Calif.	204	55	8,158	8,997	10	N.J.	31	5	2,610	2,613	-						
Colo.	3	0	1,016	1,149	13	N.M.	18	0	435	568	30						
Conn.	6	4	1,686	1,728	2	N.Y.	84	47	6,471	6,800	5						
Del.	3	0	300	285	-	N.C.	41	2	1,735	1,953	12	Canada					
D.C.	27	0	520	673	29	N. Dak.	17	2	588	682	15	Alta./N.W.T.	9	1	1,783	1,614	-
Fla.	78	6	3,114	3,428	10	Ohio	126	2	2,605	3,280	25	B.C./Yukon	7	3	1,850	2,275	22
Ga.	13	2	1,598	1,649	3	Okla.	12	0	1,245	1,411	13	Man.	20	3	1,014	1,136	12
Hawaii	53	0	170	289	70	Oreg.	23	3	762	925	21	N.B./P.E.I.	4	1	460	538	16
Idaho	26	0	288	478	65	Pa.	50	2	2,662	2,822	6	N.S./Nfld./					
Ill.	47	2	3,462	3,961	14	R.I.	7	2	503	522	3	Lab.	3	1	905	993	9
Ind.	22	1	1,324	1,514	14	S.C.	8	5	805	842	4	Ont.	108	8	4,906	5,055	3
Iowa	53	2	1,200	1,409	17	S. Dak.	6	0	576	730	26	Que.	7	1	390	703	80
Kans.	8	3	1,345	1,345	-	Tenn.	121	71	895	1,158	29	Sask.	4	1	1,040	1,206	15
Ky.	15	0	749	884	18	Tex.	45	4	3,522	3,728	5		162	19	12,348	13,520	9
La.	21	0	798	935	17	Utah	52	1	288	418	45						
Me.	2	1	500	535	7	Vt.	3	2	352	320	-						
Md.	13	0	1,543	1,555	-	Va.	160	3	1,808	2,159	19						
Mass.	25	7	3,970	3,750	-	Wash.	14	7	2,024	2,194	8	Foreign	4	0	1,166	1,475	26
Mich.	121	2	2,869	3,121	8	W.Va.	34	1	475	567	19						
Minn.	58	3	3,419	3,839	12	Wis.	32	2	2,146	2,247	4						
Miss.	2	1	506	579	14	Wyo.	47	0	174	286	64						
Mo.	4	0	1,401	1,533	9				77,385	85,246							